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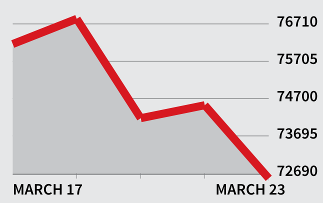
SENSEX 72696.39 (-1836.57)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22512.65	-601.85
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.98	-0.48
US Dollar (in ₹)	93.97	+0.26
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	139010.00	-7618
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	219260.00	-13104

ALLIANCE BOOST. **India, Russia** strengthen strategic and economic ties, reaffirm $100-b trade target by 2030 amid geopolitical tensions **p3**

POLLSCAPE. **AIADMK-led NDA** decides on seat sharing in TN; BJP to contest 27, PMK 18 and AMMK 11 **p7**

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Equities, gold rebound, oil falls as Trump halts Iran strikes for 5 days

CROSS-TALK. Crude drops to $96/bbl but rises to $102 after Tehran disputes any communication with US

Bloomberg
Reuters

A possible de-escalation in the West Asia conflict rippled through markets, with oil falling and stocks rising as US President Donald Trump said he would postpone strikes on Iranian energy infrastructure after what he described as productive talks toward ending the hostilities.

The reversal came after Trump gave Iran until Monday evening New York time to reopen the Strait of Hormuz or face strikes on power plants. Instead, he said on *Truth Social* that he'd ordered a five-day pause on military action, citing "in-depth, detailed and constructive conversations with Iran".

However, Iran's Fars News Agency disputed Trump's statement, citing a source who said there had been no direct communication with the US, nor via intermediaries. Israel's military said it was conducting strikes on Iran.

OIL RETREATS

"The market woke up to some potentially good news," said Chris Larkin at E*Trade from Morgan Stanley. "But follow-through on any relief rally will likely require tangible follow-through on the geopolitical front." Brent dropped as much as 14 per cent to $96, before paring its decline to $102 as Iran denied there had been negotiations. The S&P 500 added 1.4 per cent. Treasury yields and the dollar retreated, with traders lightening bets on the Federal Reserve tightening while pricing in some easing. Bitcoin gained.

POSITIVE MOMENTUM

At 9.40 am, the Dow Jones Industrial Average rose 758.78 points, or 1.66 per cent, to 46,336.25, the S&P 500 added 99.24 points, or 1.52 per cent, to 6,605.26, and the Nasdaq Composite gained 383.36 points, or 1.77 per cent, to 22,033.90.

Europe's STOXX 600 and precious metals edged up, while oil prices fell, signalling improving risk appetite. They had been trading lower after threats of attacks on Israeli and Iranian power networks.

BULLION RALLY

Gold prices rebounded from a four-month low hit earlier in the day, after Trump's comments postponing military strikes on Iran's energy infrastructure sent oil prices plunging.

Gold rose from $4,097.99 to $4,455 an ounce. Silver, too, gained, rising above $70 an ounce.

The abrupt shift caught traders off guard. There had been little sign of diplomatic progress before Trump's post. Just hours earlier, Israel had launched strikes on Iranian infrastructure, and Tehran was retaliating against Gulf nations.

Still, the damage to crude markets may linger well beyond any diplomatic breakthrough. It remains unclear how Iran will respond.

And if talks succeed, reopening the Strait — through which roughly a fifth of global oil supply flows — is unlikely to happen overnight, leaving shipping routes disrupted and energy traders pricing in prolonged supply uncertainty.

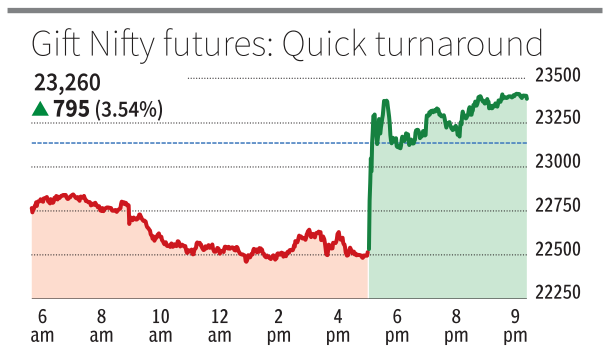
Dialogue, diplomacy are solutions to the Gulf conflict: Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi called for dialogue and diplomacy to end the West Asia conflict, warning that the prolonging crisis was beginning to cast a shadow on global supply chains and India's energy and fertilizer security, even as the government moved to cushion households and farmers from disruptions.

Read more on p3

Gift Nifty recovers, surges 795 points as Dalal Street watches W. Asia moves

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai



With US President Donald Trump extending his 48-hour ultimatum to Iran to a five-day pause, Gift Nifty, along with global stocks, recovered sharply. However, analysts cautioned against reading too much into it.

Currently, Gift Nifty (Mar) futures are trading at about 795 points gain at 23,260 (9:30 pm IST) after recovering to hit a high of 23,500 from the day's low of 22,453.

SENSEX, NIFTY CRASH

Markets are at a critical juncture, with the trajectory of the US/Israel-Iran conflict and crude oil prices set to determine whether a sharp recovery or a deeper slide lies ahead, analysts said, after the Sensex crashed 1,836 points and the Nifty 50 closed at 22,512, its lowest in 11 months on Monday. March is on course to be the worst month for Indian indices since the Covid-19 crash of 2020, with the Nifty down nearly 12 per cent so far this month.

Rajesh Palviya, Head of Research, Axis Securities, said the market remained weak and any sustained recovery hinged entirely on geopolitical developments. "The market is desperate for a sharp up move from the current level... We could see 5-6 per cent kind of jump that cannot be ruled out because the market is highly oversold," he said, adding that a failure to de-escalate could push the Nifty toward the April 2024 low of 21,700–22,000.

Palviya also flagged that supply chain disruptions from the conflict zone would weigh on multiple sectors for one-two quarters. "A lot of money is waiting on the sidelines. The confidence and sentiments are not supportive and that is what everybody is waiting for — some certainty towards the war," he added.

Kranthi Bathini, Director, Equity Strategy, WealthMills Securities, described the current market phase as one of heightened volatility, noting that the Nifty had breached the 23,000 mark over the last 22 trading sessions since the war began. He identified crude oil and the rupee as the twin burdens on Indian markets. Bathini cautioned that while relief rallies were possible, sustainability was the real test.

VIX ON THE RISE

Monday's selloff was broad-based and severe. India VIX surged over 17 per cent to close near 26.8 — its highest since June 2024 — reflecting extreme fear among participants. Nifty Midcap 100 and Nifty Smallcap 100 fell over 3.9 per cent each, and in the Nifty 500 universe, only 15 stocks ended in the green.

Bank Nifty is now down nearly 17 per cent from its all-time high in just 33 trading sessions, with the broader market structure continuing to form lower highs and lower lows.

The rupee hit a new all-time low 93.97 to the dollar.

SEBI board clears tighter conflict code, FPI fund netting

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The SEBI board on Monday adopted a revised conflict-of-interest framework for its chairman, whole-time members (WTMs) and employees, accepting most of the recommendations of a high-level committee but with some modifications on disclosures.

A key change is that detailed disclosures of assets and liabilities of senior officials will remain internal to the Securities and Exchange Board of India, instead of being made public, amid concerns of privacy.

COMPLIANCE PUSH

The board, however, allowed public disclosure of immovable property details. The revised framework, based on the recommendations of a high-level committee, largely retains stricter investment and trading restrictions, brings the chairman and WTMs under the definition of "insider", aligns the definition of "family", and mandates disclosures of future employment negotiations. A digital system for conflict management, whistleblower reporting and ethics training has also been cleared.

It also approved the setting up of an Office of Ethics and Compliance to be overseen by the chief vigilance officer for now, and extended investment restrictions to spouses and dependent family members prospectively, with existing holdings grandfathered.

The notification of the revised framework and the formation of an oversight committee on ethics and compliance have been referred to the Centre.

SPOUSAL INVESTMENT

Addressing concerns around spousal investments in the unlisted space, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said: "Spouses are acting independently on their own resources... You can't circumvent it by putting your money through your spouse." He said that recusals would continue to apply in situations involving relatives or potential conflicts.

On adopting the high-level committee's recommendations, Pandey said the board had chosen to move ahead even where changes had not yet been codified in regulations. Separately, the board approved net settlement of funds for foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) in the cash market, aimed at reducing funding costs and forex outflows. Fund netting allows FPIs to pay or receive only the net difference between buy and sell positions, instead of settling each trade separately.

The framework will be implemented after the system changes, with a deadline of December 31, 2026. Securities will continue to be settled on a gross basis. The regulator also eased the "fit and proper person" norms by removing automatic disqualification based solely on pending complaints or FIRs, while tightening eligibility in cases of convictions for economic offences and securities law violations. Other decisions included measures for AIFs, social impact funds and REITs/InvITs.

More reports on p6

Independent directors must act responsibly, says SEBI chief on HDFC Bank Chairman's exit

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Independent directors must act responsibly and avoid making unsubstantiated remarks, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey has said. His comments follow the abrupt resignation of HDFC Bank's Part-Time Chairman and Independent Director Atanu Chakraborty last week.

Speaking after the SEBI board meeting on Monday, Pandey said independent directors are required to protect the interests of minority shareholders and follow the laid-down process to raise concerns.

'ETHICAL EXIT'

"No one is expected to make insinuations without proper evidence and recordings," the SEBI chief said.

ACCOUNTABILITY FIRST. Independent directors are required to protect the interests of minority shareholders and follow laid-down processes to raise concerns, says Tuhin Kanta Pandey

Chakraborty's sudden exit, citing "ethical differences", triggered a sharp fall in the stock and raised questions over governance, even as the RBI said it found no material concerns.

Pandey said there is a clear framework under the Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) regulations and the Companies Act for independent directors.

"Where independent directors have any concerns about the running of the company... ensure that they are addressed by the board... and if not resolved, insist that their concerns are recorded in the minutes."

RECORD VIOLATIONS

Further, concerns relating to "unethical behaviour, actual or suspected fraud, or violation of the company's code of conduct" must be formally recorded, he said. "We can't keep things vague," he said.

On whether the SEBI will examine the issues raised in Chakraborty's resignation letter, Pandey said he would not "publicly state anything," but added that regulatory obligations would apply.

He also said that the RBI has already taken note of the development. "The primary regulator... has taken note... and also taken due decisions," he said.

Also read p10

QUICKLY.

Sharp partners with Amber Enterprises

New Delhi: Sharp Business Systems (India) Pvt Ltd on Monday said it has tied up with Amber Enterprises India Ltd to locally produce air conditioners in India. The move strengthens the company's expansion plans in one of the world's fastest-growing cooling markets Sharp Business Systems (India) Pvt Ltd, the wholly owned Indian arm of Japan's Sharp Corporation, said in a statement.

Over the next five years, the company aims to capture a 2-3 per cent share of the Indian air conditioner market, which is estimated to have crossed annual sales of 1 crore units mark, by expanding its product portfolio and strengthening its distribution network across the country. OUR BUREAU

OMCs to push for more LPG storage

WEST ASIA FALLOUT. Oil marketing firms mulling more caverns for storing gas on the lines of existing ones

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

As the West Asia conflict intensifies fuelling uncertainty about de-escalation, oil marketing companies (OMCs) are now aggressively pursuing plans to set up storage sites for liquefied petroleum gas (LPG), the most impacted commodity by the conflict.

Sources said that OMCs have been contemplating establishing more caverns for storing LPG, on the lines of the two caverns India has that can store a cumulative quantity of around 1.40 lakh tonnes.

"OMCs have been working for some time on plans for having more caverns or sites to store LPG. The war has severely impacted India's imports. Consequently, they are now moving aggressively on this as a medium-to-long-term strategy...," said one of the sources.

This has also been discussed in the Prime Minister's Office (PMO). Storage for crude oil and LPG are now a priority, given the source added.

India already has two caverns to store the critical commodity, which is the main cooking medium for more than 33 crore consumers. State-run Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) has an 80,000-tonne underground LPG rock cavern in Mangaluru. South Asia LPG — a JV of HPCL and TotalEnergies Marketing Holdings India — has a 60,000-tonne cavern in Visakhapatnam.

CRYOGENIC UNITS

Globally, there are more than 80 LPG storage caverns. Underground caverns are among the safest options to store the commodity. As a pressurised propane-butane mix, LPG requires costly high-pressure or cryogenic facilities.

A senior official said the push to have more storage is getting priority now due to the "current crisis".

"The government's objective now, more than ever, is to establish storages. The present hostilities have made it quite clear that large consuming nations today have to have storages. This is pertinent not just from the perspective of energy security, but also for strategic autonomy to some extent to deal with frequent weaponisation of such resources," the official explained.

The government keeps replenishing stocks in the LPG caverns. For instance, it said on March 16 that the very large gas carrier (VLGC), Shivalik which crossed the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) and reached India with 46,000 tonnes of LPG, will unload 26,000 tonnes at HPCL's cavern in Mangaluru.

The country imports 60 per cent of its demand for the key cooking fuel. India consumed more than 33 million tonnes (mt) of LPG in FY25, of which roughly 20.67 mt was imported. Around 90 per cent of this was imported from West Asia transiting the SoH.

LIFE LINE. The critical commodity is the main cooking medium for more than 33 crore consumers ALLEN EGENUSE J

CRUDE OIL

Sources said the government is also pushing for more cavern storage for crude oil. It is now fast-tracking the setting up of strategic petroleum reserves (SPR) at Odisha and Karnataka. Besides, the assessment of new sites for establishing additional crude oil reserves is ongoing. In July 2021, the Oil Ministry approved the establishment of two additional commercial-cum-strategic petroleum reserve facilities with total storage capacity of 6.5 mt in Odisha and Karnataka, on a public-private partnership mode at a total project cost of ₹14,527 crore.

This is being overseen by the special purpose vehicle (SPV), Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserve (ISPRL), which has already established SPR facilities of 5.33 mt crude oil at three locations in Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka.

Jaiprakash bid: Vedanta needs to prove CoC decision was arbitrary

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Vedanta's decision to move the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal against NCLT order approving the Adani group's bid for Jaiprakash Associates may not cut ice as the tribunal has little powers to question the commercial wisdom of lenders, say legal experts.

Vedanta has argued in its appeal that lenders violated the principle of maximising value through a fair process.

The company had emerged as the highest bidder with an offer of ₹12,506 crore on a net present value (NPV) basis.

Despite this, lenders approved a rival plan which, according to Vedanta, was lower by about ₹3,400 crore in total value and ₹500 crore in NPV.

The company also alleged procedural unfairness, stating it was not given reasons or an opportunity to clarify its proposal.

UPFRONT CASH

Last November, Vedanta sweetened its offer by increasing upfront cash to about ₹6,563 crore and equity infusion to ₹800 crore.

However, lenders had preferred Adani's bid as it offered about ₹6,000 crore upfront and faster payments in two years, compared with Vedanta's longer payment timeline of up to five years.

Lenders also rejected Vedanta's revised offer stating it was submitted after bidding had closed and accepting it would require restarting the process.

Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner, KS Legal & Associates said unless Vedanta demonstrates that the CoC's decision was arbitrary, discriminatory or in breach of the CIRP framework, the NCLAT is unlikely to substitute its own view merely on the ground of a higher bid, as that would undermine the settled principle that commercial wisdom of creditors is paramount.

The lenders' preference for Adani over Vedanta, despite a higher bid on paper, is entirely consistent with the commercial wisdom doctrine under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, where value is not assessed in mere arithmetic terms but in certainty, timelines, funding structure and execution capability, she said.

ASSET VALUE

Financial creditors are entitled to discount a numerically superior offer if it carries higher conditionality, regulatory overhang, or financing risk particularly in large, infrastructure-heavy resolutions such as Jaiprakash Associates, where delayed implementation can erode asset value rapidly, she added.

Vedanta's bid may have appeared higher, but if lenders perceived Adani's plan as more bankable, cleaner in structure, or backed by stronger funding visibility and sectoral synergies, their choice would be legally insulated, said Chandwani.

INOX India targets ₹1,600 crore revenue in FY26

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

As West Asia tensions unsettle LNG markets, INOX India, which derives nearly a third of its order book from LNG infrastructure, is looking to diversify its revenue base, leaning on industrial gases and specialised engineering to sustain growth.

The Vadodara-based cryogenic equipment maker posted revenue of around ₹1,350 crore in FY25 and is targeting ₹1,600 crore in FY26.

At 18–20 per cent annual growth, it is on track to approach ₹2,000 crore within two years, company officials told *businessline*. "From a two-litre container storing bull semen to a 400-tonne vessel, we are a supermarket of cryogenic equipment," CEO Deepak Acharya said, highlighting the breadth of its portfolio.

Recent performance underscores the momentum. INOX India reported revenue of ₹436 crore in Q3 FY26, up 27 per cent year-on-year, with exports accounting for 62 per cent of the total.

For the first nine months of FY26, total income rose 20 per cent to ₹1,157 crore, while adjusted net profit increased 23.7 per cent to ₹189 crore.

An order backlog of ₹1,450–1,500 crore provides 9–10 months of revenue visibility, with industrial gases accounting for 47 per cent, followed by LNG infrastructure (31 per cent) and cryogenic scientific applications (23 per cent).

India's expanding use of LNG in long-haul transport and industrial logistics continues to support a steady share of INOX's business. The company has built a presence in LNG semi-trailers, vacuum-insulated tanks used to transport liquefied gas, and has developed specialised fuel tanks for heavy-duty vehicles.

It has also supplied cryogenic tanks for India's first PESO-approved LNG-powered tanker used in industrial gas logistics.

HYDROGEN/HIGH-TECH

INOX is building capabilities in hydrogen infrastructure, manufacturing storage tanks and transport systems for liquid hydrogen, which must be stored at around –253°C.

"Hydrogen is the ultimate fuel, but the cost will determine how fast it scales," Acharya said, indicating that commercial viability remains some years away.

On the high-technology front, the company's work on the ITER nuclear fusion programme in France has generated over ₹650 crore in business, with annual visibility of ₹80–100 crore.

It is also involved in air-independent propulsion systems for Indian Navy submarines. New verticals are adding scale. In beverage kegs, INOX is targeting up to one million units annually, a ₹400–500 crore opportunity with approvals from global brewers such as Heineken and AB InBev.

CHIP PLAY

The semiconductor segment, currently contributing ₹80-100 crore, is expected to grow as new fabrication plants come online, with INOX supplying specialised containers for ultra-high purity gases. "With a portfolio spanning LNG logistics, hydrogen infrastructure and advanced scientific projects, we are positioning ourselves across multiple growth engines even as global energy markets remain volatile," CEO Acharya said.

Iran war brings coal back to the fore as an alternative energy source

Richa Mishra
Hyderabad

The intensifying conflict in West Asia, which has significantly impacted global energy markets, has forced a strategic shift toward coal as a reliable alternative to oil and natural gas.

ANALYSIS.

Coal demand has seen a surge amid the West Asia conflict, driven by disruptions in liquefied natural gas (LNG) supplies. India relies heavily on coal for power generation.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in Lok Sabha on Monday, said, "adequate coal stocks are available at all power plants across the country and that India has set a record of producing 100 crore tonnes of coal for the second consecutive year."

Modi highlighted that power generation and supply are being continuously monitored and that the government's preparedness has been significantly bolstered by the strides made in renewable energy over the past decade.

About half of India's total installed power generation capacity now comes from renewable sources with total renewable capacity crossing 250 GW.

On Sunday, the Prime Minister chaired a meeting of the Cabinet Committee on Security to review the ongoing and proposed measures in the context of ongoing West Asia conflict.

A detailed assessment of the availability of food, energy and fuel security was made.

Short-, medium- and long-term measures to ensure availability of essential needs were discussed, according to an official release.

"It was also determined that adequate supply of coal stocks at all power plants will ensure no shortage of electricity in India," the statement said.

On whether the world is prepared to give prime importance to coal again, given the transition to green energy narrative, Aruna Sharma, Practitioner Development Economist and former Secretary, Govt of India, said, "The prime guiding factor should be self sufficiency. Coal converted to sun-gas is an alternative for industrial process to reduce dependency on natural gas. For consumption, the option is not just coal but also solar-based cookers, and the grid to give cheaper electricity for induction-based cooking. Both these alternatives are carbon emission friendly."

OUTPUT BOOST

India is also boosting domestic coal production. The government has invoked emergency provisions to maximise coal output, with Coal India Ltd planning 29 e-auctions in March, offering 23.56 million tonnes of coal. Besides this, CIL's in-situ coal exposure was 55 mt — that is coal for ready extraction at short notice. According to CIL officials, the production was nearly at 743 mt; stocks at pitheads were around 127 mt, while the total coal offtake was around 724 mt.

EXPLORING OPTIONS. The Centre has invoked emergency provisions to maximise output, with Coal India planning 29 e-auctions in March, offering 23.56 million tonnes

The coal inventory — domestic as well as imported stocks at power plants — was 58 mt (as on March 21). The stock at the current rate of consumption would last for 24 days.

The total coal fired plants in India, according to CEA, are 189 — 172 domestic and 17 imported. So there is sufficient coal available to meet any summer spike in demand. Besides, CIL is ensuring coal availability to small, medium, and other consumers through state nominated agencies and has asked States to specify additional requirements.

According to Sharma, "India is blessed with thermal coal for 50 years and will and should be the primary fuel source for industry and power generation. Syn gas needs to be encouraged, perhaps with some tax exemption."

Domestic fuel usage is seeing a shift to induction, electric-based cooking in ovens and airfriers, and to wood in villages.

On coal prices, Sharma said, "Having sufficient thermal coal will keep a check on prices if the government can curb profiteering. Our objectives have to be clear. Coal-based sub gas for industry should be incentivised, solar cookers for domestic use products (we are surplus in power generation) and for long-term pipes under sea for fuel and natural gas requirements."

According to Tom Seng, Assistant Professor of Energy Finance at Texas Christian University, Fort Worth, Texas US, "I have to assume we will see a similar increase in its usage that we saw in both India and China after Russia invaded Ukraine. It's going to be the normal reaction to maintain any level of economic growth.

The Trump Administration has been promoting power generation with coal in the US even before the Iran war. Of course, coal prices could rise with any sudden increase in consumption."

PEAK POWER DEMAND

Going ahead, India will rely more heavily on coal fired generation to meet peak electricity demand.

Pritish Raj, Senior Manager, Asia and EMEA Thermal Coal, S&P Global Energy, said, "India is likely to rely more heavily on coal-fired generation to meet peak electricity demand this summer as tight LNG supplies and higher spot prices make gas-based power uneconomic for most utilities."

"Gas-fired plants in India typically play a marginal but strategic role during periods of peak demand, particularly during summer when cooling demand surges and renewable output declines mainly in the evening hours. However, even under normal conditions, gas-based generation remains significantly more expensive than coal, and with LNG markets tightening amid the West Asia geopolitical disruptions, generators are likely to avoid running gas plants unless absolutely necessary," he said.

FREIGHT COSTS

There could be some incremental demand for imported coal. Price is also driven partly by higher freight costs and disruptions due to restrictions around the Strait of Hormuz. India has been prioritising domestic coal usage, reducing import dependency and improving logistics. Coal demand from the power sector is expected to increase, with thermal plants operating at relatively high utilisation rates during the summer months.

Wipro expands South Korea presence, launches innovation lab in Seoul

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Wipro announced the expansion of its business in South Korea, which includes an enlarged office footprint in Seoul, the launch of a new Innovation Lab, as part of the Wipro Innovation Network (WIN), and continued investment in local talent to support South Korean clients locally and globally.

South Korea has emerged as a major global innovation hub, with leadership across semiconductors, advanced technology, automotive engineering, and industrial manufacturing.

Wipro's expanded presence reflects the growing importance of S. Korea in shaping global innovation and the increasing demand from South Korean enterprises for AI-led transformation.

Wipro employs several hundred professionals in South Korea and serves South Korean clients through a local presence, complemented by its global Wipro Delivery Network.

This integrated delivery model enables Korean enterprises to access specialised skills, industry expertise, and scalable global capabilities, while retaining close local engagement. In parallel, Wipro is partnering with leading academic institutions to upskill talent and create opportunities for early career professionals to work on advanced technology and innovation programmes. Speaking about the inauguration ceremony in Seoul, Vinay Firake, CEO of APMEA (Asia Pacific, India, Middle East, and Africa) Strategic Market Unit, Wipro Ltd, said, "South Korea is a strategic growth market for Wipro..."

SK Minerals eyes JVs in Saudi Arabia, Japan, S. Korea

Our Bureau
Kolkata

SK Minerals & Additives is looking to enter into a joint venture partnership or collaboration with companies in Saudi Arabia, Japan and South Korea for developing technical expertise and tap into the export potential of its halogen-free flame retardants under the polymer additives segment.

The firm claims to be the first in India to manufacture halogen-free flame retardants.

According to Mohit Jindal, Chairman and Managing Director, SK Minerals, there is huge demand for flame retardants in the Middle East, Europe and US markets. The JV will help the company tap into this demand by providing necessary marketing support and infrastructure.

"Through this collaboration we are looking for market outreach. Some of these companies have been working for more than 50 years in this segment and have marketing offices throughout the world. We believe the partnership will give us easier and quicker access to some of these markets. We are also looking for technical knowhow and support from the JV partner so as to enable us to match the European standards in flame retardant which is a bit more technical and regulated," Jindal told *businessline*.

ECO-FRIENDLY

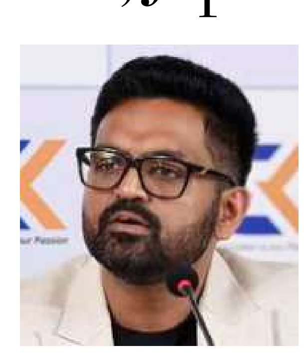
Halogen-free flame retardants are eco-friendly, non-toxic chemical compounds used in electrical and electronic products, automotive and transportation products, construction and infrastructure products and textiles and furniture foams to increase their fire resistance and reduce smoke and heat release, avoiding hazardous halogen gases.

SK Minerals will initially use its flame retardants product for the wire and cable industries and electronic equipment, and gradually expand to other industries after increasing its manufacturing capacity.

FLAME RETARDANTS

Flame retardants are indispensable for regulatory compliance, as they require manufacturers to meet rigorous national and international fire safety standards globally and India's specific norms. The company currently works on these certifications for India.

However, the European market requires different certifications, which are a notch higher. Once it achieves standardisation of the product, the JV might explore the possibility of setting up another manufacturing unit either in India or overseas to tap into the export markets.



Mohit Jindal, Chairman and MD, SK Minerals

On expanding manufacturing capacity of SK Minerals, Jindal said the company is looking to scale up the capacity by around five-fold from the current 3,600 metric tonnes to close to 19,000 metric tonnes per annum in the next 12-18 months. A majority of this expansion would be towards manufacturing flame retardant and plastic compounding products.

The company is one of the leading manufacturers of feed additives, food preservatives and polymer additives and trader of specialty industrial chemicals in the country.

It has acquired a 10-acre plot for setting up a 10,000 metric tonne unit, which is expected to be operational by March 2027. "Our installed capacity is currently under expansion and is expected to increase up to 5,400 tonnes per annum. It is expected to increase to 19,000 tonnes per annum by March 2027," the Chairman added. The company, which clocked a turnover of around ₹212 crore in FY25, is looking to close the current fiscal at around ₹310 crore to ₹320 crore.

PM calls for dialogue, diplomacy to de-escalate the conflict in West Asia

RISING STAKES. Prolonged crisis, now beyond three weeks, has begun to exert pressure on economies: Modi

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday called for dialogue and diplomacy to end the ongoing conflict in West Asia, warning that the prolonged crisis was beginning to cast a shadow on global supply chains and India's energy and fertilizer security, even as the government moved to cushion households and farmers from disruptions.

Speaking in the Lok Sabha, the Prime Minister said that every Indian effort is directed at de-escalation and the cessation of hostilities. "India's effort is to encourage all parties to arrive at a peaceful resolution as soon as possible," he said.

ADDRESSING CONCERNS. Prime Minister Narendra Modi speaking in the Lok Sabha on Monday during the second part of the Budget Session of Parliament PTI

Informing the House that he has engaged with all relevant West Asian leaders and urged them to reduce tensions and end the conflict, he emphasised that attacks on commercial ships and obstruction of international waterways such as the Strait of Hormuz was wholly unacceptable. "India, through diplomacy, is making continuous efforts for the safe passage of Indian ships even amidst the war environment," he said.

Addressing apprehensions of fuel shortage, he said the government is in constant touch with suppliers from various countries to ensure that oil and gas supplies continue from wherever possible and informed that all power plants in the country have adequate coal stock. He also said that India is well prepared in terms of food security.

FOCUS AREAS

He termed the ongoing conflict as "worrisome" and said the challenges posed by the crisis have economic, national security and humanitarian aspects. Modi said India has more than 5.3 million tonnes (mt) of strategic petroleum reserves, and the country is also working on arrangements for more than 6.5 mt of additional storage. Apart from this, he said, there were reserves held by the domestic oil companies.

The Prime Minister said the conflict, now stretching beyond three weeks, has begun to exert pressure on economies worldwide. He noted that India's concerns were particularly high given the country's deep commercial links with the region and the presence of nearly one crore Indians living and working across Gulf nations. A large number of Indian crew also serve on commercial vessels operating in the region, adding to the stakes for India.

Modi drew attention to disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, a key artery for India's imports. "A large quantity of essential items such as crude oil, gas and fertilizers come to India through the Strait of Hormuz. Since the war began, the movement of ships through the Strait of Hormuz has become highly challenging," he said.

Drawing parallels with the disruptions seen during the Covid-19 pandemic, the Prime Minister said the current situation demanded a similar level of preparedness and unity. He urged Parliament to send a unanimous message to the world, stressing that India had consistently advocated peace and that dialogue remained the only viable path to resolution. A substantial portion of the Prime Minister's address centred on fertilizer supplies, reflecting concerns about the upcoming kharif season. Recalling the pandemic years, he said the government had shielded farmers from global price spikes by maintaining heavy subsidies.

India, Russia reaffirm $100 b trade goal due to geopolitical tensions

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India and Russia have called for strengthening bilateral economic and strategic ties amid the West Asia crisis and shifting geopolitical alignments, reaffirming their commitment to the $100-billion bilateral trade target by 2030.

Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov, on Monday, said Prime Minister Narendra Modi was expected to visit Russia in 2026 and asserted that there was close foreign policy coordination between the two countries amid the West Asia crisis "provoked" by the US and Israel. As much as 96 per cent of bilateral trade was already happening in national currencies, he said.

Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar noted that in the evolving geopolitical dynamics, engagement between the two countries continues to deepen driven by frequent high-level exchanges. "Both sides are committed to increasing the present annual trade from $68.7 billion to $100 billion by 2030 in a balanced and sustainable manner. To this effect, we must continue efforts to conclude India – EAEU (Russia-led bloc) FTA, address non-tariff barriers and regulatory impediments and utilise skilled Indian workforce," he said.

Both Jaishankar and Lavrov were virtually addressing the conference "India and Russia: Towards a New Bilateral Agenda" on Monday.

Referring to the last visit of Russian President Vladimir Putin to India in December 2025, Jaishankar said it broke new ground covering diverse and novel areas, including mobility of skilled professionals, health & food safety, maritime cooperation, fertilizers, customs and commerce, and academic and media cooperation.

PAYMENT CHANNELS

"We look forward to welcoming Prime Minister Narendra Modi to Russia in 2026," Lavrov said.

To ensure smooth trade amid payment sanctions against Russia, Lavrov indicated that the system of direct settlements was moving along.

"We will also continue to improve the system of direct settlements: already today, 96 per cent of trade is conducted in national currencies," he added.

This transition has been facilitated through mechanisms such as special vostro accounts held by Russian banks in India, allowing payments to be routed outside traditional Western financial channels. Lavrov blamed the US and Israel for "provoking" the political crisis in West Asia and said India and Russia were committed to democratisation of international relations on the basis of UN principles.

Company Law Amendment Bill sent to JPC amid stiff opposition

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on Monday and sent to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) for further deliberations, after the Opposition's strong criticism of the Bill.

The Bill prescribes enabling provisions to permit companies and Limited Liability Partnerships (LLPs) in International Financial Services Centres to transact and maintain books in permitted foreign currencies. At the same time, it provides a framework for conversion of specified trusts into LLPs.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman introduced the Bill; however, it was strongly opposed by Manish Tewari of the Congress. "Core policy matters such as classification of companies, exemptions, determination of compliance requirements, threshold for corporate social responsibility (CSR), audit obligations and penalty frameworks are left to subordinate legislation through repeated use, as may be prescribed provisions without adequate legislation guidance," he alleged. TMC's Saugata Roy and DMK's T Sumathi, too, joined him.

In response, Sitharaman said the Bill had come to the House after two years of deliberation. "The recommendations of the Company Law Committee (CLC) and its reports have been taken on board. CLC had representatives from industry chambers and professional institutes, legal and accounting experts," she said. On the issue of lowering the threshold for CSR, she said the members' apprehensions were unfounded, as the Bill only seeks to amend the criteria of net profits, not the entire clause related to CSR.

Sitharaman then suggested to Speaker Om Birla that the Bill be sent to a JPC for deliberations and proper suggestions.

At this, Tewari said since a Parliamentary Standing Committee on Corporate Affairs is already in place, the Bill should be sent to that panel, rather than constituting a new JPC.

Home Minister Amit Shah intervened, saying none of the opposition members had spoken about referring the legislation to a parliamentary committee, and now, when the Finance Minister herself had sought it, they were arguing as to which panel the Bill should be sent to. Speaker Birla then put the Finance Minister's proposal to a vote, which was approved by a voice vote by the House, sending the Bill to a JPC whose members will be selected later.

KEY PROVISIONS

Meanwhile, the amendments provide for decriminalisation of procedural defaults, by replacing criminal provisions with civil penalties. Procedures related to mergers and amalgamations are proposed to be simplified through rationalisation of approval thresholds for fast-track mergers and enabling filing of applications before a single bench of the National Company Law Tribunal having jurisdiction over the transferee company.

Domestic LPG production ramped up to 50-60% of demand; two carriers to deliver 92,613 tonnes

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

As the conflict in West Asia rages on completely skewing India's liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) imports, the government's emergency measures seem to be bearing fruit, as domestic production of the critical cooking fuel is now around 50-60 per cent of demand, compared to roughly 40 per cent before February 28, 2026 — the day when the latest US-Israel offensive on Iran started.

Parallelly, two very large gas carriers (VLGCs) with roughly 92,613 tonnes of LPG transited the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) on Monday evening towards India. By March-end, India is likely to have received a total of around 2.5-2.75 lakh tonnes of LPG. Besides, seven VLGCs with an expected 3.22

lakh tonnes are idling in the Persian Gulf awaiting transit via the strait.

Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas Joint Secretary Sujata Sharma, during the briefing on West Asia on Monday, said that LPG supply continues to be monitored in view of the prevailing geopolitical situation.

However, no dry-outs have been reported at distributorships and panic bookings have reduced significantly, and domestic LPG cylinder deliveries continue as normal, she added.

Asked about the progress in LPG production, Sharma noted, "I think right now, our domestic production is accounting for something between 50 and 60 per cent of our demand."

India consumed around 33 million tonnes (mt) LPG in FY25. A back of the envelope calculation shows that India's average daily production could be in the range of 45,200-54,200 tonnes.

MIGRATION TO PNG

Sharma informed that close to 1.9 lakh LPG consumers migrated to piped natural gas (PNG) in the last few days. Besides, more than 3.5 lakh domestic and commercial PNG connections have been activated since the latest offensive started.

Rakesh Kumar Sinha, Special Secretary at the Shipping Ministry, said that there has been no change in vessel deployment over the past 48 hours, with 22 Indian-flagged vessels and around 600 Indian seafarers currently in the western Persian Gulf region. Eleven seafarers have signed off and are being repatriated as per standard procedures.

The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways said that two Indian flag LPG carriers — *Jag Vasant* and *Pine Gas* — carrying 92,612.59 tonnes have transited through the SoH on Monday evening.

These vessels are destined for India and are likely to reach ports between March 26 and 28.

Twenty States and UTs have issued orders to allocate the non-domestic LPG in line with the guidelines issued by the government.

Rupee breaches the 94/dollar mark intra-day

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The rupee breached the 94 per dollar mark on Monday as the West Asia war continued to rage, leading to hardening of crude oil prices and FPIs persisting with selling in the domestic equity markets. Yields of government securities (G-Secs) jumped due to the possibility that rising crude oil prices could stoke inflation.

The rupee closed at a new all-time low of 93.98 per dollar, down 27 paise over the previous close of 93.71. Intra-day, it touched a low of 94.01 per dollar.

Siddhartha Khemka, Head of Research, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, noted that currency markets reflected the stress arising from the escalating tensions between the US and Iran, with the rupee depreciating to a record low against the dollar, pressured by elevated crude prices and persistent foreign outflows. FPIs remained net sellers, with cumulative outflows of ₹90,152 crore in March so far, adding to market pressure.

FUTURE TENSE

SBI, in a report, said, "Since the start of the West Asia war, the rupee has depreciated 2.74 per cent in just 21 days! Presently, one year NDF (non-deliverable forward) is trading at ₹96.43 while most volatility remains concentrated in near-term NDFs."

It assessed that if the war continues for another month, the rupee might cross ₹96/$; if the war stops in another 7-10 days, the rupee is likely to be largely trading in the ₹91.5-94.5/$ range.

thehindubusinessline.
TUESDAY - MARCH 24, 2026

Plane truths

Airline ticket pricing should be transparent and fair

The Centre is justified in protecting passenger interests, by mandating that airlines make available at least 60 per cent of flight seats 'free' — that is, with no add-ons to the ticket price. The additional charges for such premium seats — which are typically towards the front of the aircraft or alongside windows and the aisle —sometimes account for between 5-10 per cent of the total fare. By also directing airlines to seat passengers on the same PNR together, the government has removed a pain point for travellers.

The new rules may not significantly impact finances of airlines as ancillary revenues — including seat prices, food and beverages and excess baggage — do not exceed 10 per cent of total revenues, in general. But they make a world of difference to passengers. There are two consumer concerns here: the price being paid; and whether this is disclosed upfront or concealed in hidden charges, only to be revealed when the 'payment' window comes up, as for example, convenience fee. Indeed, it is compelling to argue that in a free market, the government should not meddle with pricing decisions of business, but leave it to market forces instead. However, the question here is whether free market forces are really working in a duopoly market, one in which IndiGo is way ahead of Air India. To be sure, there have been both demand and supply side factors driving up prices. Geo-political disruptions have upset flight schedules and costs, while passenger traffic too has been rising sharply. Even in a more competitive market, prices would have risen; the question is, whether episodic price spurts are justified, and whether the consumer is duly informed about hidden charges while purchasing the ticket.

India is not alone in the matter of dealing with flyer-unfriendly practices. In 2024, the US' Department of Transportation came down on 'drip' pricing practices of airlines there and required the display of all fees at one go, though this was challenged in court. The UK issued similar norms on transparent pricing under a 2022 Act. The European Court of Justice recently ruled that airlines must refund the full amount paid — including booking fees — rather than slice up charges. The Centre should ask airlines and booking platforms to display the full cost of a ticket at the beginning of the booking process, rather than conceal it in convenience fees or seat pricing.

Rising passenger traffic conceals the fact that consumers are not a homogeneous lot — they could be corporate/institutional travellers, tourists, or budget-strapped individuals and families. Therefore, having more free seats is only fair. However, price regulation should be a light-touch affair — to monitor any unusual spike in prices, or hidden charges, while at the same time allowing demand and supply to adjust. In the long run, the best deal for consumers is to have more airlines. A level-playing field for smaller airlines is being attempted, but there's a long runway ahead.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

Development funding: UK's meanness is shortsighted

Progress is possible. Over two decades, global child mortality plummeted. There were many reasons for a 39% reduction in deaths in lower and middle income countries between 2001 and 2021, but a significant one was overseas development aid, which supported everything from sanitation to vaccination programmes to food security. That shift has slowed, and – like similar advances – is likely to reverse if aid budgets continue to be slashed. Researchers warned last month that continuing cuts could result in more than 22 million avoidable deaths in the next five years, with a quarter of those among children under five. The UK's decision to slash aid by 40% is part of a global trend: G7 spending will be 28% lower this year than in 2024. Donald Trump has dismantled USAID; Germany, France and others are chopping their budgets. But Britain's case is particularly dismaying. A bipartisan consensus saw David Cameron, building on Gordon Brown's work, make Britain the first G7 country to hit the internationally agreed aid target of 0.7% of gross national income (GNI). LONDON, MARCH 22

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL. EUROPE

The Tragedy of Robert Mueller

Robert Mueller, who died Friday at age 81, served his country as a Marine and as the second-longest-serving director of the Federal Bureau of Investigation. The tragedy of his legacy is that he agreed to lead the probe into whether Donald Trump colluded with Russia to win the 2016 election. Robert S. Mueller III was born in Manhattan in 1944, the son of a DuPont executive. He attended Princeton, but when a classmate was killed in Vietnam in 1967, he joined the Marines. He was wounded and returned to the battlefield. This noble contrast with so many others of his generation couldn't be greater. NEW YORK, MARCH 22

Is the private credit boom going bust?

BRIAN JUDGE

STRUCTURAL ISSUES. Signs of strain are already showing. The deals lack transparency, with layers of leverage, widespread self-dealing and offshore regulatory arbitrage

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

A defining feature of financial markets is that the most important information is often held by those least likely to reveal it. The system's inner workings are invisible to outside observers — which makes it all the more striking when leading Wall Street executives start sounding the alarm.

In October, JPMorgan Chase CEO Jamie Dimon warned of "cockroaches" lurking in the private credit market. His remarks quickly reverberated across the industry, with UBS Chairman Colm Kelleher pointing to the "looming systemic risk" posed by poorly regulated private credit, which he likened to the rating-agency failures that helped trigger the 2008 financial crisis. At its core, private credit is lending that takes place outside the traditional banking system. Loans are made by investment funds, often managed by firms that specialise in corporate buyouts.

Unlike bank loans or publicly traded bonds, these deals lack transparent pricing, an active secondary market, and meaningful regulatory oversight. Terms are negotiated privately, valuations are set internally, and the investors whose money is at risk — often pensioners and insurance policyholders — have virtually no ability to verify any of it.

Despite — or perhaps because of this opacity — private credit grew rapidly after the 2008 crisis, as banks pulled back from riskier lending and private credit funds rushed to fill the vacuum. Today, the industry manages roughly $3.5 trillion.

The rise of private credit is often framed as a story of financial innovation, with traditional banks retreating and nimbler private lenders stepping in. But a closer look reveals a troubling, eerily familiar pattern: layers of leverage, widespread self-dealing, offshore regulatory arbitrage, and a feedback loop that ties the savings of millions of retirees to risky bets on AI data centres, leveraged software companies, and bundled loans marketed as safe investments.

Much of this activity is driven by private equity. When private-equity firms acquire companies, they typically rely on debt provided by private credit funds. But the initial buyout is just the beginning, as portfolio companies often undergo multiple rounds of borrowing to finance additional acquisitions, re-financings, dividend recapitalisations, and restructurings.

A single deal can therefore generate several separate transactions. In many cases, the lender and the private-equity sponsor are affiliated, allowing the same parent company to collect fees on both sides of the deal while deploying other people's money — namely, retirees who believe their savings are safe.

Over the past decade, large alternative-asset managers have taken this model a step further by acquiring life-insurance companies. Apollo's 2022 merger with Athene, which has roughly $400 billion in assets and serves more than 535,000 policyholders, helped set the template: insurers provide a steady stream of capital, and affiliated asset managers channel it into private credit, with profits generated at every step, from insurance float to deal fees and carried interest. Nearly every major alternative-asset manager has since followed suit.

Traditional banks making similar loans operate under strict capital requirements. Unlike private credit funds, they must hold reserves against potential losses, submit to regulatory

> **Whether turmoil in private credit markets could trigger a broader financial crisis is impossible** to know in advance, but that uncertainty is itself part of the risk

scrutiny that can force write-downs, recognise losses before borrowers default, and undergo stress tests whose results are publicly disclosed. Against this backdrop, it is hardly reassuring that roughly one-third of the US life-insurance industry's $6 trillion in assets is now invested in private credit.

BERMUDA TRIANGLE STRATEGY

To boost returns, these firms employ what industry analysts call the "Bermuda Triangle" strategy, whereby a single sponsor controls three interlinked entities: a life insurer, an asset manager, and an offshore reinsurer. The insurer gathers premiums; the asset manager channels those funds into private credit deals it originates and prices; and the reinsurer — typically based in Bermuda or the Cayman Islands — assumes the insurer's liabilities under looser capital requirements than those imposed by US regulators.

The system is already showing signs of strain. Software companies, long a favoured target for private-equity buyouts because of their steady revenues and low capital expenditures, are being repriced as AI threatens widespread disruption. Private credit funds' exposure to the sector is an estimated $600-750 billion, fuelling liquidity pressures. Blue Owl recently restricted withdrawals from a $1.7 billion retail fund, and Blackstone's BCRED has recorded its largest net outflows since its inception. The shares of publicly traded alternative-asset managers have also fallen sharply.

These developments highlight a deeper structural problem. When the same firm originates a loan, holds it in a fund it manages, values it using its own models, and reports that value to an insurer it owns, the result is unlikely to reflect what an independent buyer would pay.

Whether turmoil in private credit markets could trigger a broader financial crisis is impossible to know in advance, but that uncertainty is itself part of the risk. Before 2008, few observers understood how vulnerabilities in the US subprime-mortgage market could cascade through the global financial system. There is no reason to assume that we have a better view of the risks in private credit markets today.

To be sure, none of this means a financial crisis is inevitable. But it does suggest that risk has migrated into less transparent structures, subject to lighter regulation yet still tied to government guarantees. The gains accrue to Wall Street, while the potential losses may once again fall on retirees and state insurance systems. In that sense, the echoes of 2008 are becoming hard to ignore.

The writer is Research Director of the Program on Finance and Democracy at the University of California, Berkeley. Copyright: Project Syndicate, 2026. www.project-syndicate.org

A national water vision for Viksit Bharat

Water governance must become climate-resilient with women playing a central role in it

Nilanjan Ghosh

India is already approaching the threshold of water stress. The paradox is stark: a country endowed with major river systems is confronting intensifying scarcity, conflict, and ecological stress. The explanation lies not in the lack of water but in how it is governed.

Water in India refuses to obey political boundaries. Rivers traverse States; groundwater interacts with surface flows; and water simultaneously serves agriculture, industry, cities, and ecosystems.

Yet governance remains fragmented across ministries, sectors, and States. Decisions taken upstream — diversions, dams, pollution — generate downstream consequences that are rarely internalised. A single ecological system is governed by disconnected administrative silos.

Climate change is only aggravating the problem. Variability in rainfall, more frequent floods and droughts, and shifting hydrological cycles are rendering static governance frameworks obsolete.

Agricultural incentives, particularly minimum support prices, have entrenched water-intensive cropping patterns. Food security has been pursued through paddy and wheat, but at the cost of groundwater depletion and river basin stress.

For decades, India's response has been guided by the "arithmetic hydrology" paradigm — a reductionist belief that water challenges can be solved through supply augmentation. Large dams, canals, and extraction systems have expanded availability in the short run, but often at the cost of long-term sustainability. Sediment flows have been disrupted, ecosystems degraded, and flood risks heightened. The "arithmetic hydrology" paradigm has also promoted the simplified linear thinking of "more water, more crops, more growth". However, if only today's water problems could have been expressed in the framework of the ordinate and the abscissa, they would have been solved by linear algebra only – they would have ceased to be complex problems.

The moment now calls for a decisive change. India needs a coherent National Water Vision aligned with its Viksit Bharat aspirations. Here are the 12 tenets of the National Water Vision.

12 TENETS

First, the river basin should be the unit of governance. Basin-level governance institutions must replace fragmented, State-centric approaches.

Second, water must be recognised as a dynamic socio-ecological flow rather than a static stock. Surface water, groundwater, sediments, biodiversity, and energy are parts of interconnected systems, with disruptions in one

WATER. Looming crisis PTI

element cascading across the system. Governance must embrace this complexity.

Third, India must operationalise Integrated Water Resource Management at the basin scale by aligning agriculture, urban development, industry, and ecosystems within a common framework.

Fourth, empowered River Basin Authorities, multidisciplinary expertise, and transparent data systems should replace the prevailing model of conflictual federalism evident in recurring inter-State disputes.

Fifth, water must be valued, as a free or underpriced resource is subjected to systematic overuse and misallocation.

Sixth, this creates space for market-based instruments like water credits, tradable permits, and water derivatives, which can align incentives for conservation and efficient allocation.

Seventh, environmental flows must be placed at the centre of policy. Rivers are living systems that sustain agriculture, livelihoods, and biodiversity. Ignoring these functions undermines development itself.

Eighth, India must shift from supply augmentation to demand management. Efficiency gains, crop diversification, and behavioural change can deliver water security without perpetually expanding infrastructure.

Ninth, governance must be data-driven. Basin-level information systems integrating hydrological, ecological, and socio-economic data are critical for informed decision-making.

Tenth, the private sector must be part of the solution. ESG-linked water stewardship, water credits, and responsible industrial practices can mobilise capital and innovation.

Eleventh, water governance must become climate-resilient. Adaptive systems that incorporate uncertainty and risk are essential.

Finally, while governance needs to be inclusive and strike an optimal balance between bottom-up and top-down approaches, women must be considered central to water management.

The twelfth tenet of the proposed National Water Vision coincides with the theme for World Water Day 2026: Water and Gender, which explicitly states, "it's time to centre women and girls in water solutions".

The writer is Vice-President – Development Studies at the Observer Research Foundation

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Solar security

This refers to 'Realising solar power's potential for energy security' (March 23). The solar energy scheme, PM Suryaghar Muft Bijali Yojana, despite being cost-effective for the beneficiaries, is not attractive, due to bureaucratic lethargy and lack of public awareness.

The infrastructure to establish the panels and their accessories remains unutilised or underutilised. The beneficiaries need to be motivated and provided with the necessary support to establish the panels for the generation of solar power from their rooftop.

There should be more awareness programmes to push the schemeTimely payment of the subsidy must be ensured.

VSK Pillai
Changanacherry

It is with reference to the news article 'Realising solar power's potential for energy security' (March 23). Solar energy is crucial, sustainable and increasingly cost-effective energy source.

It provides long-term price stability, acting as a hedge against rising unpredictable costs of fossil fuels. While solar energy generation is limited to daylight hours and affected by weather conditions, the advanced battery technologies enable us its use, 24/7 making it a reliable long-term solution.

By generating more solar power, India could reduce its reliance on imported coal, oil and gas and insulate itself from supply disruptions caused by geopolitical factors. Solar energy is an inexhaustible domestic resource that adds diversity to the energy mix.

P Victor Selvaraj
Palayamkottai (TN)

Blessings in disguise

This refers to the article 'Trump, Netanyahu and the stag hunt' (March 23). The example of the hunt for the rabbit and deer is apt. The concluding para about the possibility of positive externality of an adverse event turning out a blessing in disguise also stands to logic.

A country that could evade responsibility for Hiroshima to Venezuela will have to face trial in the humanity's court sooner than all of us think. There are no escape routes left.

MG Warrier
Mumbai

Futile move

Apropos "Demographic fixation" (March 23); the draft policy in Andhra Pradesh reflects a troubling cycle of demographic engineering. Incentives for larger families may appear supportive, yet they echo earlier coercive measures that undermined women's autonomy and health. International experience shows that financial inducements rarely succeed in raising fertility, while structural inequities remain unaddressed.

The real challenge lies not in manipulating birth rates but in creating conditions where families feel secure. Strengthening healthcare, education, and employment opportunities would empower citizens far more than pronatalist schemes. Labour shortages can be met through migration and better workforce planning.

K. Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

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Hazy signals from Iran war

US' statements and actions are often contradictory

Sridhar Krishnaswami

If the objectives of starting the Iran war had been clear there would not have been a problem in deciphering the messages coming out of the US.

After joining hands with Israel and bombing nuclear facilities in Iran on February 28, Washington shifted its sights to regime change once Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was assassinated and the top line of the clerics wiped out in missile strikes by Israel.

But the ballgame soon changed when Teheran began striking Gulf nations that were seen supporting American war efforts.

IN THE DARK

While the conflict is into its fourth week, the international community is unaware of any steps being taken to de-escalate the situation but is witnessing conflicting statements and actions.

While US claims Iran is the "head of the snake for global terrorism", yet sanctions were lifted on its oil that were at sea — apparently about 140 million barrels — to facilitate the easing of oil prices that were roiling energy markets. However, Washington also put out word that steps would be taken to prevent Teheran from making money out of the sales. No one is sure though, how this is going to be done. Even Republican lawmakers don't seem happy. "Bombing Iran with one hand and buying Iran oil with the other," quipped one.

The conflicting messages are not confined to economics and trade. Militarily, President Trump announced that he was "winding down" the Iran war but almost in the same breath threatened to hit Iran hard should it obstruct transit through the Strait of Hormuz; reports indicate some 2,500 Marines were en route to the Gulf to augment the existing 50,000 or so already there.

Of course the additional boots does not mean that a land invasion is imminent or even on the cards. And the Pentagon is asking for an additional $200 billion for its Iran war efforts, a demand that is not sitting well with Congress.

While saying the war is "nearly complete" with little or nothing of Iran's military facilities left, the continued American and Israeli assault on Iranian infrastructure is baffling allies in Europe and Asia.

The Israeli hit on Iran's South Pars gas field brought forth a swift response on Qatar's LNG hub Ras Laffen. This threatens to further escalate retaliatory strikes to include the scores of desalination plants that are in the range of Iran's drones and missiles. Analysts believe that weaponisation of water will have disastrous consequences for the region.

SUBTLE SIGNS. Trump looking for a way out of the war mess REUTERS

The Trump administration claimed that it was not aware that Israel was going to strike South Pars; Tel Aviv, however, avers that Washington was in the loop.

In the maze of chatter are also subtle signals that President Trump is trying to wriggle out of the mess he has created.

And the first of the steps is in his saying that Israel has been told not to hit Iranian energy infrastructure. "I told him (Prime Minister Netanyahu) 'Don't do that, and he won't do that'". While Trump is still maintaining that he is not planning to land troops in Iran, the Israeli Prime Minister is wondering how the entire thing could be wrapped up without the "ground component".

BACK CHANNEL TALKS

Bringing the conflict to an end would face a larger problem if Tel Aviv keeps targeting individuals in the existing power structure in Iran. Even for back channel talks there must be moderates left to take decisions.

Leaving a vacuum at the top will only encourage attempts by fringe radical elements to grab power, the end result of which will not be in the interests of the international community.

The last thing Washington would want is a Teheran that is even more hell bent on going ahead with its nuclear weapons programme, intensifies its anti-Israel stance, or unleashes brutality on its people that would put previous regimes to shame.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations

Petroyuan— a geopolitical signal

DOLLAR'S SWAY. Yuan is constrained by lack of capital account convertibility and PBOC control on exchange rate

RAM SINGH

Amid the Hormuz choke, Iran has signalled conditional openness to energy shipments by permitting oil cargo passage only if transactions are invoiced in Chinese-yuan (¥), a move widely seen as an attempt to challenge the long-standing dominance of the petrodollar system. This development has revived debate over whether the Petroyuan could emerge as an alternative currency for global energy trade.

However, replacing the dollar requires several structural attributes of an international currency, including deep and liquid financial markets, full capital convertibility, global investor trust, and reserve currency dominance, conditions that the renminbi still only partially meets. Therefore, decoding these structural constraints is essential to evaluate whether such shifts could realistically reshape global energy trade and what implications they may hold for India's energy security and financial stability.

PETROYUAN: THE CONSTRAINTS

Petroyuan is a signal, not a system, its growing use in energy trade reflects geopolitical intent to challenge dollar dominance, but structural constraints limit its emergence as a true global monetary alternative. First, from a monetary perspective, the ¥ remains only partially internationalised. According to the IMF, the Chinese-¥ accounts for 2-3 per cent of global foreign exchange reserves, compared with about 56 per cent held in US dollars (see table).

SWIFT data show that the ¥ accounts for 3-4 per cent of global payment transactions, even though China now invoices over 60 per cent of its trade in ¥, while the dollar still dominates with more than 40 per cent of global payments. A key constraint lies in China's continued reliance on capital controls.

Unlike the US dollar or euro, the ¥ is not fully convertible on the capital account, and its exchange rate remains managed by the PBOC. For energy exporters holding large trade surpluses, limited convertibility reduces the attractiveness of ¥ reserves. Moreover, wider ¥ use can constrain PBOC's monetary and liquidity management, particularly during inflationary cycles.

Petrodollar vs Petroyuan: Hype vs Reality

Dimension	Petrodollar (USD)	Petroyuan (RMB)
Monetary credibility & convertibility	Fully convertible currency; global reserve dominance (56% of global FX reserves). Independent central bank, Federal Reserve	Partially convertible currency with capital controls. RMB accounts for 2-3% of global reserves; exchange rate managed by PBOC
Financial market depth	Deep and liquid financial markets; US Treasury market >$26 trillion. Global investors can park oil revenues safely in dollar assets	Financial markets expanding but limited global participation; foreign holdings in Chinese bonds remain relatively low (<10%)
Forex & global payments role	USD dominates global payments (>40% via SWIFT) and >80% of global oil trade is dollar-denominated. India invoices over 85% trade in $	RMB accounts for 3-4% of global payments; limited use in global commodity pricing. Very limited use in India except in the case of some oil trade settlements with Russia
Institutional & regulatory framework	Strong rule of law, transparent financial regulations, investor protection, open capital markets	Regulatory opacity, strong state influence over banks and capital flows, limited investor protection perception
Energy trade & recycling mechanism	Oil exporters recycle petrodollars into US assets (Treasuries, equities, bonds). Large and liquid asset markets sustain system	Limited avenues to recycle large yuan surpluses globally; yuan-denominated oil futures exist but limited adoption
Geopolitical & strategic networks	Supported by US security alliances with Gulf oil producers and dominance of global financial infrastructure (SWIFT, dollar clearing)	China expanding influence via Belt and Road, currency swaps, and CIPS, but geopolitical trust and adoption remain limited

Source: Author's compilations based on IMF data inputs

Second, constraints within China's financial system limit the yuan's global role. Reserve currencies require deep and liquid markets capable of absorbing large international capital flows. The US Treasury market alone exceeds $26 trillion, offering a vast pool of safe assets for global investors and sovereign wealth funds.

Although China's government bond market is sizeable, around $20 trillion, foreign participation remains low, near 10 per cent of outstanding bonds. Capital controls, regulatory restrictions, and concerns over legal transparency discourage investors from holding large ¥-denominated assets. Moreover, China's financial system remains dominated by state-owned banks and policy-driven lending, weakening global confidence in market-based capital allocation.

Third, foreign-exchange recycling mechanisms for the ¥ remain limited. Under the petrodollar system, oil exporters particularly Gulf states, reinvest surplus revenues into US financial markets, especially US Treasuries and other dollar-denominated assets that provide liquidity, transparency, and legal certainty. China lacks a comparable ecosystem capable of absorbing large global energy surpluses. Although Shanghai hosts ¥-denominated oil futures, their trading volumes remain far smaller than benchmark Brent and WTI contracts.

> India should strengthen the international role of the rupee through deeper domestic financial markets, and bilateral currency-swap arrangements

Geopolitical and institutional factors further reinforce dollar dominance. The US financial system is supported by global infrastructure such as SWIFT messaging networks, dollar clearing systems, extensive banking linkages and 'rule-of-law' unlike China's 'rule-by-law'.

Moreover, many energy exporters maintain deep strategic and security ties with the US, encouraging continued dollar invoicing. Despite China's currency swaps and Belt and Road settlements, most global oil contracts remain dollar-priced.

WAY FORWARD

Even as a geopolitical signal, Petroyuan-based invoicing warrants a nuanced policy debate in India, given its implications for energy security, monetary stability, and strategic autonomy. Given the dollar's liquidity, transparent pricing, and stable recycling, India should largely remain within the dollar-based system, while allowing selective ¥ invoicing to manage transactional flexibility, sanctions exposure, and growing unpredictability in US policy. Further, given the ¥'s partial convertibility, capital controls, shallow financial integration and state-controlled policy initiatives, it should be treated as a tactical tool, not a systemic alternative, with vigilance against excessive dependence on China's state-controlled financial ecosystem.

Second, India must simultaneously strengthen its export capabilities. Without a resilient balance of payments supported by strong export growth, India's ambition of rupee internationalisation will remain largely aspirational and confined to sanction-driven corridors.

In this context, India may explore emerging digital settlement architectures such as the mBridge platform, enabling corridor-specific payment arrangements with trusted partners. It is paramount given that India's existing rupee-trade settlement is also subject to risks of sanctions (Russia, Iran).

Third, strengthening foreign-exchange resilience remains essential. Maintaining robust and diversified reserve holdings including gradual integration of yuan in India's currency reserve amid opening of Chinese investment can be considered as a hedge to manage volatility arising from geopolitical shocks, commodity price fluctuations, or currency realignments in global energy markets amid escalating transactional opacity.

Fourth, India must deepen energy diplomacy beyond 'supplier diversification' to 'supplier integration' involving them as stakeholders in expanding its strategic reserve infrastructure. As India scales geo-economically and geo-strategically, its rise will certainly be tested under strategic rivalry and deterrence and, correspondingly, it must gradually scale crude oil and gas reserves to initially 90 days to become a member of IEA and eventually to 120-150 days.

Finally, India should gradually strengthen the international role of the rupee through deeper domestic financial markets, expanded bilateral currency-swap arrangements, and more resilient cross-border payment infrastructure. Such a balanced strategy, preserving dollar stability while cautiously expanding currency flexibility, will best safeguard India's energy trade, financial stability, and long-term strategic autonomy.

The writer is Professor and Head, IIFT New Delhi. Views expressed are personal

thehindu**businessline.**

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

March 24, 2006

SBI Act changes okayed

The Union Cabinet gave its nod for legislative changes that will enable State Bank of India to sell shares in its associate banks. The changes will also facilitate SBI to split the shares of its subsidiaries. SBI has seven associate banks of which only three are listed.

Sonia resigns from Lok Sabha, NAC

The Congress President, Ms Sonia Gandhi, on Thursday resigned from her position as a Lok Sabha MP from Rae Bareilly and as Chairperson of the National Advisory Council (NAC), thereby opening a political Pandora's Box on the issue of legislators holding office of profit. Ms Gandhi's resignation follows Opposition demand for her disqualification as an MP in view of her holding the post of NAC Chairperson, which the Opposition alleged was an office of profit.

Jet-Sahara deal may go through

Barring a last-minute hitch, the Jet-Sahara buyout deal is all set to go through, though there could be a re-negotiation on the end price. There were hectic parleys throughout Thursday between the top officials of Jet Airways, followed by a meeting with the Sahara representatives.

India's economy resilient despite West Asia headwinds

Nirmal K Minda

India's economy continues to grow rapidly, with GDP expected to rise by 7.6 per cent in FY 2026, and exports likely to stay steady at 6 per cent. Looking ahead, growth is expected to remain above 7 per cent in FY 2027, even as global growth is projected to fall below 3 per cent.

Despite geopolitical and tariff challenges, India has grown by more than 7 per cent over the past three years. The Purchasing Managers' Index at 56.9 for manufacturing and 58.1 for services was the highest among the top economies, the US, China and Germany, in February 2026.

India's export trajectory remains steady, increasing by around 6 per cent from April to February 2025-26, reaching $791 billion, up from $748 billion in the same period last year.

Exports are strongly supported by engineering goods, electronics, chemicals, gems and jewellery, and agricultural products. India has numerous diversification opportunities in advanced, emerging, and developing economies.

On the gas and energy front, India maintains a buffer through strategic petroleum reserves and significant commercial stocks, offering an energy cushion of 50-60 days that surpasses the global average. Additionally, India has diversified its crude import sources, drawing supplies from numerous countries, including Russia, the US, Canada, Brazil, and Mexico.

At the current juncture, strict oversight of supply chains must be enforced to prevent traders or intermediaries from hoarding petrol, diesel, and LPG.

Maintaining reliable fuel supply and public confidence are essential to avoid unnecessary market panic. A coordinated policy approach that includes supply monitoring and strategic stock management will help India navigate global energy fluctuations while safeguarding economic stability.

ECONOMY. Robust outlook REUTERS

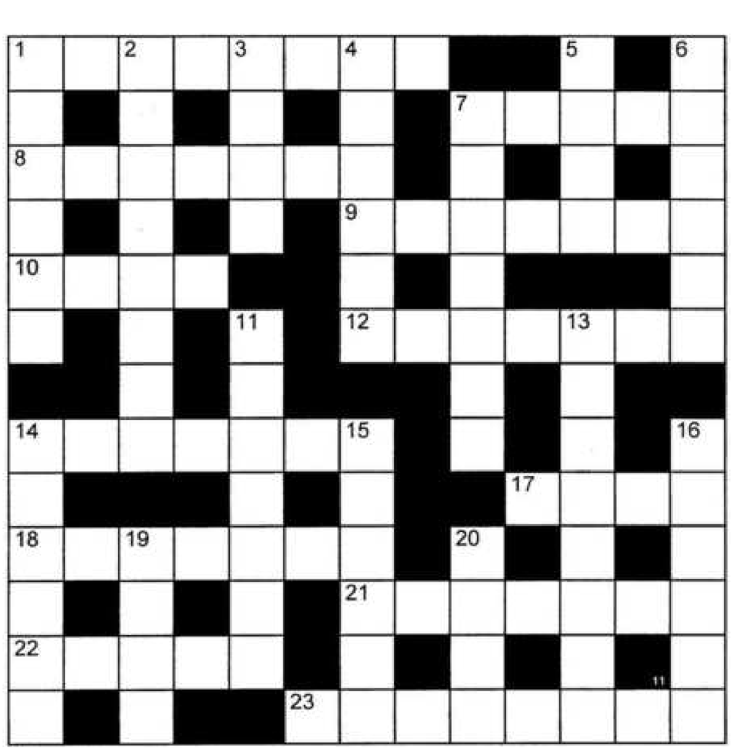
However, a prolonged US-Israel-Iran conflict could raise logistics costs and lead to price volatility, putting pressure on the transport, logistics, manufacturing, and consumer goods sectors.

MSMEs, which form the backbone of our journey towards Viksit Bharat, require support. Helping them become more resilient to global shocks will strengthen overall growth and job creation. Their working capital needs during global headwinds should be addressed.

The plug-and-play industrial development under the Bharat Industrial Development Scheme (BHAVYA) marks a historic breakthrough in India's manufacturing sector. A seamless, end-to-end ease-of-doing-business model, from approvals to operations, will meet the aspirations of a new India and contribute to the vision of Viksit Bharat.

The writer is President, ASSOCHAM

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2642



EASY

ACROSS

1. Ember-days (4-4)
7. Haughtiness (5)
8. Hanging droppings of frozen water (7)
9. Handcuff (7)
10. Drag, pull with violence (4)
12. Delicate shades of difference (7)
14. Get out of way to escape legal process (7)
17. Use teaspoon (4)
18. Departure of aircraft (4-3)
21. 40 poles (7)
22. Clasp firmly (5)
23. Looked down on with contempt (8)

DOWN

1. Sudden fear (6)
2. Influence producing response (8)
3. Deal out in small portions (4)
4. Obedient follower with no initiative (3-3)
5. Flat, circular body (4)
6. Coat lapel (6)
7. Man-of-war's tender boat (7)
11. Lengthen out (7)
13. Has the governing of (8)
14. Tricks, capers (6)
15. Thick-napped coarse woollen cloth (6)
16. Unanimated (6)
19. Draw together, contract (4)
20. Pleasure excursion (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

1. Rapid periods when one may deprive oneself of food (4-4)
7. A number of lions showing their amour-propre (5)
8. Droppings that are frozen (7)
9. Handcuff a fellow with torn lace (7)
10. What thief gets from a dacha ultimately (4)
12. Can use name with various shades of meaning (7)
14. Make off with rating the second energy departs (7)
17. A disturbance in which one is confined (4)
18. Departure of aircraft for a parody (4-3)
21. For lung it can be an eighth of a mile of displacement (7)
22. Hang on tightly to a sort of peach (5)
23. Looked down on the speeds I'd achieved (8)

DOWN

1. Scare caused by combat is about right (6)
2. It may suit slum to be something rousing one to action (8)
3. A hand-out that will satisfy the French (4)
14. He'll agree to say men are wrong (3-3)
5. Record is to be found in the situation of Washington (4)
6. Extension of collar one will almost move back (6)
7. A boat that can be made up in wood (7)
11. A non-amateur will yearn to spin it out (7)
13. Has the regulation of knobs, wheels and levers (8)
14. Can sit around and get up to tricks such as these (6)
15. With 'flu, fed on a different sort of coarse wool cloth (6)
16. Frozen with cold if grid is adapted to it (6)
19. Give up some stinking work with wool (4)
20. Will make one lose one's footing on the journey (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2641

ACROSS 7. Indefatigable 8. Permanently 12. Dotage 14. Novice 16. Strode 18. Result 19. Flower vases 23. Lets well alone

DOWN 1. Snap 2. Peer 3. Damage 4. Pigeon 5. Vast 6. Clay 9. Enthral 10. Leisure 11. Cent 12. Dose 13. God 15. Owe 17. Eleven 18. Revile 19. Flew 20. Oast 21. Sole 22. Song

QUICKLY.

1.33 lakh social media content flagged: SEBI

New Delhi: SEBI has escalated 1.33 lakh manipulative social media content pertaining to the securities market to the social media platform providers, Parliament was informed on Monday. In a written reply to the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said the escalations were done as of February 28, 2026. He said that the regulator receives input regarding misleading, manipulative or unlawful content related to the securities market and escalates this input to the concerned social media platform provider to remove, disable or take down the content, in accordance with the relevant regulatory framework. PTI

Innovision slumps 28% to ₹374.20 on Day 1

Bengaluru: Shares of Innovision made a weak debut on the stock exchanges, listing at a 10 per cent discount and fell further to close at ₹374.20 on the NSE, 28 per cent below the offer price of ₹519. The stock opened on the NSE at ₹467.70, marking a 9.8 per cent decline. On the BSE, the shares debuted at ₹466, down 10.2 per cent. Selling pressure intensified after listing, dragging the stock to end at the lower circuit on the BSE to ₹372.80. The IPO saw moderate investor interest, with the issue subscribing 3.32 times. The company had earlier extended the IPO closing date to March 17 and trimmed its price band following a muted response. OUR BUREAU

SEBI removes auto triggers in revised 'fit and proper' norms

EASE OF BIZ. Pendency of criminal complaint will not cause automatic disqualification

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Monday approved amendments to the "fit and proper person" criteria for intermediaries, easing certain rule-based disqualifications while strengthening principle-based oversight. The changes are aimed at balancing regulatory scrutiny with ease of doing business, ensuring that only individuals with integrity and ethical conduct participate in the securities market without imposing undue restrictions.

A key change is that the mere pendency of a criminal complaint, FIR filed by SEBI or a chargesheet related to economic offences will no longer automatically disqualify an applicant or intermediary. Such cases will now be assessed on a case-by-case basis under broader principle-based criteria.

SEBI has also expanded disqualification triggers to include convictions for any economic offence or violations under securities laws, in addition to offences involving moral turpitude.

WHO IS FIT. Cases will now be assessed individually, SEBI chief Tuhin Kanta Pandey said at the board meeting

WINDING UP NORMS

The regulator has also removed initiation of winding-up proceedings as a ground for disqualification, although an actual winding-up order will continue to attract ineligibility. Intermediaries will now be required to inform SEBI and stock exchanges within 15 working days of any material developments involving themselves, key managerial personnel or persons in control that may affect their eligibility status. SEBI has also introduced an explicit provision to grant entities a reasonable opportunity of being heard before they are declared unfit.

The Board has reduced the period during which applications are kept in abeyance following issuance of a show-cause notice from one year to six months, and limited such cases to specific proceedings under the SEBI Act. The default five-year bar on reapplying for registration has been removed.

Regulator proposes gift cards for MF investments

REACHING OUT. SEBI proposed that PPIs shall be funded only through electronic bank transfer or UPI from an Indian bank

Reuters

Markets regulator SEBI on Monday proposed allowing gift cards or gift prepaid payment instruments (PPIs) for mutual fund investments to improve financial inclusion through onboarding new investors, according to a consultation paper on its website.

The proposal would allow buyers of gift cards or gift PPIs to transfer them to recipients, who could then use the instruments to subscribe to mutual fund units, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) paper said.

Each PPI shall have a validity period of one year from the date of issuance, it added. Registrar and transfer agents, acting on behalf of asset management companies, will track each investor's annual investments made through gift PPIs, e-wallets and cash and will reject any gift PPI-linked transaction that pushes the total above ₹50,000.

SEBI cuts entry threshold for social impact funds to ₹1,000

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has approved a sharp reduction in the minimum investment threshold for individual investors in Social Impact Funds (SIFs), a sub-category of Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), to ₹1,000 from ₹2 lakh now.

The change aligns the entry threshold for SIFs with that of Zero Coupon Zero Principal (ZCZP) instruments listed on Social Stock Exchanges (SSEs). By lowering the entry barrier, the regulator aims to attract a wider base of retail and small investors into the social impact investment space, thereby improving capital flows to the sector.

The reform is expected to strengthen participation on India's Social Stock Exchange, a new platform designed to channel capital towards non-profit organisations and for-profit social enterprises working in areas such as education, healthcare and livelihood generation.

FUND RAISING

SSEs enable social enterprises to raise funds through instruments like ZCZP bonds, where investors contribute capital without expecting financial returns, or through equity-like structures in the case of for-profit entities.

Market participants had flagged high entry barriers as a key constraint limiting retail interest in such instruments.

By lowering the ticket size, SEBI aims to broaden the investor base and improve funding access for social enterprises.

AIF winding-up norms eased; retention of proceeds allowed in select cases

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Monday eased winding-up norms for Alternative Investment Funds (AIF) Regulations and surrendering registration. AIFs will be allowed to retain liquidation proceeds beyond the permissible fund life in specific circumstances. The decision comes after SEBI observed that some AIFs were unable to close operations due to pending tax demands, litigation or residual expenses, despite having no active fund management activity.

Currently, AIFs are required to distribute all proceeds within the fund tenure and achieve a nil bank balance before surrendering their registration. However, delays linked to regulatory or legal obligations have forced certain funds to continue holding licences and comply with ongoing regulatory requirements.

OTHER MEASURES

SEBI has now permitted retention of proceeds, subject to conditions such as receipt of litigation or tax notices, consent of at least 75 per cent of investors by value for meeting anticipated liabilities, or substantiation of retained amounts for operational expenses. In the case of operational costs, the retention period has been capped at three years from the end of the fund's life.

SEBI has also introduced a new category of 'inoperative funds' for AIFs that are in the process of winding up but unable to fully close due to such residual issues. These funds will be subject to lighter compliance norms, including exemption from periodic filings, private placement memorandum updates and performance benchmarking requirements.

The move is expected to significantly reduce compliance burden on AIFs with no active investment activity, while maintaining necessary regulatory oversight.

Regulations for InvITs, REITs relaxed to boost operational flexibility

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Monday cleared amendments to the Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT) and Real Estate Investment Trust (REIT) regulations, allowing InvITs to continue holding investments in special purpose vehicles (SPVs) even after the underlying infrastructure project has concluded.

EXIT TIMELINE

This move is aimed at resolving practical difficulties arising from pending claims, litigation, tax assessments or defect liability periods that delay exit from such entities.

InvITs must now exit these SPVs or acquire new assets within one year from the completion of concession agreements or resolution of pending issues. Time taken for regulatory approvals will be excluded from this timeline, while enhanced disclosures will be mandated.

SEBI has also broadened investment avenues for InvITs and REITs by permitting deployment of surplus funds into a wider set of liquid mutual fund schemes, which now include schemes with slightly lower credit thresholds — those rated AA and above — compared with the earlier restriction to top-rated instruments. This move is expected to help mitigate concentration risk.

The Board has also aligned norms for privately-listed InvITs with publicly-listed counterparts by allowing them to invest up to 10 per cent of their assets in under-construction, or greenfield infrastructure projects.

SEBI has relaxed borrowing norms for InvITs with higher leverage. Trusts with leverage between 49 and 70 per cent of asset value will now be allowed to raise fresh debt for capital expenditure, major maintenance of road projects and refinancing existing borrowings.

BlackRock CEO flags inequality risks, calls for broader market access

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Larry Fink, Chairman and CEO of BlackRock, has warned that widening inequality and the rapid rise of artificial intelligence could deepen economic divides unless more people gain access to capital markets, in his 2026 annual letter to investors released on Monday.

In the letter, Fink said the global economic order is undergoing a structural shift marked by geopolitical tensions, trade realignment and the push for national self-reliance in critical sectors such as energy, defence and technology. These transitions, he noted, are capital-intensive and increasingly reliant on financial markets rather than traditional funding channels like banks or governments.

"The old model of global capitalism is fracturing," Fink said, adding that countries are spending heavily to secure domestic supply chains and industrial capacity, even at higher costs.

Larry Fink, Chairman and CEO, BlackRock

WEALTH GAP

A key concern highlighted in the letter is the growing gap between asset owners and wage earners. Fink pointed out that over the past decades, wealth creation has disproportionately benefited those invested in markets, while wage growth has lagged significantly. He cautioned that AI could accelerate this trend by concentrating gains among companies and investors with the scale and resources to deploy the technology.

"Capitalism is working — just not for enough people," he said, calling for policies that expand participation in long-term investing. Fink emphasised that broader access to capital markets could help address inequality and support economic growth. He cited initiatives such as early-stage investment accounts, improved financial infrastructure and digital platforms as ways to bring more individuals into the investment ecosystem.

Fink stressed on the importance of long-term investing, saying that it performed a 'civic miracle.' "When people invest their savings — over decades, not days — the capital markets put that money to work financing companies, infrastructure and jobs. And when that cycle happens in your own country, your future and your nation's future become linked," he said.

In countries like India, he noted, widespread smartphone adoption is already enabling millions to access financial services and potentially invest in markets.

Zerodha's Nikhil Kamath and Quant MF back Swan Defence OFS

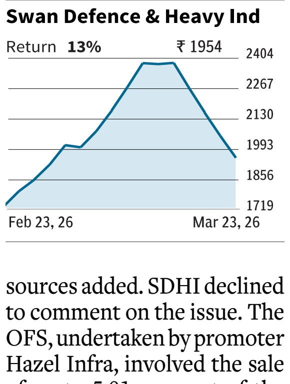
Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Marquee investors including Nikhil Kamath, Co-Founder of Zerodha, and Quant Mutual Fund, one of India's leading asset managers, anchored the Offer for Sale (OFS) of the Mumbai-based Swan Defence and Heavy Industries (SDHI), with the company's promoters raising an estimated ₹500 crore.

The OFS was subscribed 1.2 times, signalling strong institutional confidence in the shipbuilding company's turnaround story in Gujarat, where it operates a shipbuilding facility, according to sources familiar with the matter.

STAKE SALE

The issue raised the funds at an average realised price of ₹1,905-1,910 per share, sources added. SDHI declined to comment on the issue. The OFS, undertaken by promoter Hazel Infra, involved the sale of up to 5.01 per cent of the company's total equity, or 26.38 lakh shares, through the stock exchange mechanism on the BSE and NSE, in line with SEBI's minimum public shareholding (MPS) requirements. The base offer was spread across institutional and retail categories over two trading days. Institutional investors alone oversubscribed the OFS by 20 per cent, with participation largely from long-only funds, sources said.



While investor participation was anchored by marquee names, including Kamath and Quant Mutual Fund, other long-term institutional investors, including Bank of India, also participated, highlighting strong confidence in SDHI's prospects.

Operationally, SDHI has seen steady business momentum. Its shipyard at Pipavav in Gujarat has secured orders, including six chemical tankers from Norway-based Rederiet Stenersen AS and a defence export contract for the Royal Navy of Oman.

The company has also completed over 10 ship repair and refit projects across Indian Coast Guard vessels, commercial ships and offshore rigs, with several deliveries ahead of schedule, reflecting improved execution under new management.

BROKER'S CALL.

ICICI Securities

3M INDIA (ADD)
Target: ₹36,726.00
CMP: ₹31,070.90
3M India has passed on commodity inflation and INR depreciation to end-consumers in medium-long term, we note its EBITDA margin in 9MFY26 (19.7 per cent) is at its highest level since FY13. We remain confident that it is likely to end FY26E with the highest EBITDA margin in the past decade. Considering the inflation in other commodities such as copper, aluminium and crude oil, and with USD-INR rates reaching nearly ₹94 in March 2026, we believe there is an imminent risk to EBITDA margins.
There is a negative correlation coefficient of 0.37 between INR depreciation and EBITDA margin (with a one-year lag). While INR depreciation has an impact on EBITDA margin, we believe the company is in a position to pass on some of the additional costs via price hikes, revenue mix changes, cost-saving initiatives and operating leverage. 9MFY26.
3M India imports the majority of its raw materials and incurs significant expenses, including royalties and corporate management fees. While it generates some export revenue, we believe steep INR depreciation may impact profitability. We note its net outflows as a percentage of net sales stood at about 43 per cent over FY19-25.
We also note other commodities such as crude oil, copper and aluminium are in an inflationary zone. Furthermore, global shipping crisis and higher crude oil prices could impact freight costs. We cut TP to ₹36,726 (vs ₹39,250 earlier); implied target P/E works out to 50x FY28E EPS. Maintain ADD.

Elara Securities

ETERNAL (BUY)
Target: ₹415
CMP: ₹226.95
Eternal (Zomato) has raised its platform fee by about 20 per cent to about ₹15/order, in line with its peer, Swiggy. Hence, Zomato's increased platform fee should not pose concern over order flows. We estimate each ₹1 hike drives about 26-bp take-rate expansion and about ₹120-crore incremental adj EBITDA (about 5 per cent of base). In our base case, this adds about 40 bps to the take rate and ₹180 crore (about 7.5 per cent) to FY27E adj EBITDA. Platform fees have increased 7.5x since their introduction in August 2023 (₹2 initially); since then, Zomato has hiked them in almost every quarter. At 3.1 per cent of food delivery (FD) average order value of ₹475, the fee remains too low to trigger demand elasticity, supported by monthly transacting users growth accelerating to about 22 per cent in Q3FY26.
Company data show a gradual increase in platform fees has not affected the gross order value (GOV) growth rate. The move supports the management's 5-6 per cent adj EBITDA/GOV target; we expect 6 per cent by FY28E. The fee hike largely factored in our base case Adj. EBITDA margin estimates for FY27E. We retain Buy with a TP of ₹415, as we value food delivery on 55x EV/EBITDA, Blinkit on 5x EV/gross profit and Going out/Hyper pure on 3x EV/sales.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

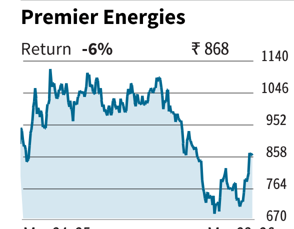
Premier Energies (₹868.15): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Premier Energies. The stock has made a bullish double-bottom reversal pattern. This marks the end of the downtrend that was in place since October last year.

The neckline support of this pattern is coming around ₹815. Fresh buyers are likely to come in around ₹815 and limit the downside. Moving average cross overs on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case. Premier Energies share price can rise to ₹1,000 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Premier Energies shares now at ₹868. Accumulate on dips at ₹830.



Keep the stop-loss at ₹785. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹890 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹915.

Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹920 and ₹960 when the price touches ₹945 and ₹975 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹990.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is arisk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

22496 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
22470	22100	22680	22890	Go short on a break below 22470. Keep the stop-loss at 22510

₹742 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
725	710	754	770	Go short now and at 750. Keep the stop-loss at 760

₹1253 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1210	1275	1295	Immediate outlook is not clear. Avoid trading this stock

₹291 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
289	285	294	297	Go short only below 289. Stop-loss can be kept at 290

₹265 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
263	259	268	272	Take fresh shorts below 263. Keep the stop-loss at 264

₹1403 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1390	1365	1430	1450	Wait for dips. Go long at 1395 with a stop-loss at 1385

₹1031 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1015	1000	1050	1075	Wait for a rise. Go short at 1045 with a stop-loss at 1055

₹2380 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2350	2300	2410	2445	Go short on a rise at 2395 and 2405. Keep the stop-loss at 2420

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 601.85 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
HCL Tech	1358.60	5.76	22.38	1.40
PowerGrid Corp	302.10	4.47	18.10	1.13
Infosys	1256.80	0.69	18.20	4.29
ONGC	265.45	0.04	7.43	1.00
Tech Mahindra	1384.00	-0.11	29.53	0.86
Max Healthcare	956.90	-1.29	65.59	0.69
TCS	2383.80	-1.52	17.98	2.37
Wipro	187.54	-2.10	14.75	0.52
TataConsumerProduct	1023.60	-3.80	68.83	0.65
Tata Motors PV	305.25	-4.06	41.51	0.62
NestleIndia	1166.80	-4.22	68.98	0.82
Cipla	1221.80	-4.27	21.77	0.67
Sun Pharma	1758.40	-4.34	38.52	1.81
Bajaj Finserv	1675.50	-4.37	13.94	0.93
Apollo Hosp	7145.00	-4.96	55.06	0.72
Adani Enter	1833.00	-5.38	14.97	0.47
Hind Unilever	2052.20	-5.94	47.95	1.77
Dr Reddys Lab	1253.30	-6.10	18.94	0.74
SBI Life	1832.30	-6.36	74.12	0.80
Coal India	455.25	-6.43	9.43	1.01
Bajaj Auto	8776.00	-6.69	27.59	0.95
Eicher Motors	6681.50	-6.87	34.21	0.90
Maruti Suzuki	12355.00	-7.08	26.01	1.58
Grasim Ind	2531.10	-7.14	18.19	0.94
Asian Paints	2121.30	-7.35	52.04	0.93
HDFC Life	592.10	-7.44	67.59	0.62
Eternal Ltd.	226.96	-8.40	948.16	1.59
NTPC	372.40	-8.89	14.54	1.72
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	226.10	-9.49	89.51	0.72
Reliance Ind	1407.80	-9.78	19.48	9.26
Trent Ltd.	3356.70	-9.88	73.67	0.73
Adani Ports	1303.60	-10.00	24.03	0.94
IntGlobeAvi	3945.30	-10.11	47.50	0.87
Bajaj Finance	812.60	-10.46	27.59	2.10
Hindalco	840.25	-10.79	11.74	1.18
JSW Steel	1109.60	-12.37	34.94	1.02
UltraTech Cement	10362.00	-14.88	39.85	1.20
Bharat Elec	405.50	-16.19	49.71	1.42
Kotak Bank	356.55	-16.45	18.86	2.55
Tata Steel	187.17	-17.41	25.62	1.51
Shriram Finance Ltd.	877.70	-18.71	18.05	1.20
ITC	290.45	-20.08	17.58	2.73
Axis Bank	1170.60	-20.94	13.76	3.27
M&M	2955.80	-21.60	21.74	2.57
Titan	3853.10	-22.95	71.77	1.55
State Bank	1031.90	-23.76	11.01	4.17
L&T	3342.40	-23.81	24.23	3.83
Bharti Airtel	1795.90	-30.69	27.64	4.88
ICICI Bank	1222.70	-35.57	15.44	8.51
HDFC Bank	744.15	-121.82	14.79	11.09

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▼ 2,447.40 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Info Edge I	974.70	-4.08	37.51	1.85
Bajaj Housing Finance .	78.51	-8.26	26.40	0.36
Torrent Pharma	4213.90	-17.67	62.77	2.15
Godrej Consumer	1002.40	-18.35	56.31	1.97
United Spirits .	1275.20	-22.06	53.93	1.84
Zyduslifesciences	860.60	-22.45	17.23	2.05
Lic	740.00	-24.48	8.83	0.80
Pidilitind	1314.90	-24.60	57.83	1.99
Siemens Energy India	2696.10	-25.23	81.28	1.16
Mazagaon Dock	2206.70	-26.76	36.99	0.82
Indian Railway Finance Corp	89.45	-28.09	16.68	0.78
Shree Cement	22725.00	-32.50	45.65	1.48
Bosch	29135.00	-32.66	31.17	1.23
Divis Lab	6013.50	-32.97	64.40	3.73
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3412.50	-35.01	53.09	3.91
Hindus Zinc	487.65	-35.25	17.46	1.03
Hyundai Motor India	1867.50	-35.72	26.21	1.30
Cg Power & Ind Sol	664.10	-36.05	94.27	2.23
Solar Industries	12430.00	-36.84	73.67	1.48
Siemens	2988.30	-37.47	67.12	1.29
Havells	1231.00	-37.99	52.07	1.52
Jsw Energy .	482.70	-39.20	32.41	1.27
Icici Lombard Gic	1722.20	-39.94	31.36	2.04
Abb India	6041.50	-40.20	75.92	1.55
Adanigreenenergy	816.45	-42.90	72.46	1.22
Adani Power .	147.85	-43.67	25.23	2.85
Bajaj Holdings	9162.00	-45.46	11.38	1.94
Britannia Ind	5490.00	-45.47	54.72	3.16
Ambuja Cements	395.35	-46.11	19.86	1.18
Dlf	514.75	-50.04	28.77	1.61
Avenuesuper	3655.60	-50.89	83.05	2.63
Rural Elec	316.45	-52.65	4.83	1.93
Ltimindtree	4105.60	-53.75	25.77	1.86
Macrotech Developers .	727.90	-58.23	21.73	1.00
Gail (India)	135.40	-60.45	10.35	1.78
Punjab Natl Bank	105.55	-61.86	6.79	1.78
Power Finance	398.00	-64.87	3.93	2.83
Adani Energy Solutions .	946.90	-65.57	47.72	1.60
Samvardhanmothersoninternatl	106.59	-66.63	30.91	2.31
Canara Bank	129.56	-69.59	6.38	2.13
Indian Oilcorp	138.11	-72.75	5.29	2.52
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1380.90	-75.62	24.04	2.85
Tata Power	386.95	-77.84	24.69	3.17
Bank Of Baroda	265.90	-78.20	7.00	2.41
Varun Beverages .	382.20	-79.04	42.21	2.56
Hindustanaeronautics	3634.60	-84.14	27.32	3.37
Indian Hotels Co. .	582.45	-87.22	38.30	2.50
Jindal Steel	1106.20	-90.03	55.97	2.02
Bpcl	271.30	-95.95	4.78	2.57
Vedanta	645.75	-134.62	15.24	5.35

Pts: Impact on index movement

◉ FOCUS ON TAMIL NADU

AIADMK allots 27 seats to BJP, 18 to PMK; yet to decide on seats for smaller partners

WAR OF KAZHAGAMS. State headed for a four-corner battle among the NDA, the DMK-led alliance, NTK and Vijay's TVK

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK)-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) on Monday gave a final shape to its seat-sharing arrangement, sharpening the contours of a four-cornered contest in Tamil Nadu involving the ruling Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) alliance, Seeman-led Naam Tamilar Katchi (NTK) and actor Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK).

FINAL PICTURE
The AIADMK, the main constituent of the Opposition alliance, allocated 27 seats to the Bharatiya Janata Party, 18 to the Pattali Makkal Katchi (PMK) led by Anbumani Ramadoss, and 11 to the TTV Dhinakaran-led Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam (AMMK), AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami, said at a press conference. Dhinakaran, the nephew of Jayalalithaa's confidante VK Sasikala, is expected to bolster the NDA in southern Tamil Nadu by consolidating sections of the Thevar vote while reinforcing the alliance's claim to Jayalalithaa's legacy.

(from left) AMMK leader TTV Dinakaran; BJP's Tamil Nadu in-charge Piyush Goyal; AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami; PMK leader Anbumani Ramadoss; and BJP TN President Nainar Nagendran in Chennai on Monday BIJOY GHOSH

Flanked by Union Minister Piyush Goyal and other alliance leaders, Anbumani Ramadoss and Dinakaran, Palaniswami told reporters at the party headquarters that seat-sharing talks with the smaller allies would be concluded soon. The smaller parties include Tamil Maanila Congress and India Jananayaga Katchi.

A RECALIBRATION
The evolving alliance structure marks a recalibration from the 2021 Tamil Nadu Assembly election, when the AIADMK contested 191 seats and won 66. The BJP contested 20 seats in Tamil Nadu and won 4 with a vote share of 2.62 per cent. This time, the BJP will contest in 27 seats.

The PMK (as a joint faction consisting of both senior and junior Ramadoss) contested 23 seats and won five with a vote share of 3.8 per cent in 2021.

This time, a split PMK faction, headed by Anbumani Ramadoss, has settled for a reduced number, mainly to accommodate the AMMK. "Ours is a winning alliance. We will come to power again. The NDA is a passionate alliance, a victorious alliance," said Palaniswami.

The ruling DMK continues to anchor a broad secular progressive alliance comprising the Indian National Congress, the Communist Party of India, the Communist Party of India (Marxist), Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK), Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK), the Indian Union Muslim League, and other smaller regional partners.

In 2021, the DMK contested 173 seats and won 133, while the Congress secured 18 seats, helping the alliance return to power with a comfortable majority under Chief Minister MK Stalin.

The NDA has, however, not been able to attract actor Vijay's TVK into its fold, introducing an element of unpredictability into what has historically been a bipolar contest between DMK and AIADMK and their allies.

◉ STATE OF PLAY

Kerala's LDF-UDF script faces disruption

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance has muscled its way to disrupt the near ritualistic two-front rivalry between the Left Democratic Front (LDF) and the United Democratic Front (UDF) in Kerala. This time, that familiar script faces disruption, with the NDA pressing hard to transform the elections into a three-cornered contest in the southern State.

Hardly have elections in Kerala promised a contest as competitive as the one now unfolding, with all three fronts striking aggressive postures early in the campaign.

The incumbent LDF aims for a historic third consecutive term in what remains its last major bastion, while the Opposition UDF faces a fight to reclaim ground it considers familiar turf.

The BJP, meanwhile, hopes to expand its footprint sufficiently to turn the contest triangular, and potentially force a hung Assembly that could allow it to play kingmaker.

The CPM-led LDF has set an ambitious target of winning 110 seats in the 140-member Assembly (it holds 99 in the outgoing House), while the Congress-led UDF is eyeing a tally of over 100 seats (from 41 at present).

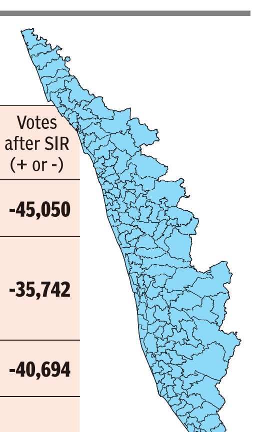
The BJP-led NDA, whose best showing so far has been one seat each in the Assembly and the Lok Sabha, is seeking to push its tally into double digits, a threshold that could significantly alter post-election arithmetic.

SYMBOLIC VICTORY
The BJP's attempt to break the LDF-UDF duopoly received a morale boost in the recent municipal polls, where the NDA scored a symbolic breakthrough by capturing the prestigious Thiruvananthapuram Corporation. The victory was significant enough for Prime Minister Narendra Modi to travel to the State to celebrate the win and address a rally, a move widely interpreted as signalling the party's determination to expand its organisational base in Kerala.

Whether the electorate is ready for such a transition remains uncertain. The unusually short campaign window, among the briefest in the State's history until polling day on April 9, leaves little time for course correction. Compounding this are logistical setbacks, including the fallout from SIR, which affected several BJP strongholds, including parts of Thiruvananthapuram.

A few seats in Kerala where results could turn unpredictable post-SIR

Constituency	2021 winner/ front	Runner-up	Margin	Votes after SIR (+ or -)
Thiruvananthapuram	Antony Raju (LDF)	VS Sivakumar (UDF)	7,089	-45,050
Nemom	V Sivankutty (LDF)	Kummanam Rajasekharan (NDA, currently candidate from Aranmula)	3,949	-35,742
Vattiyoorkavu	VK Prasanth (LDF)	VV Rajesh (NDA)	21,515	-40,694
Kazhakkottam	Kadakampalli Surendran (LDF)	Shobha Surendran (NDA, currently candidate from Palakkad)	23,497	-31,320
Thrissur	P Balachandran (LDF)	Padmaja Venugopal (UDF, currently NDA candidate)	946	-29,452
Palakkad	Shafi Parambil (UDF)	E Sreedharan (NDA)	3,859	-15,829
Manjeswar	AKM Ashraf (UDF)	K Surendran (NDA)	745	2,960



Remark: All are seats with core BJP-NDA focus. Post-SIR, number of voters are fewer by tens of thousands, save in one

Early campaign turbulence has also taken a toll on the UDF, where prolonged wrangling over candidate selection stretched across four days, costing valuable campaign time.

Its rivals watched closely as the Opposition struggled to close ranks. Adding to the campaign uncertainty, a cooking gas shortage across parts of the State has threatened disruption to restaurants and street food vendors, an issue with the potential to influence voter sentiment at the grassroots level.

Signs of strain have surfaced within the ruling LDF as well. Internal dissensions, particularly in traditional strongholds such as Kannur, have dented the image of unity long associated with the Communist Party of India (Marxist).

At least 10 senior LDF leaders, including former MLAs and a Minister, have switched sides to contest under rival banners, hinting at fractures within the cadre base.

CADRE FATIGUE
Analysts point to growing signs of political weariness and possible cadre fatigue as the LDF attempts to secure a third straight term, a feat never before achieved in Kerala's electoral history.

The Congress-led UDF, on its part, continues to grapple with factionalism and leadership tussles that have periodically undermined its campaign momentum.

This evolving churn has created space for the NDA to position itself as a viable third alternative. The local body polls held in December, often viewed as a semi-final ahead of the Assembly elections, provided a template for campaign strategies.

While the UDF registered strong overall gains, the NDA's capture of the Thiruvananthapuram Corporation stood out as a politically significant breakthrough, even though its vote share gains remained modest.

The LDF, which performed below expectations in these polls, sought to stabilise its position by granting Assembly tickets to as many as 56 sitting MLAs, signalling continuity as a campaign theme.

With anti-incumbency pressures, Opposition factionalism and an emboldened BJP seeking to expand its base, Kerala's electoral landscape appears to be moving beyond its traditional binary.

Whether that shift translates into a durable three-front contest or merely reshapes margins within the existing order will determine if this election marks a structural turning point in the State's politics.

Breaking idli with voters at Indira Canteen

Chitra Narayanan
Kochi

It was not at a public rally but at a breakfast table in Kochi's newly opened Indira Canteen where Ramesh Chennithala, Chairman of the Congress election campaign committee for the 2026 Kerala Assembly polls, kicked off his people-to-people connect.

Over a plate of steaming idlis that he ate with obvious relish, Chennithala and Kochi Mayor VK Minimol chatted with people, turning the spotlight on the affordable canteen in Edapally that is offering citizens breakfast for ₹10. Of course, his whole meal had to be partaken in front of dozens of cameras of mediapersons.

LPG SHORTAGE
Minimol said the canteen had opened just a week ago and was set up in a matter of just 20 days, having been fast-tracked in view of the problems people are facing as hotels and caterers shut down due to LPG shortage.

Speaking to some people — mostly young working professionals — who queued up in front of the swanky looking canteen that was efficiently disbursing the ₹10 breakfast, comprising idli, vada and sambar, it was clear that it had come as a boon.

PEOPLE CONNECT. Ramesh Chennithala and Kochi Mayor VK Minimol at the affordable canteen in Edapally

DAILY VISITS
Shibu described how his hostel canteen had closed and the Indira Canteen providing good food at an affordable price was a great alternative. Minimol said the Indira canteen managed by Kudumbashree and food sourced by their Samridhi central kitchen had been getting an average of 2,000 customers a day; at night, the lines of hungry people are so long that they have had to extend the hours to 10 pm on some days.

For just ₹50 (breakfast at ₹10, lunch for ₹30 and dinner for ₹10), people can get three square meals a day, she said.

bl. video
https://tinyurl.com/INcanteen

UDF'S ACTION PLAN
The Indira Canteen is part of the 50-day, 21 projects action plan of the UDF-governed Kochi Corporation, which also includes *Talk with Mayor* sessions and adalats for complaint redressal of citizens.

One more Indira Canteen is coming up soon in Kochi, said Minimol.

"This is a very good initiative," said Chennithala, adding that even in a big city like Kochi, people are struggling for a good meal. He took the opportunity to take a dig at the failure of the LDF government to provide for the people.

'Cases of 29 lakh voters under adjudication get resolved in West Bengal'

Mithun Das Gupta
Kolkata

Cases related to around 29 lakh voters, among the 60 lakh who were marked as under adjudication in the final voters' list published in February after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in West Bengal, have been resolved so far after due verification, the Election Commission of India said on Monday.

"Under the adjudication process, so far cases of around 29 lakh voters have been resolved," West Bengal's Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Manoj Agarwal told mediapersons here. The Election Commission of India, on February 28, published the State's final electoral rolls after the SIR, which has emerged as a major political issue ahead of the Assembly polls. In the final electoral roll, net deletion of voters stood at over 61.78 lakh after the removal of a total of 63.67 lakh names and the addition of 1.88 lakh names. Additionally, the list noted that the names of around 60.06 lakh voters were under adjudication as of February 28.

According to the Election Commission, the State has 6,44,52,609 total electorate as on February 28, 2026, down from 7,66,37,529 as on October 27, 2025, before the SIR exercise. The poll body earlier said 60.06 lakh "doubtful and pending cases" had been marked under adjudication in the electoral roll. Names approved by judicial officers will be added by way of supplementary list later. The EC has formed as many as 19 Appellate Tribunals for West Bengal to hear disputed case appeals rejected by the judicial officers who have been disposing of the 60.06 lakh under-adjudication cases in the State following the SIR. Notably, total electors during the 2021 Assembly elections stood at 7.33 crore.

QUICKLY.

'Secret understanding between BJP, CPI(M)'

Kochi: Senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala on Monday alleged a "secret understanding" between the BJP and the CPI(M) in candidate selection in constituencies such as Palakkad and Ettumanoor. He claimed that this arrangement involved Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and the Chief Minister, aimed at preventing the Congress from coming to power in Kerala. He added that votes for the BJP would effectively benefit the ruling CPI(M). Chennithala criticised the CM's remarks against senior CPI(M) leader G Sudhakaran, saying such language was inconsistent with Kerala's political culture.

He also accused Vijayan of targeting Rahul Gandhi to appease the BJP leadership, while avoiding criticism of the Centre. Expressing confidence in the United Democratic Front (UDF), Chennithala said the coalition would form the next government in Kerala with a "thumping majority". He dismissed any internal dispute over leadership within the Congress, stating that the party's strength lies in having multiple capable leaders. He also accused the Kerala government of sabotaging the Sabarimala gold smuggling case and misleading devotees on the issue. V SAJEEV KUMAR

EC letter with seal of Kerala BJP triggers row

Thiruvananthapuram: A political row erupted on Monday after a letter from the Election Commission was found carrying the seal of the BJP Kerala unit, prompting sharp reactions from the CPI(M) and the Congress. The controversy surfaced after CPI(M) flagged the issue on social media platform X, sharing an affidavit attached to a March 19, 2019, letter sent to political parties in the country that bore the BJP Kerala seal instead of the Election Commission's official seal.

Reacting to the development, the Election Commission said it was "purely a clerical error" and had been "rectified immediately." In a strongly worded post, the CPI(M) said: "Have all pretences been dropped by the BJP?"

It added: "It is no secret that the same power centre seems to control both the Election Commission of India and the BJP. Even then, at least maintain the courtesy of two separate desks." The party further alleged that "seals are being casually swapped. PTI

PMK intra-party dispute: SC upholds view of HC

New Delhi: Asking PMK founder S Ramadoss to approach the civil court, the Supreme Court on Monday upheld a Madras High Court decision dismissing his two petitions for a direction to the Election Commission to either let his faction use the mango symbol during the upcoming Assembly elections in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry or freeze the symbol. Ramadoss has been fighting a legal battle to restrain his son Anbumani from using the party's name, flag and symbol. A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi said that the EC cannot decide a dispute over the allocation of symbols of an unregistered political party, and if the application is filed by Tuesday for remedy, the civil court may adjudicate it in three days. "The High Court appears to be right in holding that the dispute over allocation of symbol among the two rival groups of an unrecognised political party cannot be decided by the EC. We have gone through the orders passed from time to time and must observe that an aggrieved party must not be left remediless. Since the petitioner has already filed a civil suit, it is open to the petitioner to move an appropriate application before the civil court. If such an application is filed by March 24, we direct the civil court to decide the same after hearing the parties and in accordance with law within a period of three days," the top court ordered. PTI

Namesake candidates across constituencies

Thiruvananthapuram: As the deadline for filing nominations for the Kerala Assembly elections ended on Monday, several candidates are facing the challenge of namesakes in different constituencies. Among those affected are Trinamool Congress leader PV Anvar, Minister P Rajeev, CPI(M) MLA VK Prasanth, Congress leader Praveen Kumar K and Thomas Unniyadan. More such cases are likely to emerge as nomination details are still being uploaded on the official website.

Anvar, who is contesting from Beypore against Tourism Minister PA Muhammad Riyas, son-in-law of Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, is facing as many as four namesakes. Independent candidates Anwar Al Hassan and three others with the name Anvar have filed nominations from Beypore in Kozhikode, where PV Anvar is in the fray. In Kalamassery, an independent candidate named Rajeev has filed nomination paper in the constituency where Minister P Rajeev is contesting. At Thiruvambady, where Muslim League leader CK Kasim is contesting, two other candidates with the same name have also filed nominations. In Vattiyoorkavu, sitting MLA VK Prasanth faces a namesake in independent candidate Prasanth K. PTI

QUICKLY.

Copper up after US postpones strikes on Iran

London: Copper prices jumped on Monday after US President Donald Trump said he will order the US military to postpone any military strikes against Iranian power plants and energy infrastructure. Benchmark copper on the LME was up 1.7 per cent at $12,132 a tonne at 1127 GMT. REUTERS

Sugar futures fall after oil price slumps

London: Raw sugar futures on the ICE fell on Monday after oil prices slumped following comments from US President Donald Trump that he would postpone any strikes on Iranian power plants and energy infrastructure. Raw sugar fell 1 per cent to 15.55 cents per lb at 1253GMT, having earlier hit its highest since October at 15.75. REUTERS

Crude oil plunges by 13% on Iran war development

London: Crude oil prices plunged by more than 13 per cent on Monday after US President Donald Trump said he would postpone military strikes against Iranian power plants for five days. Brent crude futures traded at about $104.1 a barrel at 1130 GMT after sliding as much as 15 per cent to a session low of $96 a barrel. US West Texas Intermediate was down 7.8 per cent at $90.55 after losing 13.5 per cent to a session low of $85.28. REUTERS

Gold rebounds after US defers strikes on Iran's energy assets

WAR IMPACT. Spot gold has fallen over 15% since West Asia conflict began on Feb 28

Reuters

Gold prices trimmed losses on Monday, rebounding from a four-month low hit earlier, after US President Donald Trump's comments postponing planned military strikes on Iranian energy infrastructure sent oil prices plunging.

Spot gold fell 0.4 per cent to $4,470.36 per ounce by 10.53 am ET (1453 GMT), after falling over 8 per cent earlier to a session low of $4,097.99. It posted its worst weekly performance since 1983 on Friday.

US gold futures fell 2.2 per cent to $4,471.60.

"The overnight sell-off was a continuation of the long liquidation we've seen over the past several sessions, driven largely by expectations of rising interest rates. The dramatic reversal came after Trump's post on Truth Social. The headline triggered broad reversals across markets — metals, energy and equities alike," said David Meger, Director of Metals Trading at High Ridge Futures.

TRIMMING LOSSES. Spot gold fell 0.4% to $4,470.36 per ounce by 10.53 am ET

"It's fair to assume that we're going to see volatility continue," he added.

ENERGY PRICES

Higher energy prices due to the Iran war have lately increased bets on rates staying higher for longer. Gold, despite its reputation as an inflation hedge and safe haven, has struggled to benefit as elevated rates raise the opportunity cost of holding the non-yielding metal.

Trump said the US and Iran have held constructive talks and that he would postpone any strikes on power plants and energy infrastructure.

Conversations with Iran will continue throughout the week, he said in a social media post.

However, Iran's Fars news agency, citing a source, said there are no direct or indirect communications with the US.

Following Trump's comments, oil prices plunged and the dollar moved lower. A weaker dollar makes greenback-priced bullion more affordable to other currency holders.

Spot gold prices have fallen over 15 per cent since the West Asia conflict began on February 28, and has retreated about 20 per cent from its record peak of $5,594.82 reached on January 29.

Among other metals, spot silver rose 3.3 per cent to $70.01per ounce, while platinum slipped 1.1 per cent to $1,901.53. Palladium added 3.4 per cent to $1,450.79.

Govt to notify Bt cottonseed price cap for 2026-27 soon

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Union Agriculture Ministry will soon notify the maximum retail price (MRP) of Bt cottonseed for Bollgard I and II varieties for the upcoming kharif season, as sowing is to commence.

Taking a cue from past instances, there may not be an increase in the maximum price this year; however, a final decision will be taken at the top level, industry sources said.

Last year, the government fixed the MRP of Bollgard II at ₹900/packet (of 450 g), up from ₹864/packet in 2024-25. The MRP of Bollgard I remains at ₹635/packet since price control on the Bt cotton seed was introduced in 2016.

"There was a precedence in 2019-20 when the MRP of Bollgard II was kept unchanged at ₹710/packet. Since last year's MRP saw a hike of over 4 per cent compared with only 1 per cent hike in 2024-25, non-increase in price may not impact the industry much," said an industry source.

LEGAL OBLIGATION

The government is currently holding stakeholders meeting on the issue of Bt cotton MRP and sources said it is a legal obligation under the Cotton Seeds Price (Control) Order, 2015 to notify the MRP each year whether there is an increase or not.

But, RSS affiliate Bharatiya Kisan Sangh recently opposed fixing MRP for Bt cotton, saying due to the price fixation of seeds, non-GM cotton is getting sold at ₹300-400/packet. It said since the pest resistance capacity (to PBW) of Bt cotton is questionable, there is no need to declare prices for Bt cotton.

However, official sources said the MRP was first fixed in 2016 and the need for it was felt after farmers were sold Bt cottonseeds at much higher rates. There is a fear that if the prices are not fixed, the farmers may again be charged higher, the sources said, adding that it is the maximum cap and not a floor price.

In a written reply in the Lok Sabha last month, Union Minister of State for Agriculture Ramnath Thakur said about 95 per cent area under cotton cultivation is occupied by Bt cotton.

However, he also said that pink bollworm had developed resistance against Bt protein, and is becoming a major pest in all cotton-growing areas.

Ethanol producers urge govt to increase blending

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The All India Distillers Association (AIDA), the apex body for ethanol, bio-energy and potable alcohol, has urged the government to enhance ethanol blending from 20 per cent to 30 per cent and promote its wider adoption across transport, including flex-fuel vehicles as well as in domestic and industrial cooking applications.

In a representation to the Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways, Nitin Gadkari, AIDA has recommended exploring ethanol blending in diesel to contain fuel costs and further strengthen the country's energy security amid rising global uncertainties.

MORE THAN 20%

"We have achieved the E-20 ethanol blending target well before time, and the credit goes to the vision of our Prime Minister, government policy and enterprises who brought it on ground. Now, with West Asia entangled in a war and oil prices increasing, we as an ethanol industry are ready to offer ethanol more than 20 per cent, which will reduce the import of crude," AIDA said in a letter to Gadkari.

To mitigate the situation caused by the supply disruption of oil, AIDA suggested increasing ethanol blending gradually from 20 per cent to 30 per cent and the introduction of flex vehicles, which can run on 100 per cent ethanol like those in Brazil.

WHAT'S COOKING. AIDA suggested the use of ethanol for cooking by introduction of ethanol burners

Besides, AIDA suggested the use of ethanol for domestic and industrial cooking by introducing ethanol burners and exploring ethanol blending in diesel to contain the costs. Further, the introduction and promotion of ethanol- based stoves can complement the clean cooking option for households, particularly in semi-urban and rural areas and for commercial establishments.

Such an initiative would align with national priorities on clean energy access, reduced indoor air pollution and diversification of fuel resources, it said.

AIDA also said there was a need to accelerate the rollout of flex-fuel vehicles in India. Enabling a wider eco-system of flex-fuels capable of running on higher ethanol blends will be critical in creating sustained demand, it said.

Sugar mills rush export deals on record-low rupee

Reuters
Mumbai

Indian sugar mills have returned to the export market, locking in 1,00,000 tonnes of shipments in a week after a slump in the rupee to a record low and a rally in global prices restored the economics of overseas sales, five dealers told *Reuters*.

Shipments from the world's second biggest sugar producer will help Asian and African consumers to secure sugar at lower prices amid rising freight and global prices, which are trading near the highest level in five months. "The war has suddenly changed everything. It has pushed global sugar prices up in anticipation of higher ethanol demand and dragged the rupee down to a record low," said a Mumbai-based dealer with a global trade house.

"Export deals are finally picking up after weeks of no activity. About 1,00,000 tonnes have already been signed in the past week, and there's likely more to come."

Indian sugar is being offered around $450 per tonne on a FOB basis, with countries, including Sri Lanka, and African nations, such as Djibouti and Somalia, booking shipments for April and May, dealers said.

Unseasonal rain may hit wheat output

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Some of the wheat-growing States may experience 6-8 per cent crop loss, even as the Centre is yet to get reports on the damage to crops from recent unseasonal rains and hailstorms in different parts of the country. This will most likely in States where farmers irrigated their farms 1-2 days before the rain and high wind lashed over the about-to-be-mature crop on the field.

Though some agriculture scientists said the impact will be minimal and could be limited to a few lakh hectares, farmers fear yield losses as well as lustre loss after the crop got water logged.

"As the temperature was very high, I had applied water for two consecutive days only a day before the rain. As the wind was heavy, 60 per cent of wheat plants fell on the field," said Kishore Tyagi, a caretaker of a firm of 30 acres in Meerut district, Uttar Pradesh. Tyagi feared up to 10 per cent drop in yield if there is no sunshine.

4% AREA HARVESTED

The all India wheat harvested area so far is only 4 per cent, though it is almost complete in Gujarat (60 per cent), Karnataka (90 per cent) and Maharashtra (25 per cent), sources said. Harvesting in Madhya Pradesh has started while in UP, Punjab and Haryana it will start from April.

Wheat acreage this year reached a record high of 33.46 million hectares (mh) from 32.80 mh in 2024-25. This will likely help the country harvest a record high of 120.21 million tonnes (mt) of wheat, up 2 per cent from previous high of 117.94 mt in 2024-25, according to the government's second advance estimates of agriculture crops for 2025-26 crop year (July-June).

The government is banking on a higher wheat production and has estimated to procure 30.3 mt for the ensuing 2026-27 rabi Mmarketing season (RMS), which will commence from April 1 under MSP operation. The government has already allowed limited quantity of wheat and wheat products for exports this year, waiving a ban imposed in 2022.

QUALITY MATTERS

"Though a small drop in production may not impact, but if the quality of the wheat gets affected, there will be a rush to buy good quality wheat, which may inflate its price and that may also influence overall market rates. However, food companies, traders, millers and stockists will be cautiously buying this year after making losses from buying at higher rates last season," said a North Indian flour miller.

There was anticipation of bullishness in wheat prices last year and many companies had bought even at ₹2600-2650/quintal from farmgate as against MSP of ₹2400/quintal, he added.

Prices of rabi pulses ease on improving arrivals

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Prices of key rabi pulses such as gram (chana) and lentils (masur) have eased on improving arrivals across key producing regions. They are likely to remain range-bound, as per the trade.

The all-India average wholesale mandi prices of chana eased to ₹5042.55 per quintal for the week ended March 21 against ₹5147.31 the previous week.

Similarly, lentil prices eased to ₹6,778.37 for the week ended March 21 over ₹7,245.51 a week ago, per the UPAG. Both pulses are trending lower than the minimum support price (MSP). The MSP for chana for the 2026-27 rabi marketing season is ₹5,875 per quintal, while for lentils it is ₹7,000 per quintal.

DEEP DIP. The all-India average wholesale mandi prices of chana eased to ₹5,042.55 per quintal for the week ended March 21 over the previous week's ₹5,147.31

"The government has started procurement at MSP, which should support the prices of chana. Prices are unlikely to come down further and may stay range-bound as the landed costs of imports have also gone up due to the ongoing war and geopolitical tensions in West Asia and the weakening of the rupee against the dollar," said Rahul Chauhan of IGrain India.

Also, the procurement of lentils has started, and arrivals are increasing steadily.

The India Pulses & Grains Association (IPGA), in its weekly update, said chana prices are seen range-bound amid weak demand and higher supply expectations.

"Chana prices showed a mixed trend during the week ending March 21 as arrivals increased in major producing States. Prices in most mandis remained below MSP while buying by millers and traders stayed cautious due to weak demand for chana dal and besan," IPGA said. It said the chana imports were estimated at around 6.44 lakh tonnes (lt) by the last week of March, keeping the supply situation comfortable.

IMPORTS DOWN 20%

Imports during the April-January period of the current fiscal were down 20 per cent at 6.88 lt compared to 8.64 lt.

As per the second advance estimates, the production of gram is projected at 117.92 lt, higher than t 111.14 lt a year ago. Similarly, the production of lentils is expected to rise to 17.33 lt over t16.54 lt last year. Punit Bachawat, a miller in Ahmedabad, said the chana crop is good this year due to good rain and conducive climate.

Natural rubber demand set to grow 3.6% driven by auto, EV sectors, says AIRIA

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

The country's natural rubber demand is expected to grow by around 3.6 per cent this year, outpacing several global markets, driven by rising consumption from the automotive and electric vehicle sectors, infrastructure development and expanding export opportunities.

Anay Gupta, President, All India Rubber Industries Association, said the sector is witnessing increased investments in capacity expansion, technology upgrades and export-oriented manufacturing. The industry is entering a new growth cycle, supported by strong domestic demand, rising exports and global supply chain shifts. This momentum is expected to accelerate expansion across both tyre and non-tyre segments, he said.

Amid ongoing supply chain diversification, Gupta said the country is steadily emerging as a key player in the global rubber ecosystem.

RELIABLE ALTERNATIVE

As global companies adopt a "China-plus-one" strategy, India is increasingly being viewed as a reliable sourcing alternative. Trade agreements, including the proposed India–EU FTA, could further enhance export competitiveness, he added.

The global natural rubber market, according to him, is set to remain structurally tight in 2026, with demand projected at 15.6 million tonnes (mt), exceeding expected supply of around 15.2 mt, marking the sixth consecutive year of deficit. This imbalance is being driven by adverse weather conditions, ageing plantations and crop diseases, some of which have reduced yields by up to 30–35 per cent in key regions.

China's decision to levy anti-dumping duties of up to 30 per cent on halogenated butyl rubber imports from India, Japan and Canada signals more than a routine trade correction. It reflects a broader shift towards strategic protectionism in critical industrial inputs.

Such measures are likely to trigger a realignment of global trade flows. Exporters may increasingly pivot towards alternative markets such as ASEAN, Europe and Africa, reducing the dependence on China, he said.

Zinc futures: Go short at ₹305, stop-loss at ₹312

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl.research bureau

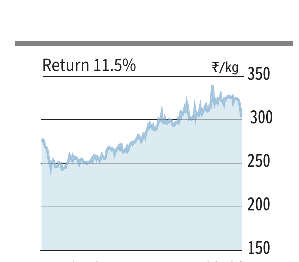
Zinc futures lost 5.2 per cent last week. The March contract is now trading at ₹305 (per kg) after closing at ₹307.65 on Friday.

COMMODITY CALL.

Since early February, the futures have been attempting to break out of the resistance at ₹330. But unable to do so, it was charting a sideways trend.

Bears took advantage of the prolonged consolidation, which led to the contract slipping below the support at ₹317 last week.

Going ahead, the price could drop further. That said, there is a chance for a corrective rally, given that the price band of ₹300-305 is a potential support.



However, the uptick is unlikely to go beyond ₹310.

An eventual breach of the support at ₹300 could drag the contract to ₹290, a support. Subsequent base is at ₹278. On the other hand, if zinc breaks out of ₹310, the upside could extend to ₹315, a notable resistance.

Overall, the bias is bearish, given the prevailing chart set up.

TRADE STRATEGY

Short zinc at the current level of ₹305. Target and stop-loss can be ₹290 and ₹312, respectively.

'Past decade was hottest on record'

In the 176-year record, 2025 was 2nd or 3rd warmest year

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

The World Meteorological Organization (WMO) says the Earth's climate is becoming more unstable, as greenhouse gases are raising temperatures and disturbing natural balance.

The past 10 years (2015–2025) have been the hottest on record. Warming oceans, melting ice and extreme weather affected millions of people, economies and ecosystems around the world, the WMO said in its 'State of the Global Climate 2025' report. According to it, 2025 was the second or third warmest year on record, with temperatures about 1.43°C above the 1850–1900 average.

In the 176-year record, 2025 was the second or third warmest year (depending on the dataset), partly due to a shift to La Niña conditions, which briefly cool the planet. The average global temperature was about 1.43± 0.13°C above the 1850–1900 pre-industrial level.

The year 2024, which started with a strong El Niño, is still the warmest year on record, with temperatures about 1.55°C higher than the average from 1850 to 1900. The ocean continues to warm and absorb carbon dioxide. For the past 20 years, it absorbed energy nearly 18 times the annual human energy use each year.

NEAR RECORD LOWS

The report said Arctic sea ice was at or near record lows, Antarctic sea ice was the third lowest on record, and glaciers continued melting without slowing down. "The State of the Global Climate is in a state of emergency. Planet Earth is being pushed beyond its limits. Every key climate indicator is flashing red," said UN Secretary-General António Guterres.

The WMO released its State of the Global Climate report on Monday to commemorate World Meteorological Day on March 23. The report said the Earth's energy imbalance had been getting worse since records began in 1960, especially in last 20 years, and reached a new high in 2025.

QUICKLY.

RBI announces MPC schedule for FY27

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India on Monday announced the calendar for the bi-monthly monetary policy committee (MPC) meetings for FY27, with the first meeting set for April 6-8. The six-member rate-setting panel, headed by the RBI Governor, will hold six meetings in the next financial year. The second bi-monthly policy review meeting will be held on June 3-5. PTI

EKA bags order for 915 e-buses in Hyderabad

Hyderabad: EKA Mobility, a Pune-based EV and technology company, has received the Letter of Award (LOA) for the supply and deployment of 915 e-buses in Hyderabad. The project will be executed under the Government of India's CESL-led PM E-DRIVE (Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement) Scheme. OUR BUREAU

Deep-tech player Pranos Fusion raises $6.8 million

Bengaluru: Deep-tech player Pranos Fusion has raised $6.8 million in an early-stage funding round co-led by pi Ventures and Ankur Capital. The company said the newly raised capital will advance development across its fusion technology stack, with key activities including the commissioning of a tokamak, continued development of magnet systems, and software-driven design and control capabilities. OUR BUREAU

AM/NS India plant will bring AP to centrestage in steel sector: Naidu

GRAND SCALE. The country's largest plant of 8.2 mtpa in phase one will involve an investment of ₹70,000 crore

G Naga Sridhar
Anakapalli (Andhra Pradesh)

MODEL PROJECT. (from left) Andhra Pradesh CM N Chandrababu Naidu along with ArcelorMittal senior executives and Deputy CM K Pawan Kalyan at the foundation stone laying ceremony for the steel plant at Rajayyapeta in Anakapalli

ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India's greenfield plant in Andhra Pradesh will be the country's largest integrated steel factory and will drive economic development for both the State and the country, according to Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu.

He was addressing the gathering after laying the foundation stone for the project here on Monday.

The upcoming plant, along with the existing Visakhapatnam steel plant, will make the State a strong player in the industry, he noted, and called farmers of the region harbingers of the development as they "came forward to give over 5,000 acres of land".

"Andhra Pradesh is the best place for investments in the country with suitable policies and resources," the CM added.

The plant, coming up at Rajayyapeta in Anakapalli district, will have a capacity of 8.2 million tonnes per annum (mtpa) and will be set up at an outlay of ₹70,000 crore in the first phase.

Manufacturing in the initial lines is expected to kick-start by the first quarter of calendar year 2029.

DEMAND FOR LOCAL

HD Kumaraswamy, Union Minister of Steel & Heavy Industries, said India is moving towards its long-term steel capacity goals under the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision. As India continues its rapid development, the demand for high-quality, domestically-produced steel would only increase, said Lakshmi N Mittal, Executive Chairman, ArcelorMittal.

"The Rajayyapeta plant, with its first-phase capacity of 8.2 mtpa, is designed to meet this demand," he said.

Mittal also credited CM Naidu for his "commitment to industrial development [that] has made this moment possible". He added that the project would create one lakh jobs.

Aditya Mittal, Chairman, ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India, and CEO, ArcelorMittal, said the company progressed to the ground-breaking stage in record speed. "We have actually been here for over 30 years. We have a 11 million tonne pelletiser in Vizag and a slurry pipeline, which connects our pelletiser to the richest iron-ore belt in the country," he said.

The existing infrastructure enables the company to fast-track the project as it could connect the pipeline to Anakapalli district," Aditya Mittal said. "We will also be setting up a metallurgical institute here to train professionals in industry-specific skills," he said.

Highlighting the government's swift clearance of permits, Nara Lokesh, AP Minister for IT & HRD, said, "The government gave approvals in two months and land was given in three months. This is our speed of doing business."

AM/NS Steel India has also signed two memoranda of understanding (MoUs) with the Andhra Pradesh government to build, along with the New Age Makers' Institute of Technology (NAMTECH), a future-ready industrial talent ecosystem in the State.

'Evolving geopolitical situation requires close monitoring'

THE BRIGHT SIDE. RBI staffers said the capacity and resilience of the Indian economy to absorb external shocks have strengthened over time REUTERS

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The evolving geopolitical situation in West Asia requires close monitoring and proactive measures to limit adverse spill overs in view of India's external dependence on crude oil, according to the RBI's latest monthly bulletin.

However, RBI staffers, in the article *State of the Economy* published in the bulletin, emphasised that the capacity and resilience of the Indian economy to absorb external shocks have strengthened over time, buttressed by its strong growth, sound macroeconomic fundamentals and robust external sector buffers.

In terms of energy security, India has progressively diversified its crude oil import sources and augmented its domestic refining capacity, they said.

STEPS TAKEN

Further, since the start of the conflict, several policy measures have been implemented to blunt the immediate impact of the disruptions in global fuel supply chains and to achieve more effective use of domestic capacity to meet shortfalls.

The measures include invoking the Essential Commodities Act to ensure the supply of natural gas to critical industries, ramping up domestic refining of LPG, diplomatic initiatives for securing the safe passage of fuel carriers through the Strait of Hormuz, and measures to prevent hoarding of petroleum products, among others.

The RBI staffers noted that the creation of an Economic Stabilisation Fund would further provide fiscal headroom and buffer to proactively respond to global headwinds.

WORD OF CAUTION

They observed that the conflict in West Asia and the US investigations into trade practices of key trading partners have brought uncertainties regarding global energy security, US import tariffs and global supply chains back to the centrestage.

The RBI staffers cautioned that in March, the widening conflict in West Asia is expected to increase upside risks to global inflation across major economies, as surging energy prices and potential transport disruptions to key shipping routes could renew supply-side pressures.

AP will expedite all 76 proposed investments: Nara Lokesh

G Naga Sridhar
Visakhapatnam

Andhra Pradesh is focusing on ensuring speedy grounding of the 760 projects for which investors had entered into pacts with the State in the last 20 months, said Nara Lokesh, Minister for Human Resources Development and IT Electronics & Communication.

Lokesh was speaking to newspersons on the sidelines of the foundation stone laying ceremony of the ArcelorMittal/Nippon Steel India integrated steel plant in Rajayyapeta, Anakapalli.

"I am personally monitoring the grounding of the projects," he said.

BALANCED GROWTH

Construction of the Bhogapuram international airport is on track and it will be operational in June this year, Lokesh said, adding that the construction of a greenfield capital in Amaravati and the Polavaram project would also be completed on time.

"The State government had adopted a cluster-based approach, in which 22 key industry sectors have been identified as core to the economic development of the State and job creation," the Minister said.

Nara Lokesh, Minister for HRD and IT, Andhra Pradesh

When asked about the priority sectors, he said the government is looking at a comprehensive plan covering all sectors.

"For instance, we have taken a strong position on quantum energy, steel and port-led development. AM/NS India is the second largest investment so far after Google's investment," Lokesh said.

"The upcoming plant would create about one lakh direct and indirect jobs," he added.

To achieve balanced regional growth, the government is following a three-pronged approach. "We have identified three economic regions across the State in Visakhapatnam, Amaravati and Tirupati. We have a master plan for all regions," Lokesh said.

ATTRACTING MORE

"Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu's pro-development image, speed of doing business and the close collaboration with the Centre and support from Prime Minister Narendra Modi drove the recent slew of investments," Lokesh said.

"Andhra Pradesh has attracted 25.3 per cent of total domestic investments so far, which is an indication of the potential of the State," he added.

Fuel scarcity fear sparks panic buying across Gujarat; dealers say no shortage

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Long queues were seen outside petrol pumps across major cities in Gujarat on Monday evening, as panic gripped consumers on a possible fuel shortage amid rising concerns linked to the ongoing West Asia conflict.

In Ahmedabad and Gota, two-wheelers, cars and other vehicles lined up at fuel outlets operated by Nayara Energy till they ran out of stock.

Similar disruptions were reported from Rajkot and Surat, where a handful of petrol pumps shut temporarily after exhausting their available fuel.

However, suppliers assured that there was no disruption or shortage.

"In the last few hours, long queues have been seen at petrol pumps across Ahmedabad. There is no disruption in supply from oil companies or the government. Adequate quantities are available. Out of around 210 pumps in the city, only four or five are currently out of fuel, which appears to have triggered panic," said Arvind Thakker, past President of the Federation of Gujarat Petroleum Dealers Association (FGPDA).

According to FGPDA, about eight petrol pumps in Rajkot and five in Surat faced temporary stock-outs.

"We have been assured by oil marketing companies that there is no shortage of petrol or diesel. Some dealers faced payment-related issues over the weekend, which delayed replenishment. Supplies are ongoing and pumps will be restocked shortly. According to the information coming to us, pumps belonging to Nayara and Bharat Petroleum are the most affected and have reported to have dried out," said Dhimant Ghelani, Secretary of the association.

WIDER NETWORK

Dealers added that outlets of Indian Oil Corporation had been witnessing higher demand due to their wider network, further contributing to localised pressure.

The Gujarat government also issued a statement assuring the public that there was no fuel shortage. Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel held a review meeting on fuel availability in the State.

'Collective action needed to shield small farmers from economic instability'

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The three-day Public Policy Dialogues (PPD) 2026 has called for collective and sustained action, led by farmer producer organisations, cooperatives, self-help groups and other community networks, to lift over 100 million small farmers out of economic vulnerability.

However, this collective prosperity is hampered by implementation challenges, such as the challenge to transition from being solely producers to taking business ownership within FPOs, and women, who perform 70 per cent of agricultural work, remaining largely unrecognised as 'farmers'.

The three-day dialogue, organised by the Bharti Institute of Public Policy (BIPP) at the Indian School of Business (ISB) over the weekend, focused on the theme, 'Food Systems: Moving Beyond Linear Thinking'.

CRITICAL NEED

The discussions underscore the critical need to systematise these fragmented lessons and compile evidence-backed policy reforms, ensuring stakeholders are prepared to push for change during crucial "windows of opportunity".

"While FPOs have seen financial success, a major challenge is getting farmers to take ownership and accountability for running their business, rather than relying on the promoting agencies. Farmers are finding the shift from being solely producers to managing value-chain organisations difficult," an institute statement said here on Monday.

Archimedis Digital eyes ₹100 crore topline in FY27 driven by AI projects

Rohan Das
Chennai

Archimedis Digital, a life sciences-focused IT services company, hopes to double its revenues to ₹100 crore for the fiscal year ending March 2027.

Speaking to *businessline,* Duraisamy Rajan Palani, Founder & CEO, Archimedis Digital, said that the revenue growth would be driven by an increase in AI-related projects.

In the coming fiscal, the company will also double its workforce from the current 250-300, with a majority of the hiring to be focused on the company's newly opened AI centre for excellence in Tiruchirappalli, he added.

Archimedis Digital provides IT and digital transformation services to pharma, biotech and medical device firms.

Duraisamy Rajan Palani, Founder & CEO at Archimedis Digital

The company leverages both life sciences expertise and tech talent to build digital platforms and AI-led solutions, while also supporting and maintaining these systems overtime.

"Our current workforce consists of both domain specialists in life sciences as well as software engineering teams. Looking ahead, we will want to scale our AI teams and expect 50 per cent of the new hires to come with some background on AI, machine learning and data science, while the remaining will be for life sciences domain specialists," he said.

STRONGER EXPANSION

Though predominantly serving clients in the UK and US, the company is expecting stronger expansion in emerging markets in Latin America and India, with the revenue mix from these markets expected to go up from 5 to 15 per cent in FY27.

In terms of the crisis in West Asia, Palani said that for now the services industry is fairly insulated.

"Typically, for our western clients, the financial year is between January and December and hence, the budgeting would have been completed by 2025 itself. So, we are secured for this year, but if there is unrest of more than six months or nine months, we may start to see some impact on the industry," he said.

Telangana to set up panel to expedite Musi river rejuvenation project

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy has announced the State government is ready to constitute a Cabinet Sub-Committee, led by Deputy Chief Minister Bhatti Vikramarka, IT and Industries Minister D Sridhar Babu and Transport Minister Ponnam Prabhakar, on issues related to the Musi rejuvenation Project.

Addressing the Legislative Council here on Monday, he said that the government had formulated a strategy for the development of the Musi river.

He said that those displaced due to the project will be rehabilitated. "We will not render anyone living alongside Musi river homeless nor will we cause harm to even a single individual." Everyone will be rehabilitated, he added.

He also urged the Opposition parties to submit suggestions for the project.

Stating that the government had secured permission to develop an underpass at Begumpet airport, the Chief Minister said the first-of-its-kind project in the country would ease traffic congestion.

METRO EXPANSION

He said the Metro rail expansion works would begin soon. "We have decided to take over the Metro project from L&T. Since the Metro rail lacks last-mile connectivity, we propose to expand it," he said.

CAPF Bill to be introduced in Rajya Sabha today

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The government on Monday deferred introduction of the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Bill, 2026, in the Rajya Sabha, following objections by the Opposition. The Bill is now expected to be introduced in the Upper House on Tuesday for an eight-hour discussion and passage, said a source.

The opposition alleged that an attempt was made to introduce the Bill without discussing it in the Business Advisory Committee (BAC), and that copies of the Bill were not circulated 48 hours in advance as per the rules.

TMC MP Derek O'Brien raised a point of order to protest against the introduction of the CAPF Bill as he questioned why copies of the legislation were not circulated among the members of the Upper House.

BYPASSING DISSENT? Opposition party members said copies of the Bill were not circulated among members of the House 48 hours in advance, as per the rules ANI

The government, however, mentioned its intent at the BAC about introducing the Bill in the meeting at 5 pm on Monday. It will then go to the Lok Sabha for another round of deliberation, before final nod from Parliament.

At the Rajya Sabha BAC, sources said the Congress, the TMC, the AAP and the CPM objected to its introduction as "it violated the Supreme Court verdict".

PARTIES' CONTENTION

On May 23, 2025, the top court had granted Organised Group 'A' status to CAPF officers and called for a phased reduction in their deputation of Indian Police Service (IPS) officers to the forces.

Aam Aadmi Party MP Sanjay Singh raised concerns regarding the promotion structure and working conditions of personnel in the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) and the Border Security Force (BSF). One of the issues flagged by him was that CAPF personnel, particularly Deputy Commandants and Assistant Commandants, face significant delays in promotions (15-18 years) in comparison to IPS officers, impacting their morale.

IBA urges Delhi govt to blend 20% biogas in CNG

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Indian Biogas Association (IBA) has suggested to the Delhi government that it pursue up to 20 per cent blending of compressed biogas into compressed natural gas as it can bring gaseous (vehicular) mobility close to carbon neutrality.

The IBA has submitted its recommendations on the Draft Delhi Electric Vehicle Policy to the government, urging policymakers to adopt an integrated clean mobility approach that combines electric vehicles, CNG and CBG to deliver immediate and scalable emissions reductions.

QUICKLY.

E-filing portal to facilitate compliance: I-T Dept

New Delhi: The Income Tax Department on Monday said its e-filing portal will facilitate compliance under the old Income Tax Acts, and all assessments, appeals and other proceedings relating to earlier years will continue to be conducted under the old Act until their final resolution. In a set of FAQs issued days before the implementation of the new Income Tax Act, 2025, the I-T Department said taxpayers filing returns for AY 2026-27 (pertaining to the period governed by the old Act) in July 2026 will do so using the forms prescribed under the old Act. At the same time, advance tax payments for Tax Year 2026-27 will be made in line with the new Act. PTI

RBI likely to review HDFC Bank's push for Jagdishan's third term

DOWNWARD SPIRAL. Bank's stock continued to take a beating, plunging to a fresh 52-week low of ₹740.95

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The dramatic exit last week of Atanu Chakraborty as Part-Time Chairman of HDFC Bank may prompt the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to take a long, hard look when the bank makes an application for a third term for its MD and CEO, Sashidhar Jagdishan.

Sources versed with the central bank approval process said when a bank chief's tenure comes up for renewal, the RBI scrutiny is not restricted to balance-sheet growth and financial health.

The process, with the "fit and proper" criteria at its heart, includes examining whether issues raised by the directors were discussed and resolved; looking into regulatory violations/whistleblower complaints and how they were addressed; and personal transgression, if any. "There is no smoke without fire. Things are not quite adding up, given that the Chairman left hastily and the bank's directors emphasised that everything is hunky-dory," they said.

Chakraborty quit the bank's board on March 17, citing "certain happenings and practices within the bank that I have observed over last two years, are not in congruence with my personal values and ethics."

Sashidhar Jagdishan, MD & CEO, HDFC Bank

Atanu Chakraborty, former Part-Time Chairman

STOCK TAKES A HIT

The HDFC Bank stock continued to take a beating, plunging to a fresh 52-week low of ₹740.95 on Monday, with trading sentiments negatively influenced by Chakraborty's sudden resignation and continued pessimism in the stock.

Among large private sector lenders, HDFC Bank's stock declined the most (4.70 per cent). The stock had fallen nearly 12 per cent in four trading sessions.

Suresh Ganapathy, Managing Director and Head of Financial Services Research at Macquarie Capital, in a flash note on the developments at HDFC Bank, said: "We remove HDFC Bank from our marquee buy list. Near-term underperformance may remain, while fundamentals remain strong with good ROA."

Also, now the uncertainty surrounding MD and CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan's reappointment will weigh on the stock, he said. Ganapathy observed that key risks include a slowdown in growth and more governance issues cropping up.

RESIGNATION DRAMA

In his resignation letter of March 17, 2026, Chakraborty said: "I joined the board of HDFC Bank in May 2021. My tenure on the board saw momentous events like the merger of the bank with HDFC Ltd, which created a conglomerate under the bank."

The Bank's Interim Part-Time Chairman, Keki Mistry, noted that, at the age of 71, he would not take on the responsibility as Chairman for three months if the systems, processes, and governance practices in the bank did not align with "his principles and his level of integrity".

Govt restores full RoDTEP rates to support exporters

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In a move that would give some relief to exporters grappling with trade disruptions due to the West Asia crisis, the government has restored full benefits under the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme, reversing a sharp cut in rates announced last month.

"RoDTEP benefits shall be available at the rates and value caps as applicable on February 22, 2026, thereby withdrawing the earlier restriction of 50 per cent notified vide notification... dated February 23, 2026," the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), said in a notification issued on Monday.

The restored rates will apply for the period from February 23 to March 31, 2026.

SLIGHT RELIEF

The latest notification is in line with earlier assurances from the DGFT to exporters' bodies, such as FIEO, that full RoDTEP rates would be made available from April 1, 2026, providing continuity of support beyond the current fiscal year.

The RoDTEP scheme refunds embedded taxes and duties that are not otherwise reimbursed, and is seen as a crucial support mechanism for exporters across sectors such as engineering goods, textiles and chemicals.

Exporters, who had strongly flagged concerns over the cut, are now relieved.

EFFORTS WELCOMED

"The Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI) welcomes efforts being made to de-escalate the situation in West Asia and hopes the talks will ensure an early return to normalcy," said Chandrima Chatterjee, Secretary General, CITI.

The latest notification is in line with earlier assurances from the DGFT to exporters' bodies, providing continuity

PAST DEDUCTIONS

India's textile and apparel industry has already been adversely impacted by the turbulence in West Asia, with raw material availability, supply chains and industrial energy requirements being affected, she pointed out.

While the DGFT decision is welcome, the initial reduction was hard to justify as RoDTEP is not a subsidy and it simply refunds taxes exporters have already paid, pointed out Ajay Srivastava from research body GTRI.

Cutting rates arbitrarily makes little sense unless earlier rates were wrongly fixed, he stated.

"For exporters operating on tight margins, stable incentives are critical for pricing and long-term planning. Locking in RoDTEP rates for the next five years would provide that certainty, enabling firms to integrate these refunds into cost structures and compete more effectively in global markets," Srivastava noted.

We're well-placed to navigate evolving landscape: Novo Nordisk

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

As the marketplace begins to see generic versions of semaglutide, in vials, pre-filled pens and tablets, to treat obesity and Type II diabetes — Danish healthcare company Novo Nordisk believes it is well placed to navigate this "evolving landscape".

Semaglutide is the active ingredient in Novo's globally popular products — injectables Ozempic (for diabetes) and Wegovy (obesity), and oral tablet Rybelsus (diabetes) per cent — and a patent on this ingredient expired last Friday, opening up the generics market in India, among other countries.

Industry-insiders cite IQVIA data (December 2025) estimating the global semaglutide market at $68 billion — though, this could not be independently verified.

SLICE OF SEGMENT

With several companies looking to get a slice of this segment, the weekend witnessed launches from over a handful of major Indian drugmakers, including Dr Reddy's Laboratories, Zydus Lifesciences, Sun Pharma, Torrent Pharma, Glenmark Pharma, USV and Eris Lifesciences — their versions of semaglutide pegged at prices ranging between 50 to 80 per cent lower than innovator Novo's products. The domestic market for semaglutide is estimated to be about $1 billion, according to industry representatives.

Vikrant Shrotriya, Managing Director, Novo Nordisk India

"We are driven by patients, not patents," Vikrant Shrotriya, Managing Director, Novo Nordisk India, said in an e-mailed response to *businessline*, as generics readied to launch over the weekend. "Patent expiry is a natural part of the pharmaceutical product lifecycle, and we are well-positioned to navigate this evolving landscape," he added.

Novo's Wegovy's price ranges between ₹2,700 and ₹4,100 per week; and its Ozempic ranges ₹2,200-2,793 per week, in pen formats. The oral tablet Rybelsus is over ₹8,900 a month.

LOCALISED PRICING

Pointing to Novo's price reduction last November, Shrotriya said, "We made a 37 per cent reduction in our prices for injectable semaglutide in India which has helped us gain momentum and acceleration in the market."

Further, he pointed out, "In India, we have a localised pricing strategy and partnerships in place that enable us to expand access and offer a comprehensive semaglutide portfolio across orals and injectables to meet as many patients' needs as possible. We continuously assess market dynamics and will continue to evaluate partnerships that help us serve our patients better."

Novo's products in India are distributed by Abbott, who in fact have also launched a second brand of semaglutide for diabetes — ie generic Ozempic, in other words. Novo had also tied-up with Pune's Emcure to launch a second brand of semaglutide for obesity — or generic Wegovy.

Retailers register 9 per cent growth in February

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Retailers in India recorded a nine per cent year-on-year growth in February, reflecting a normalisation in consumption following a strong festive-led performance in November and December, according to the latest survey released by the Retailers Association of India (RAI).

But the industry body flagged concerns about rising costs for the sector amid the West Asia conflict.

Despite demand tapering down post festival season, the industry body said the February data indicates that growth has stabilised at a healthy level, with consumption trends remaining resilient supported by sustained urban demand and ongoing contribution from non-metro markets.

Kumar Rajagopalan, Chief Executive Officer, RAI, said, "after a strong festive-led performance in November and December, retail growth in February reflects a normalisation to more stable consumption levels. The broad-based performance across regions and continued strength in key categories such as apparel and food and grocery indicate that consumption remains steady."

SIGNIFICANT CHALLENGE. Growth in the coming months will depend on how effectively retailers navigate cost pressures

He added that while consumption remains stable, but the operating environment is becoming more complex. "At the same time, retailers are beginning to feel the impact of rising input costs, particularly on account of global developments around energy markets. The evolving geopolitical situation in the Gulf region adds an additional layer of uncertainty, and its implications for fuel prices could pose challenges for the sector going forward. Growth in the coming months will depend on how effectively retailers navigate cost pressures while continuing to serve an increasingly diverse and evolving consumer base," Rajagopalan added.

ENERGY SUPPLY

The global geopolitical developments, including tensions has affected key energy supply routes, and expected to influence inflation and logistics costs but the immediate impact on consumer demand has so far remained limited. In terms of geographic regions, in February retailers in the West and East reported relatively higher growth at 10 per cent each year on year.

This was followed by North and South India at nine per cent and eight per cent respectively. Category-wise, apparel and clothing, along with food and grocery, led growth at 12 per cent and 11 per cent respectively. Footwear segment garnered 10 per cent growth. Furniture and furnishings, jewellery and quick service restaurant segments posted a growth of nine per cent each.

However, consumer durables and sports goods segment posted a growth of seven per cent each in February. "Looking ahead, retail growth is expected to be driven by underlying demand fundamentals including expansion in non-metro markets, improving supply chain efficiencies, and continued evolution in retail formats," RAI said.

Malaysia and Singapore stepping up promotions to woo Indian tourists

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Tourism boards are stepping up promotions as Indians look East for their summer holidays.

This comes amid the ongoing West Asia conflict, which has limited flights and increased fares to Europe and the US. Trips to and via West Asia are also being postponed.

BUNDLED INCENTIVES

While Singapore Tourism Board has partnered with Visa to offer curated benefits and rewards to Indian travellers, Malaysia's tourism authority is engaging with airlines, hotels and travel agents to roll out offers.

Tourism Malaysia's incentives include free night stay, bundled with shopping vouchers, theme park tickets, and other offers.

"This is to counter the current situation as well as to support our Visit Malaysia 2026 campaign. Our focus is on domestic tourism and regional/Asia Pacific travel markets," an executive from Tourism Malaysia said.

"We are in the process of rolling out targeted promotions for the upcoming summer holiday season, which is traditionally a strong period for travel," Tourism Authority of Thailand (TAT) said.

"India remains a priority market for us and we are committed to sustaining and growing this relationship through focused engagement and on-ground support," it added.

TOP DESTINATIONS

According to a *Bloomberg* report, luxury hotels in Thailand and have slashed rates, especially for local residents, to make up for the drop in international visitors.

Over 32 million Indians travelled overseas in 2025 for various purposes such as work, pilgrimage, education and leisure travel.

Five South-East Asian countries featured in the top 20 destinations for Indians.

While Thailand was ranked number three (2.2 million visitors), Singapore stood fifth (1.5 million visitors).

Others in the list include Malaysia (10th), Vietnam (13th) and Indonesia (15th).

BOOKING SPIKE

Online portals ixigo and Cleartrip have seen are seeing an increase in bookings for South-East Asia.

"As anticipated, travel to West Asian destinations is impacted. Alternate destinations such as Vietnam, Bali, the Philippines, Thailand, Singapore and Australia have benefited, especially for leisure and honeymoon travel," said Anil Kalsi, Vice-President, the Travel Agents' Federation of India.

60% of Indian professionals in US not planning to return, says survey

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Despite the rapid expansion of global capability centres (GCCs) and engineering hubs across India, nearly 60 per cent of respondents to a Blind survey say they are not considering a move back within the next two-three years, showing that job creation alone is not enough to bring talent back.

The survey is based on responses from 2,316 Indian professionals currently working in the United States on Blind.

When asked how much of a pay cut they would accept, around 33 per cent say they would not accept any, ruling out a return to India under current compensation levels.

Another 45 per cent say they would accept reductions only up to 50 per cent, indicating that for most, returning is not an option unless compensation remains broadly comparable.

Even among those open to returning, only 19 per cent are actively planning or preparing to move, while the majority say they would only consider returning under external pressures such as layoffs or visa uncertainty.

MOBILITY PATHWAYS

Return intent is relatively higher among employees at companies with established India operations.

At companies such as Snap, Walmart, Intel, ServiceNow and Capital One, 62 per cent to 80 per cent of respondents express willingness to return, likely reflecting clearer internal mobility pathways and the presence of local engineering hubs. However, even within this group, willingness to return depends on job continuity and stability.

Recent discussions on Blind suggest that many Indian professionals succeed despite the system, not because of it.

One user from Adobe wrote, "If India wants to produce the next Surya Midha, the one who builds here, employs here, and compounds wealth here, then the conversation needs to be about ecosystems, not scorecards."

Another user from Microsoft added, "Most Indians succeed not because of India but despite India," highlighting that improvements in workplace conditions, career growth, and overall professional ecosystems may be just as critical as job creation and corporate investment.

Dhurandhar 2 grosses ₹761 crore in opening weekend

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In line with industry expectations, *Dhurandhar: The Revenge* has grossed ₹761 crore in worldwide box office collections in the opening weekend. At the India box office, the movie garnered gross box office collections of ₹550 crore and net collections of ₹466 crore during this period. At the same time, it has garnered overseas collections of ₹211 crore in the four-day period.

NET COLLECTIONS

According to Jio Studios & B62 Studios, the movie garnered net collections of ₹145 crore on day 1 at the domestic box office on Thursday, which includes collections of paid preview shows that were held on Wednesday.

The movie's net India collections stood at ₹83 crore on Friday, ₹117 crore on Saturday and ₹121 crore on Sunday. Trade analyst Taran Adarsh said the movie has set a new record in terms of fastest film to garner ₹300 crore and ₹400 crore in collections. "#*Dhurandhar2* has set new benchmarks over the extended weekend – the hype is unbelievable, unprecedented, and unimaginable. From the paid previews [Wednesday, 5 pm onwards] to Sunday, #*Dhurandhar2* remains unstoppable, facing capacity issues at several locations despite round the clock screenings," said Adarsh on X.

BIG SUCCESS. A still from *Dhurandhar: The Revenge*, written and directed by Aditya Dhar

According to trade website Sacnilk, the spy action thriller delivered a "4-day extended opening weekend collection of around ₹430 crore net in Hindi", making it the "biggest first week grosser of all-time in a single language at the Indian box office" beating *Pushpa 2* (₹425.10 crore).

WELCOME JOLT

The spy action thriller, which is written and directed by Aditya Dhar, is a sequel to the 2025 film, *Dhurandhar*. The film's success has come as a respite for the multiplex industry, which had been witnessing sluggish collections during Q4 FY26.

Karan Taurani, EVP, Elara Securities in an analyst report last week, had stated that Q4FY26 box office collections had been largely tepid before the release of *Dhurandhar: The Revenge* except for success of movies such as *Border 2* (and the regional language movie, *The Raja Saab*). The movie will aid higher footfalls and is also expected to drive higher average ticket price for premium formats, he noted.

CHENNAI
businessline.
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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	151.02	143.04	148.90	150.47	140.65	166.18	284.10	142.00	9	144.20
360 One WAM	1040.60	985.40	1040.60	1040.60	973.90	550.43	1273.80	790.50	-	-
3i Infotech	13.82	13.49	14.15	14.15	13.06	1428.78	27.45	12.68	-	-
3M India	32270.00	31100.00	31960.00	32035.00	31000.00	4.04	38300.00	26800.05	107	31070.90
5PAISA	291.60	279.20	286.20	290.75	278.15	70.67	435.95	278.15	30	279.00
63 MoonsTe [5]	531.45	484.30	520.80	520.80	481.00	486.27	1130.00	482.00	53	484.40
Hind Uni [1]	2082.70	2052.20	2062.30	2097.00	2033.30	2599.54	2734.31	2033.00	45	2054.10
HIND.CONST [1]	15.44	14.23	15.25	15.30	14.15	42325.80	31.47	14.17	10	14.27
HIND.COPP [5]	489.45	449.15	475.00	475.95	445.70	14250.50	759.20	183.90	65	449.20
Hind.Foods	482.15	467.15	478.00	478.00	461.60	63.18	608.00	421.50	-	-
Hind.oil Exp	128.43	122.26	128.43	128.43	120.10	1544.70	197.80	117.90	9	121.85
Hind.Znc [2]	514.75	487.65	499.35	499.50	484.00	9206.59	732.60	385.05	18	487.70
HINDALCO [1]	874.25	840.25	855.00	857.35	835.95	11372.79	1029.60	546.25	22	839.30
Hindware HME	197.14	180.69	195.49	196.50	179.40	255.66	392.70	179.40	-	-
Hitech Pipes	75.54	72.01	74.30	74.50	71.50	1104.80	235.00	117.30	28	135.60
HLE Glascoat	286.30	277.35	286.25	286.30	274.00	110.28	661.95	230.00	-	-
HLV	6.92	6.60	6.94	6.95	6.45	806.98	15.75	6.45	-	-
HMA Agro Ind	23.96	23.20	23.50	24.29	23.05	1627.16	38.00	22.92	-	-
Home FirstFi	936.00	905.20	932.10	932.10	894.00	323.86	1519.00	878.40	-	-
Honasa Cons.	289.20	281.05	285.00	286.40	277.75	263.61	334.20	212.51	-	-
Honda Siel	2021.90	1951.70	2010.00	2010.00	1920.00	5.29	3251.00	1827.20	24	1953.25
HONEYWELL	28330.00	27215.00	28150.00	28190.00	27105.00	4.97	41599.80	27016.90	47	27224.15
HP Adhesive	30.76	29.47	30.76	32.60	29.25	164.54	57.55	29.25	-	-
HPCL	336.30	319.15	324.00	329.65	316.20	13182.56	508.45	316.20	4	319.25
HPL	283.55	269.15	283.50	283.55	265.45	290.19	639.50	265.90	19	269.30
Hubtown	198.28	184.85	191.00	194.87	183.46	852.76	366.00	149.90	21	184.95
HUDCO	172.48	165.11	170.00	170.01	164.00	5959.08	253.80	164.15	12	165.05
Huhtamaki In	162.93	153.60	160.08	160.49	151.70	211.94	272.65	151.70	-	-
HyundaiMotor	1951.00	1867.50	1940.00	1940.90	1860.00	371.72	2890.00	1541.70	-	-
I										
ICE Make Ref	764.00	707.40	755.30	760.00	701.45	64.83	1088.75	666.30	-	-
ICICI Bank [2]	1245.40	1222.70	1226.60	1234.90	1218.10	17049.53	1494.10	1218.00	18	1222.65
ICICI PRU AMC	2804.00	2690.30	2763.00	2774.50	2651.00	467.34	3193.00	2530.00	-	-
ICICIGI	1777.20	1722.20	1761.00	1771.30	1706.00	1369.46	2074.85	1660.20	31	1722.45
ICICIPruLife	552.10	531.25	545.00	550.05	528.90	1050.33	706.50	517.00	56	531.05
ICRA	5203.50	5135.00	5153.00	5205.00	5060.00	4.15	7135.35	5070.00	37	5145.00
IDBI	73.07	67.39	71.30	71.30	66.45	36421.79	118.45	66.50	8	67.35
Ideaforge	417.95	397.60	417.90	417.90	394.40	363.34	659.85	304.20	-	-
IDFCFirstBnk	62.95	60.24	62.47	62.47	59.94	40208.24	87.00	52.46	-	-
IEX [1]	120.53	115.38	118.71	119.42	114.72	7773.47	215.40	114.80	22	115.45
IFB	977.90	923.90	975.00	975.00	917.90	45.27	2024.90	920.00	28	924.85
IFB Agro	763.25	725.45	758.95	759.00	725.10	17.19	1795.00	441.00	13	722.45
IFCI	53.99	50.56	53.00	53.00	50.34	11545.26	74.50	35.67	45	50.59
IG Petro	384.85	360.05	387.00	387.50	356.90	136.91	519.00	317.80	159	357.95
Igarshi Mot	314.90	298.05	314.00	314.00	294.90	65.21	665.45	295.00	69	297.60
IIFL [2]	473.00	453.50	466.80	467.00	443.60	1518.71	674.95	305.55	28	453.40
IIFL Capital	269.80	255.05	267.00	267.00	253.55	455.01	411.30	180.00	-	-
IKIO Light.	116.98	107.79	115.00	115.01	106.35	181.73	289.95	106.35	-	-
IL & FS INVE [2]	6.91	6.41	6.85	6.90	6.02	1066.70	10.65	6.03	-	6.42
Imagica Wrld	39.98	37.58	38.15	39.76	37.05	1003.81	75.55	37.05	-	-
Ind Glycols [5]	876.25	816.65	876.25	876.25	811.00	143.39	1222.85	502.50	24	818.40
Ind.Inv.Tru	133.07	134.63	130.06	135.00	122.99	26.40	265.80	121.40	52	134.25
Ind.Shelt.Fi	686.15	667.50	685.00	690.05	654.50	147.26	1011.75	650.00	-	-
Indegene	440.65	423.50	432.50	437.20	414.00	422.09	632.90	414.00	-	-
IndHumPip [2]	323.75	307.55	318.90	318.90	304.65	53.13	490.00	297.95	15	305.50
India Nippon [5]	735.20	710.25	735.20	735.25	705.00	24.15	1099.95	565.00	16	711.45
India Pesti.	136.99	126.72	136.99	136.99	125.10	275.39	245.84	123.11	-	-
Indiabulls	9.94	9.23	9.91	9.91	9.14	7493.53	21.25	8.90	-	-
IndiaCements	359.85	349.45	351.00	356.05	345.25	211.67	489.65	252.55	-	349.30
IndiaMart In	1994.40	1970.50	1961.00	1995.70	1943.10	200.50	2799.00	1900.10	-	-
Indian Bank	878.65	838.20	861.00	869.90	833.00	1677.11	1000.00	519.50	9	839.45
Indian Htl [1]	615.55	582.45	610.55	611.00	580.85	3495.22	858.85	581.00	52	582.50
INDIAN MET	1235.30	1179.70	1224.10	1224.10	1173.00	94.11	1511.05	550.85	17	1178.75
IndianOilCo	144.60	138.11	141.49	142.69	137.75	21048.47	188.90	120.05	6	138.05
IndianOverBk	33.72	32.11	33.50	33.50	31.80	6478.30	45.19	31.58	13	32.18
IndiaTour De	426.70	390.05	424.00	424.15	386.55	75.16	714.05	387.55	41	391.00
IndigoPaints	743.75	712.95	738.00	738.00	711.00	134.20	1345.90	711.00	-	-
IndiqubeSpac	148.05	135.56	141.05	147.50	132.05	96.51	243.80	132.05	-	-
Indo Amines	88.27	82.12	87.89	87.89	81.90	167.20	176.25	81.90	-	-
INDO COU [2]	233.45	224.75	229.00	231.45	216.90	330.08	350.70	210.70	38	224.90
Indo Farm Eq	125.99	119.36	125.00	125.00	118.00	211.45	271.69	118.00	-	-
Indo Nationl [5]	293.90	273.55	294.70	295.25	268.00	24.58	589.00	271.00	-	276.55
Indo Rama	31.35	31.52	31.35	31.81	29.00	985.79	74.94	29.05	7	31.65
INDO THAI [1]	252.15	258.20	253.85	264.75	245.70	1027.61	470.00	144.00	74	256.55
Indo US BIo	104.19	102.55	104.19	106.00	100.11	59.60	206.00	96.05	-	-
IndocoRem [2]	192.20	182.93	189.32	194.29	181.70	37.92	348.10	181.90	-	182.70
IndogulfCrop	58.64	53.60	58.94	58.94	52.25	186.74	122.00	52.25	-	-
INDOSTAR	199.10	183.32	196.10	196.10	179.03	315.69	368.55	180.00	-	184.15
IndoTech Tra	1298.10	1233.50	1278.90	1279.60	1225.00	24.19	2790.15	1138.95	15	1232.25
Indrapra Gas [2]	156.63	147.98	156.00	156.00	147.40	1791.09	229.20	147.60	14	148.05
Indraprastha	396.25	369.10	389.00	390.25	365.00	312.16	640.05	326.00	18	369.70
IndSwifLab	141.51	134.03	137.57	147.00	133.00	470.47	151.95	67.15	24	134.30
IndusInd BK	818.60	778.35	806.30	809.00	771.90	7448.05	968.60	618.05	-	778.00
IndusTowers	434.55	413.60	430.00	430.00	411.80	4793.43	481.50	312.55	-	-
INFO EDGE [2]	978.20	974.70	970.00	979.80	954.30	1489.51	1549.00	931.00	58	974.10
Infobeans Te	139.73	131.42	136.50	136.90	129.32	801.46	1030.00	120.33	-	-
INFOSYS [5]	1255.90	1256.80	1238.20	1261.10	1227.40	12420.29	1727.85	1215.15	18	1258.10
Ingersoll	3647.50	3537.80	3640.00	3654.10	3466.00	16.51	4449.95	3070.00	40	3533.85
Innova Cap	679.60	665.55	670.00	680.95	655.95	30.99	1020.70	622.00	-	-
Innovana Th.	353.30	344.35	356.65	358.35	334.00	24.51	649.50	270.50	-	-
INNOVISION	519.00	374.20	467.70	470.00	374.20	7314.99	470.00	374.20	-	-
Inox Grn Enr	150.40	135.01	150.00	150.00	132.58	7985.95	279.00	104.00	-	-
Inox India	1180.70	1162.90	1164.00	1179.00	1151.10	106.17	1288.00	892.25	-	-
Inox Wind	81.84	76.15	80.78	80.78	75.63	15237.53	198.14	75.70	20	76.21
INSECTCID	574.85	569.80	573.00	596.95	546.15	47.35	1096.30	531.60	12	568.70
INSOLATION EN	101.30	94.75	101.30	101.30	94.00	560.71	104.90	91.11	-	-
INTELLECT [5]	650.55	636.80	648.00	654.25	634.40	346.02	1255.00	555.05	38	636.25
INTENS TE [2]	83.98	77.61	85.70	85.70	76.00	61.56	149.90	75.80	-	77.55
InterarchBui	1742.40	1673.60	1738.90	1738.90	1650.00	82.40	2762.60	1264.00	-	-
InterGlobeAv	4149.10	3945.30	4069.80	4103.90	3895.20	2919.61	6225.05	3894.80	34	3946.55
Intl Convey.	69.74	65.46	70.00	70.00	64.09	123.24	114.54	64.09	-	-
Intl Gemm In	338.45	318.80	334.80	334.80	316.00	430.19	442.00	287.00	-	-
Inventu Know	1332.80	1274.90	1320.00	1323.90	1262.00	182.46	1876.00	1236.80	-	-
IOL Chem [2]	74.36	71.56	74.25	74.25	71.11	1152.90	126.60	57.51	17	71.60
Ion Exch	338.05	317.25	337.05	337.05	312.70	364.62	580.75	312.70	-	-
Ipca Lab [1]	1544.90	1529.90	1543.60	1550.00	1488.30	178.46	1624.00	1200.00	39	1532.80
IRB INFRA [1]	41.51	40.24	41.00	41.28	39.77	9897.36	54.38	36.99	27	40.24
IRCON	123.68	115.24	122.00	122.00	114.50	4720.61	225.52	114.50	-	-
IREDA	116.37	110.51	115.00	115.05	110.00	10405.78	186.58	110.00	-	-
IRFC	94.69	89.45	93.50	93.65	89.20	17225.37	148.95	89.20	-	-
IRIS Cloth.	29.50	27.83	29.50	29.50	27.31	364.63	68.70	27.31	-	-
IRM Energy	199.19	186.44	198.90	198.90	185.00	128.05	393.00	185.00	-	-
IRTC	522.85	510.30	520.00	522.80	506.60	2589.94	820.25	506.60	-	-
ISGEC Hvy	888.15	883.05	885.00	890.00	860.00	82.31	1281.30	683.95	-	-
ITC [1]	299.95	290.45	298.90	299.00	289.55	31788.16	444.15	289.60	18	290.40
ITC Hotels	149.01	140.11	147.86	147.86	139.10	9802.61	261.62	139.10	-	-
ITI	270.60	253.45	266.00	269.00	250.05	1289.60	372.95	232.90	-	254.60
IValue Infos	235.38	212.60	230.39	231.90	207.35	147.42	340.00	207.35	-	-
IWIND ENERGY	8.83	8.42	8.98	8.98	8.25	387.34	23.71	8.00	-	8.42
Ixigo	173.54	166.57	170.55	172.40	162.65	1909.22	339.15	123.29	-	-
J										
J KUMAR INF [5]	488.30	460.80	480.00	480.20	454.10	946.68	764.00	454.50	9	466.80
J&K Bank [1]	118.82	109.33	115.68	116.31	108.00	8331.74	128.45	82.01	6	109.25
J.K.INDUST [2]	417.25	392.05	411.00	411.55	390.00	877.06	611.60	231.65	16	392.20
Jagran Prak [2]	61.13	59.85	61.17	61.17	59.77	368.20	83.99	59.72	5	59.90
Jagson Phar [2]	183.34	182.15	181.32	182.68	180.00	126.97	301.80	154.90	29	182.60
Jai Corp [1]	102.12	94.69	100.80	100.80	93.15	1306.36	178.00	81.27	10	94.30
JaiBalaj.Ind	64.68	57.76	63.07	63.65	57.50	4728.87	668.00	81.00	-	-
JAIN IRRIG [2]	30.17	27.67	29.99	30.01	27.10	11954.32	66.40	27.37	-	27.76
Jain Resourc	441.20	439.65	438.00	444.40	417.50	1755.48	461.00	247.57	-	-
Jamna Aut [1]	119.68	112.44	117.88	117.88	111.26	2106.54	152.50	70.00	19	112.60
Jana SFB	349.25	343.65	349.25	349.25	330.00	325.53	552.50	330.00	-	-
Jaro InsofT	486.15	457.50	478.00	478.00	444.60	207.52	890.00	386.00	-	-
Jash Engg	368.50	344.30	362.50	368.00	337.20	152.76	698.95	337.20	-	-
JAY NECO IND	74.24	68.90	71.80	73.49	68.40	5417.20	94.30	26.06	18	69.22
JayBh Maru [2]	85.88	78.72	86.30	86.30	78.50	341.83	115.63	55.32	10	78.90
Jaykay Enter	132.62	124.13	130.62	131.79	123.24	129.19	219.70	122.89	-	-
Jayshree [5]	80.61	77.04	79.35	79.90	76.60	59.80	122.40	73.35	58	76.95
JB Chem [1]	2138.60	2080.30	2138.60	2138.60	2069.20	254.45	2195.00	1303.00	46	2082.85
JBM Auto [1]	567.25	540.70	556.00	569.40	533.00	2165.43	790.00	477.00	79	540.35
JeenaSikhoLi	611.30	586.65	605.00	605.00	574.15	202.46	2450.00	400.25	-	-
JG Chem.	332.00	315.15	331.20	331.20	312.50	118.11	558.00	280.45	-	-
JHS Svend	7.93	6.84	7.99	7.99	6.55	804.07	16.20	6.80	-	6.89
JIN POLY INV	1165.70	1086.00	1152.60	1174.70	1071.20	90.74	1480.00	660.00	1	1089.05
Jindal Drill [5]	475.25	459.10	475.25	475.25	452.70	334.46	954.00	440.00	7	461.20
Jindal Saw [1]	194.13	179.11	192.01	192.01	177.72	4015.76	285.00	153.20	10	179.20
JINDAL SOUTH	15142.00	13817.00	14700.00	14964.00	13700.00	14.82	27760.50	13700.00	128	13810.50
Jindal Sta [2]	721.95	695.70	720.45	721.00	691.50	591.70	883.25	497.00	21	696.05
Jindal Ste [1]	1186.50	1106.20	1162.00	1169.80	1101.60	1880.24	1270.00	770.00	26	1105.95
Jindal Wor [1]	21.32	19.67	20.98	21.00	19.10	618.67	79.32	19.45	-	19.61
JindalPho	1141.40	1058.50	1141.40	1142.70	1022.30	78.84	1634.80	618.55	253	1078.80
JioFin Servi	239.30	226.10	236.20	236.30	225.40	21172.07	338.60	203.10	-	-
JK Cement	5000.00	4878.50	4950.00	5011.00	4822.50	110.51	7565.00	4464.00	34	4876.65
JK Lakshmi [5]	592.85	577.80	592.85	592.85	575.00	110.19	1020.85	575.00	15	577.90
JK PAPER	336.90	315.25	333.80	337.20	312.00	327.06	444.45	294.50	26	315.10
JM Financial [1]	123.16	117.66	120.56	120.57	115.84	3779.26	199.75	78.00	14	117.50
JNK India	237.53	223.39	233.50	234.21	220.50	134.39	419.55	200.92	-	-
JPPOWER	16.36	14.67	15.50	15.64	14.46	164508.97	27.62	12.60	-	14.66
JSW Cement	116.13	113.09	114.55	114.70	112.40	2988.03	162.15	106.65	-	-
JSW energy	507.05	482.70	506.80	506.80	480.00	3486.91	578.85	428.00	94	482.60
JSW Infra	251.15	241.30	248.15	249.00	240.00	1840.14	349.00	240.00	-	-
JSWSL [1]	1169.60	1109.60	1153.80	1153.80	1102.50	2532.22	1284.55	907.25	38	1110.85
JTL Indus.	52.11	49.41	51.33	51.61	49.10	2294.87	85.99	49.10	-	-
Jub.Ingrevia	583.30	565.15	582.55	582.60	552.00	268.92	851.80	535.20	-	-
Jub.Pharmova	831.35	816.20	815.00	831.30	804.15	171.24	1248.00	786.05	-	-
Jubilant Agr	1657.50	1549.70	1634.10	1642.40	1505.00	7.15	3013.40	1020.00	-	-
JUBL FOOD [2]	451.55	438.05	448.00	448.00	436.20	960.42	743.95	437.00	118	438.30
Juniper Hot	204.63	193.43	204.62	204.62	192.50	137.28	345.55	192.50	-	-
Jupiter Life	1268.90	1258.20	1272.90	1272.90	1235.40	13.04	1770.00	1198.80	-	-
Jupiter Wag	262.60	252.60	259.40	259.40	249.00	1712.00	457.00	246.20	-	-
JUSTDIAL	520.40	500.75	517.95	517.95	499.50	205.26	1049.85	499.00	7	500.15
JYOTHY LAB [1]	208.55	199.60	208.00	208.00	199.00	580.45	399.95	199.00	21	199.55
Jyoti CNC Au	739.95	722.45	739.95	739.95	704.00	348.71	1330.00	686.75	-	-
Jyoti Struct [2]	10.46	9.75	10.35	10.36	9.62	14347.35	22.19	7.92	-	9.74
K										
K.P.R. MILL [1]	823.10	822.75	817.95	833.00	804.00	556.33	1395.40	796.05	48	822.70
KabraExtrus [5]	208.95	194.95	208.10	209.55	192.80	72.11	332.75	180.40	-	195.00
Kajaria Cere [1]	951.35	890.85	958.05	958.05	877.60	465.32	1322.00	745.00	40	884.05
Kalpataru Lt	296.25	282.90	295.00	296.15	281.10	57.77	457.40	281.10	-	-
KalpataruPro	1071.00	1018.10	1060.00	1060.00	1007.10	264.25	1335.60	786.30	-	-
Kalyan Jwl.	382.70	362.70	378.70	378.70	361.10	3830.72	617.70	347.50	-	-
KALYANI ST [5]	651.65	638.05	649.00	654.00	625.15	68.68	988.00	625.05	10	635.95
Kamat Hotels	182.56	162.57	179.37	179.37	160.95	116.51	368.95	160.25	12	161.80
KAMDHENU [1]	21.12	19.26	21.01	21.02	19.06	2711.63	35.96	19.04	7	19.29
Kamdhenu Ven	4.29	4.13	4.16	4.26	3.97	585.91	12.49	3.95	-	-
Kanpur Plast	178.57	157.83	179.00	179.00	151.25	30.51	249.50	104.50	-	-
Kansai Nero [1]	166.77	159.07	166.00	166.00	157.91	414.53	274.80	158.00	20	159.20
Karnataka Bk	228.93	214.50	223.00	225.96	212.50	3367.72	239.00	163.10	7	214.55
KarurVysya [2]	263.90	261.15	259.00	263.50	255.55	3652.47	343.55	158.37	11	261.15
KAVERI SEED [2]	814.00	785.40	801.80	814.00	772.05	328.46	1601.85	705.80	14	784.95
KAYA L	282.95	252.25	283.50	283.50	248.35	66.95	486.90	220.00	-	252.45
KaynesTech	3620.60	3409.70	3550.00	3596.00	3347.00	1495.67	7705.00	3294.90	-	-
KCP [1]	137.50	128.20	135.12	136.00	127.00	322.91	229.80	126.80	17	127.95
KCP Sugar [1]	23.82	23.01	24.15	24.15	22.70	212.04	33.40	15.75	-	-
KDDL	2195.40	2102.50	2155.00	2173.00	2079.30	23.87	3350.00	2067.25	40	2100.35
KEC Inter [2]	546.10	514.85	540.00	540.30	511.90	506.07	947.30	511.50	36	514.25
KEI Inds [2]	4188.00	3990.50	4110.00	4121.50	3937.00	370.26	5301.10	2443.70	44	3989.20
KELLTONT [1]	16.09	15.43	15.80	15.80	15.31	2164.06	33.10	14.57	-	15.39
Kernex Micro	962.00	905.00	951.00	953.30	900.00	165.74	1433.95	672.05	31	906.50
Kesoram Ind	8.05	7.81	8.20	8.20	7.41	1241.89	14.25	2.94	-	7.72
Kewal Kiran	426.85	413.05	423.00	427.10	408.35	101.33	594.35	408.75	19	415.05
Keystone Rlt	375.05	370.65	365.00	373.00	358.80	41.16	697.00	358.80	-	-
KFIN Tech	914.55	877.60	910.00	911.40	870.00	910.42	1388.50	828.80	-	-
KHADIM	88.01	85.29	88.48	89.99	80.92	856.86	310.70	81.35	16	84.90
Khaitan Chm	48.85	46.82	48.06	48.49	46.26	189.84	135.80	43.17	-	-
KILITCH DRUG	316.10	313.60	321.00	325.00	312.35	57.99	490.00	265.50	37	315.20
Kilos oil [2]	1376.70	1287.70	1366.20	1371.00	1275.20	228.16	1529.40	585.75	40	1286.05
KIMS	645.10	630.50	641.00	641.05	619.00	388.27	798.40	528.05	-	-
KIOCL	351.75	324.60	342.00	348.80	321.15	1402.50	634.35	188.15	-	324.70
KIRI DYES	374.85	357.90	369.00	371.95	354.90	936.78	778.00	355.05	80	358.55
KIRL INDUS	2735.80	2631.50	2725.00	2725.00	2619.20	11.31	4650.00	2620.00	36	2626.75
KIRL.BROS. [2]	1561.40	1483.00	1552.90	1556.10	1470.00	48.91	2475.55	1405.65	45	1482.85
Kirlosk.Elec	83.35	83.17	81.89	86.80	79.96	494.58	100.80	26.95	16	-
Kirlosk.Pne	1050.70	1041.60	1040.00	1060.70	1033.20	93.73	1550.00	990.10	-	-
KITEX GARM [1]	159.40	150.21	156.00	156.62	149.00	803.32	320.95	138.45	41	150.50
Knowledg.Mar	1545.20	1443.10	1535.00	1535.00	1409.00	136.19	3758.50	1264.05	-	-
KNR CONST [2]	118.01	114.06	117.50	117.50	111.00	1512.36	254.15	111.10	19	113.85
KOHINORF	22.69	21.96	23.00	23.00	21.50	80.74	46.00	21.50	-	21.75
KOLTEPATIL	324.65	323.10	324.60	330.00	317.25	80.61	497.80	310.00	90	323.70
Kopran Ltd	118.22	114.08	118.90	118.99	110.80	337.42	214.65	110.90	27	114.90
Kotak Mah [1]	366.75	356.55	364.85	364.90	355.25	16980.24	460.31	355.30	26	356.35
KOTHARI PR [5]	110.88	106.39	110.88	110.88	104.00	70.38	0.15	0.05	-	-
KOTYARK IN	371.00	386.05	373.00	399.40	364.00	54.46	399.40	316.00	-	-
KP Energy	279.20	264.50	277.00	278.00	262.55	218.13	583.70	237.90	-	-
KPI Grn Enr	378.00	357.95	373.25	375.00	356.00	930.22	563.00	335.65	-	-
KPIT Tech	660.95	659.30	650.00	662.90	645.55	2233.58	1434.50	624.90	-	-
KRBL. [1]	287.35	285.20	287.35	294.90	282.35	865.24	495.00	225.70	10	285.35
Krishana Ph.	487.20	469.00	479.90	479.90	466.20	62.56	619.00	210.00	-	-
Krishna def	898.40	838.80	888.00	891.70	825.70	165.83	1240.00	601.00	-	-
Kriti Ind.	68.63	60.09	67.00	69.96	58.63	170.38	177.51	58.63	-	-
KRN Heat Ex.	896.85	847.95	885.00	890.00	831.50	655.23	1031.80	589.80	-	-
Kronox Lab	110.65	104.53	109.00	110.64	103.72	57.23	207.49	103.72	-	-
Kross	171.69	160.65	172.68	172.68	157.70	457.48	237.60	150.06	-	-
Krsnaa Dia.	587.65	574.30	580.00	586.40	567.35	71.19	894.40	567.35	-	-
KSB	782.30	782.85	777.70	788.80	757.05	536.55	912.00	647.80	-	-
KSH Internat	434.20	434.90	427.10	443.75	414.00	330.73	443.75	330.00	-	-
KSolves Ind	275.45	260.25	270.00	273.00	258.00	76.83	497.00	250.05	-	-
Kuantum Pap.	77.63	71.99	75.05	76.33	71.51	174.51	135.00	71.51	-	-
KWALITY WALL'S	23.53	23.18	23.53	23.55	22.42	9903.96	31.29	22.42	-	-
L										
L & T [2]	3434.80	3342.40	3405.10	3409.90	3288.10	5645.84	4440.00	2967.65	41	3341.90
L&T Finance	261.20	247.65	260.20	260.25	245.60	8126.74	329.45	140.00	-	-
Lal path lab	1308.20	1307.60	1295.10	1326.50	1272.60	367.17	1771.30	1187.50	41	1306.50
Landmark Car	360.40	368.25	357.00	378.90	347.25	133.82	662.80	329.80	-	-
LA-OPALA [2]	184.05	177.14	182.00	183.96	176.22	139.23	286.00	176.00	19	177.90
Latent View	267.35	249.60	265.00	265.05	248.00	1294.82	517.50	248.00	-	-
Laurus Labs [2]	987.20	961.40	979.10	981.40	957.40	1068.05	1140.90	517.05	65	961.55
Laxmi Organ.	120.16	112.90	119.40	119.40	112.10	837.19	241.00	110.15	-	-
LaxmiDent	173.71	168.45	173.00	174.70	166.43	139.27	509.95	166.43	-	-
LaxmiIndFin	82.55	82.00	82.00	83.99	77.61	287.52	180.90	77.61	-	-
LEMONTREE	105.66	102.14	104.00	104.27	100.50	3842.04	180.60	99.70	70	102.10
Lenskart Sol	526.20	501.50	507.70	513.00	483.05	2283.56	543.90	356.10	-	-
LG Balkrish	1710.00	1651.30	1684.00	1707.90	1642.00	31.82	2096.95	1080.00	18	1650.75
LG Electroni	1559.70	1484.60	1535.00	1539.00	1450.00	823.65	1749.00	1325.50	-	-
LIC	776.75	740.00	766.00	768.90	737.05	1315.50	980.00	737.05	-	-
LIC Housing [2]	486.15	460.70	483.00	483.70	458.90	3943.61	646.60	459.05	5	461.00
LikhithaInfr	141.74	133.15	141.50	141.50	131.45	97.64	324.00	131.45	-	-
Lincoln Phar	600.40	586.85	582.00	600.60	582.00	34.47	679.45	439.95	13	585.55
LINDEINDIA	7014.50	6765.00	7015.00	7025.00	6558.00	71.88	7865.05	5202.45	99	6760.85
Lloyds Engg	41.30	38.20	40.92	40.92	38.00	7931.18	84.27	38.00	-	-
Lloyds Met.	1245.80	1209.60	1230.00	1234.00	1186.40	1480.25	1612.00	1015.00	-	-
LMW	13702.00	12607.00	13701.00	13701.00	12500.00	8.40	18250.00	12500.00	-	-
Lokesh Machi	198.33	191.45	195.07	197.99	190.95	52.88	255.90	138.00	-	190.40
Looyds Ent.	45.40	42.17	44.80	44.89	41.66	3585.22	96.40	41.30	-	-
LT Foods	378.45	364.00	375.90	375.90	362.00	515.46	518.55	288.25	-	-
LTIMINDTREE	4298.80	4105.60	4236.00	4236.00	4071.00	569.41	6429.50	3802.00	-	-
LTTS [2]	3229.10	3075.60	3219.90	3219.90	3050.00	129.80	4746.95	3046.85	26	3085.65
Lumax Ind	5055.50	4808.00	4950.00	4963.00	4720.00	20.13	6969.90	2200.00	30	4813.05
Lumax Tech [2]	1568.00	1480.40	1560.20	1560.20	1465.20	146.58	1823.75	452.55	115	1479.05
Lupin Ltd. [2]	2322.50	2296.70	2319.70	2321.00	2282.10	1092.16	2376.00	1774.00	19	2297.20
LUXIND [2]	941.10	926.35	938.35	964.00	908.10	149.45	1640.00	805.05	25	926.15
Lyka Labs	54.95	49.83	55.90	55.90	49.50	345.20	128.60	49.41	-	49.96
M										
M&M FinSer [2]	308.35	293.05	306.00	307.40	290.00	1619.23	412.30	235.46	16	293.00
Macpower CNC	849.80	853.10	835.20	883.00	831.95	38.02	1090.00	723.00	-	-
Macrote.Dev.	796.90	727.90	789.00	789.00	724.00	4129.35	1531.00	724.00	-	-
Madhya Bh.Ag	453.05	441.50	447.00	448.65	437.25	330.61	489.45	240.00	-	-
Magadh Suagr	459.45	436.45	455.00	461.45	431.00	21.36	814.00	413.00	7	436.20
MagellanicCl	21.75	20.75	21.73	21.73	20.67	1436.48	105.42	20.67	-	-
MAH HOLIDAY	256.75	248.00	256.00	256.00	246.05	106.75	381.55	241.00	20	247.75
Mah Logis	365.70	349.00	363.50	363.50	346.00	225.23	435.35	218.20	93	347.80
Mah&Mah [5]	3066.10	2955.80	3015.10	3019.70	2935.00	3978.74	3840.00	2360.45	24	2956.55
Mah.seamle [5]	564.75	537.70	559.85	559.95	535.05	155.31	774.00	500.00	8	538.00
Maha.Scooter	12441.00	11891.00	12489.00	12489.00	11822.00	6.39	18526.00	9225.05	44	11906.00
MAHINDRALIFE	341.40	324.15	339.00	339.00	321.60	121.54	428.35	253.81	94	323.00
Maithan All	935.30	864.60	914.00	918.90	855.00	63.54	1265.00	834.05	6	868.10
MamataMach	374.00	352.75	369.00	372.35	350.05	93.24	541.00	311.55	-	-
Man ind [5]	371.40	337.15	365.00	365.85	331.10	700.84	490.90	248.95	15	337.05
Man Infra [2]	91.09	85.80	90.01	90.32	85.10	943.41	191.90	85.35	22	86.10
Manali Petro [5]	45.51	42.12	44.60	44.72	42.00	542.99	81.00	42.05	-	42.16
Manappur [2]	259.25	252.30	252.90	254.95	245.15	7400.34	320.95	219.65	14	252.40
Manba Fin.	114.27	109.40	112.50	113.98	108.10	117.20	159.50	108.10	-	-
MandB Eng	271.05	248.00	262.50	264.60	246.00	257.61	535.90	246.00	-	-
Mangalam Cem	833.80	807.90	817.20	825.65	800.00	133.43	939.30	640.00	27	804.10
Mangalam Glo	10.49	11.71	10.35	12.30	10.19	6145.49	18.40	9.53	-	-
Mangalam Wor	265.65	252.05	260.85	260.85	246.00	92.88	295.95	150.00	-	-
MangalElec	231.46	218.33	229.06	229.06	212.80	81.00	573.70	212.80	-	-
Manindra EPC	115.58	105.66	115.00	115.00	105.00	70.92	185.12	105.00	-	-
Mankind Phr	2000.00	1927.40	1980.00	1984.80	1909.70	654.19	2716.50	1909.70	-	-
ManojVaibGem	143.18	140.36	141.90	141.90	136.81	111.47	280.00	136.81	-	-
Manomay Tex	203.47	200.28	205.00	209.40	198.11	77.88	259.88	154.10	-	-
Manorama Ind	1271.90	1207.40	1250.00	1250.00	1190.60	149.59	1760.00	849.95	-	-
Marath NX [5]	418.95	406.85	418.40	418.40	394.05	181.94	774.55	368.40	16	408.05
MARICOLTD [1]	744.30	725.30	734.80	744.80	723.55	1774.60	813.10	623.10	49	725.05
Marine Elec.	170.73	161.67	166.24	170.00	161.00	362.70	258.00	155.10	-	-
MARKSANS [1]	170.05	160.20	168.21	168.50	157.20	914.29	270.60	157.25	29	159.90
MARSONS	133.97	125.87	133.97	134.85	124.02	413.76	152.00	124.02	-	-
Maruti Udy [5]	12601.00	12355.00	12501.00	12501.00	12278.00	517.99	17371.60	11072.20	27	12354.05
MASFIN	302.55	293.30	309.55	309.55	286.00	142.75	354.95	230.35	15	292.40
Mastek [5]	1449.50	1382.60	1430.70	1448.10	1376.00	96.73	2817.75	1375.55	22	1382.30
Master Trust	68.77	62.30	68.77	68.77	62.05	195.14	174.40	62.05	-	-
MATRIMONY [5]	423.45	409.85	416.80	422.40	404.10	29.04	598.95	363.30	27	411.20
Mawana Sugar	82.60	81.78	80.75	84.00	80.15	78.67	111.80	75.00	6	81.50
Max Estate	368.90	340.25	364.90	364.90	335.90	133.77	564.30	335.90	-	-
Max Healthca	964.80	956.90	964.00	971.30	937.30	3063.87	1314.30	933.80	-	-
Max India	145.16	138.32	144.91	144.91	137.06	76.70	241.57	137.06	-	-
MAYUR UNI [5]	509.35	493.20	504.70	504.70	488.00	100.55	629.30	434.90	12	493.30
Mazagon Dock	2324.10	2206.70	2290.00	2302.70	2185.20	1695.95	3775.00	2125.90	-	-
Mazda Ltd [2]	171.31	171.78	171.50	192.90	168.87	87.10	337.90	170.00	13	172.50
MBL INFRA	22.08	20.31	21.90	21.90	20.05	551.83	56.90	20.10	-	20.49
MCLEOD RU [5]	34.74	32.31	34.20	34.47	32.11	839.70	68.73	29.65	-	32.55
MCX [2]	2414.50	2314.40	2400.00	2402.50	2260.00	6653.73	2706.00	905.35	82	2314.80
Medi Assist	325.15	304.55	325.05	325.05	302.10	165.58	594.10	294.70	-	-
Medicam.Bio	253.60	240.15	250.00	252.35	237.00	64.95	544.00	237.00	-	-
Medico Reme.	38.15	34.95	38.15	38.18	33.30	165.41	62.48	33.30	-	-
Medplus Hlth	820.65	797.75	819.90	819.90	793.40	73.17	1045.30	678.05	-	-
Meesho	144.60	141.87	143.90	144.50	139.11	6338.69	254.40	125.56	-	-
MeghamaniOrg	42.62	40.37	41.85	42.10	40.05	1458.90	106.30	40.05	-	-
Menon Bear [1]	118.11	112.57	118.11	119.37	111.60	133.73	145.20	73.00	24	112.70
Metro Brand	930.70	902.60	925.00	930.50	894.40	53.36	1340.40	892.80	-	-
METROPOL [2]	441.10	450.20	434.50	475.00	421.20	193.69	564.83	345.93	65	447.50
MFL	60.66	58.21	59.16	60.25	57.20	149.02	24.70	12.15	-	-
MFSL [2]	1639.30	1567.50	1630.50	1630.50	1553.50	1451.85	1891.35	1090.65	-	1566.45
MGL	967.10	908.40	960.00	960.50	900.00	476.87	1586.00	902.00	9	908.75
MIC Electr.	32.81	31.31	32.81	32.81	31.17	878.73	82.97	31.17	-	-
Midhani	315.30	293.85	313.00	313.00	292.00	639.70	468.40	217.05	50	293.90
Midwest Ltd	1239.10	1187.20	1250.00	1259.00	1172.20	43.52	1859.90	1048.50	-	-
MINDACORP [2]	502.50	490.85	492.50	494.85	484.15	145.05	644.35	445.25	58	491.35
MindTeck(I)	170.00	160.97	169.02	169.04	158.50	62.49	307.00	141.00	23	160.85
MINERAL& [1]	60.04	55.72	58.00	58.30	55.34	4707.00	88.20	42.55	-	55.74
Mirc Elect [1]	25.49	23.38	24.90	24.90	23.10	1027.66	37.47	10.30	-	23.44
Mirza Intl [2]	29.35	27.59	29.03	29.32	27.12	159.00	43.84	26.25	-	27.66
MM Forgings	428.25	413.20	427.40	431.00	406.80	118.13	500.00	276.05	20	415.60
Mnkcmil Ltd [1]	106.16	100.89	106.15	106.15	97.10	415.61	182.80	74.03	26	101.40
Modison	125.96	114.59	125.01	125.01	114.00	58.14	197.45	112.00	-	-
MOIL	291.60	285.25	286.00	291.00	276.00	1499.59	405.50	242.65	20	285.20
Mold-Tek T [2]	123.22	115.59	120.00	122.99	114.45	51.12	220.05	109.00	58	115.75
MOLDTKPA [5]	512.15	477.75	509.15	509.15	475.00	110.82	890.00	415.00	23	478.20
Monarch Netw	268.00	245.55	269.35	269.35	243.20	136.56	398.80	239.85	-	-
Montecarlo	525.35	497.85	514.90	514.90	496.00	20.80	865.00	489.80	11	498.05
Morepen [2]	36.99	35.33	36.59	36.75	35.10	3329.98	70.40	33.47	34	35.28
Moschip Tech	165.72	157.06	163.50	163.60	156.43	1380.86	288.45	129.98	-	-
Mothersn Sum	36.98	35.89	36.89	36.89	35.70	17364.25	65.96	35.70	-	-
MOTILALOFS [1]	662.60	628.20	653.00	654.80	614.90	1147.20	1097.00	487.85	39	628.05
Motisons Jwl	13.05	12.14	13.05	13.05	12.01	2386.35	24.02	10.62	-	-
MPHASIS	2091.10	2063.60	2079.90	2090.40	2039.00	471.39	3035.15	2025.05	28	2064.50
MPS	1506.00	1445.40	1480.60	1496.00	1432.70	38.36	3071.85	1340.00	21	1448.00
MRF	127535.00	124975.00	127515.00	127515.00	123455.00	7.96	163500.00	107388.65	24	125062.45
MRPL	191.19	183.15	191.14	195.64	181.15	19049.66	214.95	114.40	15	183.20
Mrs.Bect.Fd	182.84	176.02	182.84	182.84	175.00	382.81	1654.00	174.38	-	-
MSP Stl	30.04	28.05	29.99	29.99	27.22	1139.80	41.25	23.56	-	27.64
MSTC	415.65	391.45	415.00	415.00	382.25	239.78	582.45	382.25	-	-
MTAR Tech	3525.30	3372.20	3475.00	3501.80	3321.30	186.29	3920.00	1155.60	-	-
MTNL	24.75	23.25	24.30	24.36	23.04	1435.25	58.00	23.07	-	23.23
MufinGreen	102.99	98.51	103.00	103.22	97.00	542.00	126.34	63.11	-	-
Mukand Ind	126.39	120.11	122.65	124.49	119.26	77.89	160.85	84.64	18	120.40
Mukka Protin	21.13	20.32	21.20	21.32	20.16	369.28	34.79	20.16	-	-
Munj Auto [2]	74.14	70.78	72.90	73.29	70.14	98.87	114.60	60.04	23	70.07
MUTHOOT CAP	196.53	180.82	194.70	194.70	175.25	74.16	366.70	178.00	24	181.60
Muthoot Fin	3315.90	3115.60	3190.00	3220.50	3042.10	2186.87	4149.00	1964.35	15	3114.10
Muthoot MFin	150.85	148.50	148.01	153.68	141.20	304.55	199.39	120.00	-	-
N										
N C L IND.	169.80	162.65	169.10	169.50	160.06	157.03	239.20	162.00	11	163.30
NagarAgri [1]	137.99	131.10	133.25	137.00	131.10	130.36	309.41	89.81	-	130.35
NAHAR CAP [5]	225.85	210.01	239.00	239.00	209.01	46.79	376.40	207.05	12	210.65
NALWA SONS	5365.50	5122.00	5310.00	5360.50	5075.00	9.76	8777.60	5110.00	132	5122.35
Nandan Den [1]	2.23	2.08	2.21	2.21	2.05	2913.66	4.41	2.05	-	2.08
Nandani Crea	28.62	27.10	28.66	29.00	25.80	83.07	54.59	25.80	-	-
Natco Pha [2]	959.20	927.55	960.00	965.25	924.40	714.37	1059.60	660.05	11	927.75
NATIONAL FER	69.39	67.40	68.95	68.95	66.05	1828.38	112.11	66.10	22	67.66
NationalAl [5]	368.50	349.75	357.50	361.20	347.00	14168.01	431.60	140.00	10	349.75
Nava	553.50	544.45	545.15	552.65	537.00	385.86	735.00	396.30	-	-
Navin Fluori [2]	6124.00	5886.50	6061.00	6093.50	5866.00	112.39	6960.00	3664.55	68	5884.95
NAVKARCORP	82.77	80.25	81.15	82.72	79.32	303.50	140.35	79.47	-	80.32
Navneet Edu [2]	127.07	123.69	125.00	127.46	123.12	198.11	168.00	123.15	15	124.10
Nazara Tech	235.35	217.65	233.00	233.10	215.70	1575.87	1453.00	215.70	-	-
NBCC [1]	83.91	79.09	82.90	82.96	78.87	12197.51	130.60	75.01	34	79.10
NCC [2]	140.59	132.29	140.00	140.00	131.16	3581.06	242.00	131.30	13	132.35
NDR AutoComp	681.55	639.85	667.95	676.35	635.00	33.30	1220.00	572.85	-	-
NDTV [4]	69.95	66.02	67.11	69.98	65.00	260.81	140.54	65.10	-	66.32
NELCAST [2]	119.83	118.35	117.44	119.90	116.00	135.42	180.65	80.37	22	118.15
Nelco Ltd.	587.35	537.95	585.00	585.00	532.20	113.14	1161.50	533.55	292	538.65
Neogen Chem	1336.40	1249.60	1310.00	1325.00	1244.40	58.50	1797.90	966.70	-	-

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TUESDAY - MARCH 24 - 2026

Exchange Traded Funds

Company	Pre Cl	NSE Cl	Vol	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
InvesInNifty	2638.50	2575.00	0.09	3150.00	2511.00	-
Kotak Nifty	255.23	248.49	715.92	320.00	238.25	-
Kotak PSU Bk	856.15	825.90	48.39	1010.00	585.31	-
KOTAKMAMC - QUALITY30	19.33	18.49	38.68	23.18	18.09	-
KtakGold ETF	122.53	111.23	16451.79	158.00	68.01	-
KtakMACM-Alp	44.75	42.97	4585.26	53.60	39.00	-
KtakMAC-NV20	13.92	13.87	160.03	168.70	13.00	-
KtakMAMC-Con	10.97	10.71	73.44	132.00	10.20	-
KtakMAMC-IT	32.15	32.17	562.75	44.49	31.14	-
KtkMAMCMid50	15.89	15.33	1238.11	183.48	15.18	-
LIC MF-LIC GOLD ETF	131.50	121.10	903.84	16200.00	117.85	-
LICna-LICnfe	257.14	250.74	0.74	293.04	251.39	251.42
LICNAMC -CNFESGP	841.49	812.74	0.37	989.00	808.11	-
LICNAMC-LICNMFET	28.85	28.57	896.09	30.05	27.27	-
LICNAMC-LICNMID100	55.34	53.13	13.14	67.50	48.50	-
LICNAMCNFNHGP	258.90	252.40	1.01	296.41	242.47	-
Liquid BeEs [1000]	999.99	1000.00	3765.90	1004.99	994.00	999.99
MIRAEAMC - BANKPSU	86.17	82.65	28.76	99.52	59.80	-
MIRAEAMC - CONSUMER	10.19	9.78	508.16	12.87	9.00	-
MIRAEAMC - DEFENCE	63.48	60.61	252.18	72.00	60.33	-
MIRAEAMC - DIVIDEND	34.30	33.25	43.77	38.03	33.15	-
MIRAEAMC-MAFSETF	25.52	24.76	841.44	29.94	23.38	-
MIRAEAMC-MAGOLDETF	142.39	130.75	7662.26	173.50	78.03	-
MIRAEAMC-MAGS	29.95	29.60	8.66	31.00	28.15	-
MIRAEAMC-MAHKTECH	22.84	21.66	2555.71	35.59	17.56	-
MIRAEAMC-MAM150ETF	20.62	19.86	10744.79	23.61	16.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MAMFGETF	147.31	142.62	106.80	164.84	119.50	-
MIRAEAMC-MAN50ETF	250.08	243.30	1572.25	289.05	226.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MANV30F	193.06	188.60	5.14	219.10	180.04	-
MIRAEAMC-MANXT50	656.18	630.57	195.99	738.15	580.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MASPTOP50	67.90	67.16	502.79	73.13	40.86	-
MIRAEAMC-SENSEXETF	76.46	74.60	90.05	88.70	72.01	-
MOTIAMC-MOHEALTH	42.95	41.79	78.60	47.57	37.96	-
MOTIAMC-MOLOWVOL	35.60	34.37	62.76	43.07	33.05	-
MOTIAMC-MOMOMEN	57.49	55.33	353.93	66.37	51.21	-
MotilAMCMODe	85.20	81.25	5872.11	102.00	61.70	-
MOTIOSMIDCAP100ETF	59.13	56.87	1259.38	69.20	50.50	-
MOTIOSNASDAQ100ETF	225.96	219.18	1314.99	258.80	159.30	-
SBI-ETF NIFTY BANK	546.43	528.38	666.94	646.11	465.64	-
SBI-ETFNN50	682.25	656.68	208.39	840.00	585.51	-
Sharia BeEs	446.89	439.88	12.23	529.39	437.32	440.44
Shriram LiqS	1096.81	1096.96	25.39	1096.97	1044.58	-
TataAML Gold	14.24	13.07	278802.36	17.70	7.14	-
TATAAML-NETF	252.93	245.15	20.04	292.90	227.05	-
TATAAML-NPBET	260.21	252.03	2.25	307.00	250.43	-
TataAMLSilv	22.34	19.74	341041.35	35.10	8.56	-
TATAAML-TNIDETF	77.85	76.66	145.63	103.26	75.04	-
UnionAMCGold	144.05	131.20	17.36	177.00	85.00	-
UTIAMC-BANKBETA	54.98	53.03	1154.83	73.70	48.74	-
UTIAMC-NIFTYBETA	255.26	248.52	353.66	297.48	235.00	-
UTIAMC-SENSEXBETA	821.03	800.05	16.89	952.91	779.95	-
UTIAMC-SILVERBETA	221.67	192.80	6138.91	379.66	85.08	-
UTIAMC-SNXT50BETA	83.90	82.02	8.82	102.25	75.74	-
UTIAMC-UTIGOLDBETA	123.00	113.50	3340.16	149.35	71.10	-
WEALTH - TWCGOLDETF	145.71	134.72	19.04	187.98	123.31	-
ZerodhaA-Gol	23.03	21.11	50282.47	27.94	12.83	-
ZerodhAMCGil	29.93	29.73	125.72	30.94	28.71	-
ZerodhAMCSil	23.27	20.37	49608.61	38.01	9.00	-
ZerodhAM-Nif	9.21	8.98	8132.70	10.97	8.94	-

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Shaily Eng [2]	2396.70	2210.25
Shanti Edu. [1]	163.40	149.80
Shanti Gold In	184.80	176.30
Share India [2]	125.10	117.60
Shilchar Tec	3971.90	3773.35
Shivalik Bim [2]	405.30	395.30
Shringar House	188.65	174.50
Shriram AMC	302.30	275.40
Shriram Prop	68.19	66.09
ShriraPist	3132.45	2942.80
Shukra Phr [1]	37.50	35.63
Shyam Metal	795.25	777.05
Siemens En [2]	2791.10	2699.75
SignatureG [1]	766.65	727.55
Sika Inter. [2]	915.25	905.55
Silver Touch [2]	122.35	116.90
Singer India [2]	70.52	68.81
Sirca Paint	428.75	400.80
SJS Enter	1579.60	1518.15
Skf India (Ind	2191.30	2118.35
SMC Global [2]	64.81	61.31
Solarworld E [5]	159.80	146.15
Sona BLW Pr	506.05	485.10
Spandana Sph	207.45	197.50
SPEL SemiCon	136.40	129.60
Sri Digv Cem	60.31	55.46
Sri Lotus De [1]	115.00	107.60
Stallion India	114.80	109.10

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Supriya Life [2]	583.50	550.85
Suryoday SFB	123.65	125.50
Suven Phar [1]	299.25	300.70
SW-Solar [1]	171.70	158.65
Swiggy [1]	282.70	272.50
Syrma SGS	782.35	746.30
Taneja Aero. [5]	246.35	233.40
Tarc [2]	122.70	114.35
Tarsons Pro [2]	184.15	177.60
Tata Capital L	317.25	312.25
Tata Tech [2]	539.55	518.95
TataMot CV [2]	419.60	394.95
TBO Tek [1]	1066.85	1018.75
TCC Concept	366.15	337.10
Techno Elec [2]	1089.90	1018.70
Tega Ind	1716.80	1585.65
Tejas Netwrk	435.80	400.70
TennecoCle	546.90	536.00
Timex Group [1]	280.15	260.35
Tinna Rubber	627.30	602.20
Titan Biotec [2]	396.55	387.40
Titan Secur.	44.76	40.90
TMB	599.10	572.40
Transrail Lig [2]	500.50	487.75
Travel Food [1]	1116.10	1098.80
Trualt Bioener	408.75	386.30
Tube Invt [1]	2534.60	2472.75
Ugro Cap	94.15	86.90

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Valiant Org	269.05	243.20
Vedant Fash [1]	354.90	338.80
Ventive Hos [1]	640.90	626.75
Venus Pipes	948.50	917.10
Vidya Wires Li	54.09	51.07
Vijaya Diag [1]	902.25	882.30
Vikram Solar L	192.45	190.10
Vikran Eng [1]	60.99	57.14
Vintage Coff.	131.85	133.20
Vish.Pr.Pung	36.98	34.12
Vishal Fab [5]	17.53	16.05
VishalMega	102.25	99.85
Waaree Enr	3164.20	3063.15
Waaree Re.T [2]	849.90	808.20
Wakefit Innova	160.75	155.00
Welsp SplSol [6]	34.45	32.99
Westlife Fd [2]	437.30	416.95
Westrn.Carr. [5]	92.75	85.20
Wework India M	469.20	441.35
WPIL [1]	384.15	369.30
Yatharth Hsp	641.00	621.85
Yatra Online [1]	107.25	102.30
Zaggle Pre [1]	208.00	194.40

Group T

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Midwest Gold	4412.75	4541.05
Murae Org [1]	0.20	0.19
TVS Supply [1]	100.40	95.40

NSE Trade for Trade

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Best Agrolif	14.50	13.80
E2E Netwrk	2262.20	2162.20
Embassy Dev	47.79	45.41
GE POWER IN	425.15	414.25
Hardwyn Ind	18.81	19.17
IndoSolarL	385.15	401.60
Izmo Ltd	696.10	663.35
MadhavCopper	61.17	58.12
REL INFRA	77.46	73.59
Schneider [2]	890.00	866.70
TVS SUPPLY CH	100.47	95.45
Zee Media [1]	7.38	7.06